NINTENDO ENTERTAINMENT SYSTEM

Dragon Warrior IV

Unified Walkthrough

Story routes, achievement planning,
and reference tables

Chapters 1–5 • 43 achievements • 360 points

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Introduction

Dragon Warrior IV replaces the single continuous opening of the earlier games with four smaller adventures and a fifth chapter that brings their heroes together. Those opening chapters are not disposable prologues: they establish the permanent cast, determine the levels and equipment each character brings into Chapter 5, and introduce places that the united party will revisit later.

Story So Far

Dragon Warrior IV begins a new continuity unconnected to the Erdrick trilogy of the first three games. Its different world establishes the Zenithian legend, where scattered kingdoms face a threat they do not yet understand and rumors point toward a Hero named in prophecy.

The first four chapters follow the people whose lives will eventually converge around that Hero. Ragnar, a royal soldier of Burland, investigates the disappearance of local children. Princess Alena escapes the restrictions of Santeem Castle to test her strength, accompanied by Cristo and Brey. Taloon leaves his family in Lakanaba to pursue his dream of owning a shop and becoming the world's greatest merchant. In Monbaraba, the sisters Nara and Mara begin a search for the man responsible for their father's death.

Chapter 5 begins with the Hero and turns those separate journeys into one expedition. The earlier protagonists must be found again, the wagon filled, the Zenithian equipment assembled, and the force behind the spreading evil confronted. The guide will preserve each chapter's perspective as it happens rather than revealing later connections before the route reaches them.

Chapter and Party Overview

Each opening chapter has its own party, economy, and immediate objective. Permanent characters keep their levels and carried equipment when they return in Chapter 5, but loose gold from the solo chapters does not carry forward. Before ending Chapters 1-4, spend surplus gold on useful equipment or items that can be retained and sold later rather than leaving it unused.

Chapter	Lead and Party	Route Purpose
1	Ragnar, with Healie as a temporary companion	Build Ragnar into a durable front-line fighter while solving the disappearances around Burland and Izmit.
2	Alena / Cristo / Brey	Develop a fast physical attacker, a healer, and an offensive-support mage while traveling from Santeem to the Endor Tournament.
3	Taloon, with optional hired help	Build Taloon's fortune, secure his shop, and fund the tunnel that links Endor and Branca.
4	Nara / Mara, with Orin as a temporary companion	Develop a support healer and offensive mage while pursuing Balzack from Monbaraba to Keeleon.
5	Hero, eventually joined by the seven earlier protagonists	Reunite the chosen ones, manage the wagon and tactics system, collect the Zenithian equipment, and prepare multiple endgame parties.

Once the permanent cast is reunited, do not treat Chapter 5 as a four-character campaign. The standard party can receive the best equipment first, but the restricted Necrosaro achievements require viable alternatives to the Hero. Keep the non-Hero front line and healers equipped well enough to function when called out of the wagon.

Character	Primary Role	Long-Term Route Value
Hero	Directly controlled physical attacker, emergency healer, and utility caster	Anchors the standard route and can correct decisions the AI-controlled party members will not make.
Ragnar	High-HP, high-strength front-line fighter	Durable physical damage for bosses and a leading candidate for the no-Hero party.
Alena	Fast physical attacker with frequent critical hits	Strong boss damage and one of the best answers to King Metal encounters.
Cristo	Durable healing and defensive support	Important sustained healing for the main route and restricted final-party attempts.
Brey	Ice offense, utility magic, and Bikill support	Can accelerate physical parties when the AI chooses the right support action.
Taloon	Physical fighter with unpredictable special actions	A durable reserve whose free-form actions can help or hinder depending on the fight.
Nara	Healing and defensive support	Gives the no-Hero roster another source of recovery, though her lower durability requires protection.
Mara	Fire offense and BeDragon	Provides reliable magical damage and a tactics-dependent answer to metal enemies.

Temporary companions such as Healie, Orin, Hector, Lucia, and Doran support particular route segments but do not replace development of the eight permanent characters. Their arrival and departure points will be called out where they occur.

Chapter 5 Tactics and AI

In Chapter 5, the player directly commands only the Hero. Other permanent party members choose their actions according to the selected tactic and the battle state at the moment their turn begins. They react to damage, healing, and defeated targets caused by earlier allies, but they do not plan around the Hero's queued action. Watch what the party has already done before committing the Hero to healing or targeting an enemy that may be defeated first.

The party also maintains hidden knowledge of each monster's spell resistances. A newly encountered monster begins at knowledge rank 0. Completing rounds against it advances that entry toward rank 3, where the AI has exact resistance knowledge for the rest of the game. Six casts of Ironize cover eighteen rounds and give a 99 percent chance of reaching rank 3 from rank 0. This is excessive for ordinary encounters, but it is a useful training method when a dangerous boss or recurring enemy causes allies to waste turns on resisted spells. Knowledge gained during a failed boss attempt is retained after revival.

Tactic	Practical Use
Normal	Balanced default for unfamiliar encounters and most routine travel.
Offensive	Prioritizes ending the fight and spends MP more freely; it also encourages Mara to use BeDragon against metal enemies.
Defensive	Makes healing and defensive actions more attractive. It also enables Nara to cast Farewell, so use it carefully when her MP is low and allies have fallen.
Save MP	Reduces expensive casting and prevents Healus and BeDragon, which can be dangerous when full-party recovery is needed.
Use No MP	Restricts allies to attacks and combat-usable items; useful when conserving the last of the party's MP.
Try Out	Produces deliberately unpredictable actions and permits certain unusual combat items. It is not an AI-training mode.

For major bosses, party composition, tactic choice, learned resistance knowledge, and the Hero's inventory matter as much as raw levels. Later boss preparations will specify who should be active, which tactic to begin with, when the Hero must cover healing, and whether an AI-learning setup is worthwhile.

Game-Long Achievement Plan

Most achievements are earned within one location or story event. The following achievements either span chapters, accumulate over much of Chapter 5, or become substantially harder if preparation is postponed until the final battle.

Achievement	Points	Long-Range Plan
Tunnel Rat	5	Taloon funds the Endor-Branca tunnel during Chapter 3. Return to and use the completed tunnel in Chapter 5 so the delayed payoff is not skipped.
Small Medal Collector	50	Track every medal from the first Chapter 5 visit to Konenber onward. Collect both Konenber ship medals before completing the Great Lighthouse because one becomes permanently unavailable afterward. Every later section will maintain a running total toward the required 32.
High Roller	5	Defer the serious casino grind until Chapter 5. Build a starting coin reserve, use the Endor poker table and double-or-nothing game, and bank progress with normal in-game saves. Hold at least 10,000 coins at once before buying prizes.
The One That Didn't Get Away	5	Keep Alena and Mara usable for late-game King Metal hunting. Alena's critical hits and Mara's tactics-driven BeDragon provide better routes than ordinary attacks alone.
We Don't Need Another Hero	25	From the Chapter 5 reunion onward, maintain a non-Hero front line and at least one capable non-Hero healer. The Hero's direct commands will be unavailable for this Necrosaro clear, making tactics and equipment depth essential.
Just the Two of Us	25	Prepare a literal two-member endgame team instead of relying only on the standard four. Preserve strong defensive equipment and recovery options, and keep an in-game save before Necrosaro for a dedicated attempt.

Treat the two restricted Necrosaro achievements as separate clears when planning. A two-person party without the Hero appears to satisfy both written descriptions, but this guide will not depend on both unlocking from one victory. The endgame section will provide a standard clear, a no-Hero composition, and a two-member composition so each condition can be attempted from the same pre-battle save.

The other achievements need attention at their specific locations rather than continuous grinding. Hidden-treasure achievements will have exact local checklists, chapter achievements will be confirmed before the chapter closes, and one-time interactions will be flagged before the route can advance past them.

Achievement Routing Overview

Achievements are placed in the earliest section where they can be earned without disrupting later preparation. Each walkthrough section begins with an achievement table listing points, the exact trigger, and route notes. Story achievements appear at the event that completes them; treasure achievements appear beside their final required pickup; delayed achievements receive setup notes both when preparation begins and when the unlock becomes available.

- **Achievement Alert: Achievement Name** marks the paragraph where an achievement should unlock.
- **Achievement Setup: Achievement Name (deferred)** marks an action that prepares an achievement earned in a later section.
- Small Medal entries include a running total and identify any collection that becomes unavailable after story progress.
- Hidden-treasure checklists remain separate from ordinary loot so all required pickups can be verified before leaving the location.
- Final-boss challenge achievements use explicit active-party, equipment, tactic, and save-point instructions rather than assuming the normal story party will satisfy them.

How to Use This Guide

- Follow Chapters 1-4 in order. Their routes are self-contained, but their characters and carried items return in Chapter 5.
- Read each section's achievement table before advancing its story objective. Several achievements depend on optional recruits, interactions, or treasures that are easy to pass.
- Complete every **Achievement Alert** before crossing the section's departure checkpoint. Follow every deferred setup note even though the achievement itself will be repeated at its eventual unlock point.
- Search drawers, jars, conspicuous ground tiles, and dead ends. Ordinary pickups and Small Medals are often outside treasure chests.
- Before ending a solo chapter, convert spare gold into useful equipment or sellable items because loose gold will not join the Chapter 5 treasury.
- Treat tactic recommendations as starting settings, not guarantees. The AI's choices change with party health, enemy knowledge, equipment, and the current battle state.
- Shop recommendations use four tiers: **Required**, **High**, **Situational**, and **Skip**.
- Boss preparation uses the same fields throughout: level, active party, wagon reserves, equipment, consumables, required spells, tactic, recovery point, and opening plan.
- Use each section's return link to jump back to the table of contents before moving to another route segment.

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Chapter 1: Ragnar and the Missing Children

Section Achievements: Chapter 1

Achievement	Points	Trigger	Route Notes
Reunited	5	Help Flora find her missing husband.	Identify Alex in Izmit at night, bring Flora from Burland to his cell, and complete their reunion before entering the Secret Playground.
Making Friends	5	Let the Healer slime join your party.	Find Healie in the optional eastern branch on the bottom floor of the Secret Playground and accept his offer to join.
In Search of a Hero	10	Complete Chapter 1.	Rescue the children, return them to Izmit, then report to the King of Burland.

Chapter 1 follows Ragnar, a soldier of Burland ordered to investigate why children have been disappearing across the kingdom. Ragnar is physically sturdy but slow, has no MP or spells, and fights alone until he finds an optional companion. Equipment and Medical Herb management therefore matter more than complicated battle commands: Ragnar can attack, parry, use an item, or run, but he cannot repair a bad situation with magic on his own.

The chapter's critical path is:

1. Investigate Burland and learn that Flora's husband Alex is missing.
2. Cross the Cave to Izmit and question the villagers by day and night.
3. Identify the prisoner as Alex, bring Flora to him, and learn the location of the Secret Playground.
4. Explore the hidden well, recruit Healie, and recover the Flying Shoes.
5. Use the Flying Shoes beside Loch Tower, rescue the children, and defeat Saro's Shadow.
6. Return the children to Izmit, convert spare gold into carried value, and report to the King of Burland.

Ragnar's Starting Position

Resource	Starting Value	Route Implication
Gold	50G	Not enough for a meaningful armor upgrade; collect the free herb before buying anything.
Weapon	Copper Sword (+12 attack)	Adequate through the Cave to Izmit. Do not replace it with a Club or Thorn Whip.
Armor	Leather Armor (+12 defense)	Serviceable for the opening field, but armor upgrades have lasting value because Ragnar's low Agility leaves his Defense equipment-dependent.
Magic	None	Carry Medical Herbs and an Antidote Herb until Healie joins.

Ragnar has high Strength and exceptionally high HP growth, but very low Agility. He usually acts after enemies and gains little natural Defense from Agility, so preventing damage through shields and armor is more reliable than buying every intermediate weapon. His chapter-end gear and carried inventory return with him in Chapter 5.

Burland Castle and Town

After the opening audience, Ragnar begins in Burland Castle's throne room. The King orders the royal soldiers to discover who is taking the kingdom's children. Before leaving, speak with the people in the castle for the local context, then go to the southeast room on 1F. Search the row of dressers and take the **Medical Herb from the second dresser from the right**. It is hidden rather than displayed as a chest.

Leave the castle for the attached town. Flora stands near the southwest side of town and explains that her husband, Alex, disappeared while looking into the same mystery. Speaking with her now establishes the lead needed later, although Ragnar cannot resolve it until he identifies Alex in Izmit.

The House of Healing near the town entrance is the save point. Its priest can also cure poison, curses, and a defeated character. Make a save before the first field trip. The inn charges 4G, but at the opening budget it is better to take short loops outside and use herbs only when the experience and gold gained justify the cost.

Burland Services and Shops

Service	Cost	Route Use
Inn	4G	Cheap recovery between opening field loops.
House of Healing	Varies	Save here; return here if a Babble poisons Ragnar and no Antidote Herb remains.

Tier	Item Shop	Cost	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Ragnar has no healing spell. Carry at least two before the Secret Playground and three or four before the Loch Tower boss.
High	Antidote Herb	10G	Carry one while Babble encounters are possible, especially at night.
Situational	Fairy Water	20G	Repels sufficiently weak overworld enemies. It does not replace leveling and is unnecessary for the short Cave to Izmit trip.

Tier	Weapon or Armor	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Club	30G	+7 attack	Weaker than Ragnar's starting Copper Sword.
Skip	Copper Sword	100G	+12 attack	Ragnar already owns one.
Skip	Thorn Whip	200G	+14 attack	A two-point gain is not worth delaying defense.
Situational	Chain Sickle	550G	+20 attack	Useful before Loch Tower if fights remain slow, but it will soon be replaced by the free Sword of Malice.
Skip	Leather Armor	180G	+12 defense	Ragnar starts with it.
Situational	Chain Mail	350G	+18 defense	A reasonable early upgrade, but skip it if saving directly for Half Plate Armor.
High	Leather Shield	90G	+4 defense	The best first purchase; one short field loop usually covers it.
Skip	Scale Shield	180G	+7 defense	Loch Tower contains one for free, and the Iron Shield is the better pre-tower purchase.
Skip	Leather Hat	65G	+2 defense	Save another 55G for the Wooden Hat instead.
High	Wooden Hat	120G	+6 defense	Ragnar's best Chapter 1 helmet and a lasting, inexpensive upgrade.

The later Izmit shop carries the two defensive upgrades that matter most: Half Plate Armor and Iron Shield.

Opening Training Loop

Fight near Burland until Ragnar reaches about level 3. Stay close enough to retreat before a bad group can turn into a defeat. Slimes and Stag Beetles are harmless training targets; Giant Worms and Diverats are still manageable but have enough HP to extend a fight. Babbles are the main logistical threat because poison persists after battle. At night, either carry an Antidote Herb or avoid stretching the trip beyond a safe return.

Buy the Leather Shield once Ragnar has 90G, then rest, save, and leave Burland through the northwest route toward the river cave. The exact world-map approach bends west and north around the river; enter the cave that crosses to Izmit's side rather than trying to follow the shoreline directly.

Cave to Izmit

Recommended level: 3
Recovery: Burland before entry; Izmit after exiting
Fixed treasure: Medical Herb, 40G

This is a short one-floor passage and the first chance to learn the guide's dungeon discipline: take side branches when they appear, account for every fixed pickup, and leave before low HP forces an expensive recovery.

1. From the entrance, follow the passage north and turn right at the first available branch.
2. Enter the dark passage to the east. It ends at a chest containing a **Medical Herb**.
3. Backtrack to the main route and continue north into the room with a central pond. The soldier here is lost and does not advance the story.
4. Walk clockwise around the water and take the passage on the left.
5. Follow it north to the chest containing **40G**.
6. Continue north to the exit stairs.

Outside, travel east; Izmit lies a short distance to the north. Healers can prolong cave battles by repeatedly casting Heal. Focus on one target until it falls rather than spreading damage and giving it time to recover.

Burland and Izmit Region Enemies

The values below are per defeated enemy. Drops are possibilities, not guaranteed rewards.

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Notable Behavior	Possible Drop
Slime	8	1	2G	Lowest-risk opening target.	Medical Herb
Stag Beetle	9	1	4G	Basic physical attacker.	Medical Herb
Giant Worm	11	3	6G	More durable than the opening pair but no special route concern.	Medical Herb
Diverat	14	3	7G	Higher HP makes groups more costly before the shield purchase.	Medical Herb
Babble	12	6	8G	Can poison Ragnar; avoid extended travel while poisoned.	Antidote Herb
Healer	16	7	11G	Casts Heal and can drag out a fight; concentrate attacks.	Medical Herb
Demon Stump	21	7	13G	Can use its carried Medical Herb once, effectively extending its HP.	Medical Herb

Izmit Investigation and the Reunion

Izmit's item shop and inn are near the entrance; its weapon and armor shops are farther north. Search the three dressers in the room on the right side of the inn for a hidden **Medical Herb**. Talk to the adults and children during the day, including the schoolchildren, then inspect the jail below the stairs at the north end of town. The prisoner cannot initially explain who he is.

Stay at the inn or walk outside until night. Return to the schoolyard and speak to the boy moving around the playground. He identifies the prisoner as Alex. Go back underground and speak to the prisoner again so Ragnar can confirm the lead.

Return through the cave to Burland and talk to Flora. She will follow Ragnar without occupying his battle slot. Escort her back through the Cave to Izmit and take her directly to Alex's cell. Flora restores his memory, and Alex explains that the children visit a hidden playground in the forest: from the sign outside Izmit, walk **four steps south and four steps east**.

> **Achievement Alert: Reunited**
> **Trigger:** Complete the conversation in Alex's cell after bringing Flora from Burland. The achievement description is "Help Flora find her missing husband."

This event is the progression gate for the Secret Playground. Rest and save in Izmit before following Alex's directions.

Izmit Services and Shops

Service	Cost	Route Use
Inn	6G	Main recovery point for the Secret Playground and Loch Tower preparations.
House of Healing	Varies	Save after the reunion and before each Loch Tower attempt.

Tier	Item Shop	Cost	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Restock before both dungeons; Ragnar needs his own emergency healing even after Healie joins.
High	Antidote Herb	10G	Carry one while traveling through the surrounding region.
Situational	Fairy Water	20G	Useful only after Ragnar outlevels the local field encounters; it does not suppress the important dungeon fights.

Tier	Weapon or Armor	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Copper Sword	100G	+12 attack	Already equipped at the start.
Skip	Thorn Whip	200G	+14 attack	Too small an improvement.
Skip	Boomerang	350G	+18 attack	The Chain Sickle is stronger, and both are temporary.
Situational	Chain Sickle	550G	+20 attack	Buy only if Ragnar needs help reaching the free tower weapon.
Skip	Iron Spear	880G	+28 attack	Do not buy it for this route; Loch Tower gives a +45 weapon.
Skip	Chain Mail	350G	+18 defense	Buy only as a budget bridge if Half Plate Armor remains far away.

Tier	Weapon or Armor	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Bronze Armor	700G	+25 defense	Better than Chain Mail, but Half Plate Armor has more lasting value.
High	Half Plate Armor	1,200G	+30 defense	Ragnar's best body armor available in Chapter 1 and worth carrying into Chapter 5.
Skip	Scale Shield	180G	+7 defense	A free copy is inside Loch Tower.
High	Iron Shield	650G	+12 defense	The best Chapter 1 shield; prioritize it before the boss if funds allow.
High	Wooden Hat	120G	+6 defense	Buy if it was not purchased in Burland.

The ideal end-of-chapter set is **Sword of Malice / Half Plate Armor / Iron Shield / Wooden Hat**. It is not necessary to own all three armor upgrades before entering the tower, but every permanent defensive purchase reduces healing pressure and remains useful later.

Secret Playground

Recommended level: 6
Recovery: Izmit before and after the trip
Fixed treasure: 2 Medical Herbs, 600G, Agility Seed, Flying Shoes
Optional recruit: Healie

Walk to the sign outside Izmit, count four tiles south and four tiles east, and enter the hidden forest clearing. Walk north and descend the well. A voice gives directions through the passages. Following it leads safely toward the objective and suppresses most encounters; leaving its route leads to the optional treasure and Healie. This guide deliberately leaves the safe path to clear the area.

B1: First Branches

1. Follow the initial passage south.
2. At the first split, continue south as the voice directs.
3. At the T intersection, go west.
4. At the next split, go south and ignore the staircase to the north for now.
5. Continue until the voice speaks again. Ignore it and go east into the side room.
6. Follow the winding passage to its dead end and open the chest for a **Medical Herb**.
7. Return to the last intersection, go south, and descend to B2.

B2: Recruit Healie Before Taking the Shoes

From the stairs, walk east. When the voice tells Ragnar to turn, ignore it and continue all the way east to the dead end. Speak to the Healer slime there and answer **Yes** when he offers to join.

> **Achievement Alert: Making Friends**
> **Trigger:** Accept Healie into the party. The achievement description is "Let the Healer slime join your party."

Healie is optional for story completion but central to the safe route. He acts independently, has a basic physical attack, and casts Heal on Ragnar during battle. He also gives enemies a second target. Ragnar still needs Medical Herbs because Healie can spend all of his MP or wait longer than desired to heal.

Retrace the passage to the voice, then take the northern route. Continue north through the next intersection. At the following T split, go east against the voice's direction and follow the long passage to the chest containing **600G**. This money should fund most or all of the Iron Shield, depending on earlier spending.

Return to that T split and take the western branch recommended by the voice. Open the chest on the platform for the **Flying Shoes**. This key item is required to enter Loch Tower.

Exit Route and Hidden Pots

Return to the stairs in the southwest corner of B2 and climb to B1. Go north, west, north, then east to reach the staircase that was bypassed earlier. Follow the zigzag passage toward the entrance. Near the first split, take the western branch into the room with cracked flooring and deliberately fall through the opening.

After landing, climb the nearby stairs into the small room with five pots. Search all five to collect a **Medical Herb** and an **Agility Seed**, then use the eastern staircase to emerge near the well. Walk southeast around the trees and leave the clearing to the west.

Do not spend the Agility Seed yet. Ragnar's low Agility makes him an intuitive target, but the seed remains in his carried inventory and can be allocated after the full Chapter 5 roster is available. The supplied walkthrough recommends saving early stat seeds for that decision point.

Secret Playground Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Healer	16	7	11G	Concentrate attacks before repeated Heal casts extend the battle.	Medical Herb
Sizarmage	17	11	13G	Can cast Blaze once before exhausting its small MP pool; defeat it first.	Cypress Stick
Demon Stump	21	7	13G	Can heal itself once with its item.	Medical Herb
Lethal Gopher	16	9	10G	Stores power for a double-strength next attack; kill it during the setup turn or parry if needed.	Strength Seed

Return to Izmit, rest, save, and prepare for the chapter's only major dungeon. Aim for level 8 or 9. Buy the Iron Shield and Wooden Hat if possible, then Half Plate Armor as funds permit. A Chain Sickle is the only worthwhile temporary weapon purchase, and even it is optional because Loch Tower contains the Sword of Malice. Carry at least three Medical Herbs on Ragnar; four provides a safer buffer if Healie spends his MP before the boss.

Loch Tower

Recommended level: 8-9 on entry; about 9-10 for the boss
Required item: Flying Shoes
Recovery: Unlimited full HP/MP restoration on the basement recovery tile
Fixed treasure: Wing of Wyvern, Strength Seed, 640G, Scale Shield, Luck Seed, Sword of Malice

Walk west from Izmit to the water surrounding Loch Tower. Stand beside the moat and **use** the Flying Shoes from Ragnar's inventory. Ragnar and Healie land on the tower's roof, where they see a child being led below. The supplied guides count the roof as either the entry level or 4F, so this route identifies floors by sequence and landmark as well as number.

Roof to 2F

1. Descend from the roof and enter the northern passage.
2. Take the left branch to the dead-end chest containing a **Wing of Wyvern**.
3. Return to the entry stairs, take the southern route, then walk east past the soldier.
4. Descend the stairs at the end to reach 2F.

5. From the 2F stairs, walk north past the large door and climb the northeast stairs.
6. On the upper landing, open the nearby chest for a **Strength Seed**, then return to 2F.
7. Enter the large room on 2F and open the chest for **640G**.
8. Continue clockwise around the floor. At the pair of large pillars, walk north between them into the covered room and take the **Scale Shield**.
9. Continue north and descend to 1F.

Equip the Scale Shield only if Ragnar still has the Leather Shield. If he already bought the superior Iron Shield, keep the Scale Shield as carried value for Chapter 5 rather than downgrading.

1F Treasure and Recovery Hub

From the 1F stairs, first go south and descend to the basement. Step onto the white tile at the north end to restore Ragnar and Healie to full HP and MP. The tile can be used repeatedly, making this the best place in the chapter to finish any required leveling.

Return to 1F and open the large door north of the stairs. The eastern branch leads to a chest containing a **Luck Seed**. The mirrored western branch leads to the **Sword of Malice**. Equip it immediately: its +45 attack is 17 points stronger than the Iron Spear and 25 stronger than the Chain Sickle. When used as an item in battle, it produces a group-targeting Firebal effect, making it useful against groups or enemies whose Defense has been raised by Upper.

Keep both seeds unused for Chapter 5 allocation. Heal again after collecting the weapon if the detours cost meaningful HP or MP.

Loch Tower Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Healer	16	7	11G	Remove it before it prolongs the group with Heal.	Medical Herb
Ducksbill	22	14	10G	Can cast Sap, which is dangerous for slow, equipment-dependent Ragnar. End the fight or heal sooner after Defense falls.	Leather Shield
Lethal Gopher	16	9	10G	Do not leave it alive after it stores power.	Strength Seed
Lilypa	21	13	15G	Casts Upper on itself or allies. Use the Sword of Malice as an item against a defended group.	Basic Clothes
Ozwarg	33	18	20G	Loch Tower's durable spell threat; prioritize it before repeated Icebolt damage accumulates.	Medical Herb
Pixie	29	16	20G	Less dangerous than Ozwarg or a status threat, but sturdier than earlier enemies.	Agility Seed
Giant Bantam	31	20	9G	Its attack can put Ragnar to sleep; focus it before losing multiple turns.	Medical Herb

Once Ragnar has the Sword of Malice, most ordinary enemies should fall in one or two attacks. Use the basement tile instead of consuming herbs during the final preparation loop. Finish at level 9 or 10, refill Healie's MP, place three or four Medical Herbs in Ragnar's inventory, and save in Izmit if you want a protected attempt before committing to the boss route.

Route to the Children

From the 1F stairs leading to the recovery basement, take the west passage. Follow it south and then east across the bottom of the floor. Pass the tower's ground-level front entrance and continue east to the wall, then turn north and descend the stairs. Follow the lower passage east and enter the northern room. A child warns Ragnar before the confrontation. Heal before stepping onto the platform and speaking to the monster.

Boss: Saro's Shadow and Giant Eyeball

Preparation	Recommendation
Level	9-10
Party	Ragnar / Healie
Ragnar equipment	Sword of Malice; Half Plate Armor if affordable; Iron Shield preferred; Wooden Hat
Consumables	3-4 Medical Herbs on Ragnar; Wing of Wyvern retained for the return trip
Recovery point	White tile below 1F, used immediately before the final approach
Opening target	Giant Eyeball

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Known Threats	Possible Drop
Giant Eyeball	42	27	40G	Becomes much more dangerous at low HP and can deliver critical hits after its eye changes.	Medical Herb
Saro's Shadow	250	73	60G	Hard physical attacks, Blaze, Firebal, and fire breath make it the sustained threat.	Sphere of Silence

The encounter pays a combined **100 EXP and 100G**. Attack the Giant Eyeball first and finish it cleanly; its low-HP change makes leaving it wounded more dangerous than removing it. Once it falls, attack Saro's Shadow every round while Healie handles routine healing.

Do not assume Healie will always heal at Ragnar's preferred threshold. If Ragnar falls into danger, use a Medical Herb rather than gambling on Healie's next action. If Healie runs out of MP, Ragnar must alternate between attacking and self-healing. There is no reason to conserve herbs past survival: the chapter is almost over, while defeat costs half of Ragnar's current gold and requires another tower descent.

The Sword of Malice's item effect is less valuable here than a normal physical attack against a single target. Use the weapon as a weapon, keep Ragnar healthy enough to survive Saro's Shadow's next action, and grind down the boss's 250 HP. The battle ends as soon as both enemies are defeated; any listed monster drop remains chance-based and is not required for progression.

Returning the Children

After the battle, the children follow Ragnar. Backtrack to the tower's ground-level front entrance and step outside. The moat prevents a direct walk to Izmit. If Ragnar still has the Wing of Wyvern, use it to return immediately. Otherwise, use the Flying Shoes outside the tower to return to the roof, then walk off the south edge; Ragnar, Healie, and the children land safely beyond the moat.

Enter Izmit to reunite the children with their families. Random encounters cease for the return to Burland, so this is the chapter's final preparation window rather than another combat leg.

Before speaking to the King, spend nearly all remaining gold. Loose gold does not carry into Chapter 5, while Ragnar's equipped gear and carried items do. Prioritize the permanent set in this order:

1. Half Plate Armor if Ragnar does not own it.
2. Iron Shield if Ragnar does not own it.
3. Wooden Hat if Ragnar does not own it.
4. Extra equipment or consumables that retain resale or practical value in Chapter 5.

Keep the Sword of Malice equipped and retain the Strength, Agility, and Luck Seeds. Do not sell unique or useful carried items merely to reach exactly zero gold. The objective is to avoid abandoning currency, not to weaken Ragnar's returning inventory.

Leave Izmit, cross the connecting cave back to Burland, enter the castle, and approach the throne. Ragnar reports what the kidnappers were seeking and declares his intention to find and protect the Hero. The King awards Ragnar **3,000 EXP**, normally raising him to approximately level 12 or 13, and Chapter 1 ends.

> **Achievement Alert: In Search of a Hero**
> **Trigger:** Finish the audience with the King of Burland and complete Chapter 1.

Chapter 1 Completion Check

- **Achievements:** Reunited, Making Friends, and In Search of a Hero unlocked.
- **Ragnar:** Approximately level 12-13 after the King's 3,000 EXP reward.
- **Preferred equipment:** Sword of Malice / Half Plate Armor / Iron Shield / Wooden Hat.
- **Carried forward:** Ragnar's level, equipment, inventory, and unused stat seeds.
- **Not carried forward:** Loose Chapter 1 gold.
- **Temporary companion:** Healie leaves when the chapter ends.
- **Missable check:** Healie was recruited before taking the children home.
- **Next chapter:** Princess Alena's adventure begins in Santeem Castle.

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Chapter 2: Alena's Journey to Endor

Section Achievements: Chapter 2

Achievement	Points	Trigger	Route Notes
Sneaking Out	5	Find a way out of the Castle.	Complete the dialogue gate in Santeem, break through Alena's repaired bedroom wall, and leave the castle grounds.
The Offering	5	Bring peace to Tempe.	Volunteer as the sacrifice and defeat the Chameleon Humanoid with its two Rabidhounds.
The Kidnapped Imposter	5	Rescue the fake princess.	Exchange the Golden Bracelet for May at Frenor's graveyard at night.
Speak No Evil	5	Restore the King's Voice.	Recover the Birdsong Nectar and use it while facing the King of Santeem.
The Empty Castle	10	Complete Chapter 2.	Win the Endor Tournament, investigate the deserted Santeem Castle, and leave through its front entrance.

Chapter 2 follows Princess Alena of Santeem, whose desire to see the world is stronger than her father's order to remain inside the castle. Unlike Ragnar's solo opening, this chapter quickly forms a balanced three-person party: Alena supplies fast physical damage, Cristo supplies healing and defensive magic, and Brey supplies attack magic and enemy debuffs.

The chapter's critical path is:

1. Break out of Santeem Castle and meet Cristo and Brey outside.
2. Equip and train the party around Surene before traveling to Tempe.
3. Volunteer as Tempe's offering and defeat the monsters threatening the village.
4. Investigate the false princess in Frenor, recover the Golden Bracelet, and exchange it for May and the Thief's Key.
5. Visit the Bazaar, answer Santeem's summons, and trace the cure for the King's lost voice to Birdsong Tower.
6. Restore the King's voice, cross the travel-door shrine to Endor, and prepare Alena for the solo tournament.
7. Win five consecutive matches, return to the now-empty Santeem Castle, and leave to close the chapter.

Chapter 2 Party Development Plan

Character	Chapter Role	Important Spell Levels	Development Priority
Alena	Fast physical attacker and eventual solo tournament fighter	No spells	Keep her weapon current, reserve inventory space for tournament herbs, and buy the Iron Claw before entering the tournament.
Cristo	Healer and defensive caster	Upper 4, Surround 6, Antidote 8, StopSpell 12	Protect his MP in dungeons, improve his armor, and keep him alive so Heal remains available.
Brey	Offensive caster and debuffer	Sap 3, Outside 7, Bounce 8, Return 9, Snowstorm 11	Protect his low HP and Defense, preserve 8 MP for Outside in the Golden Bracelet cave, and learn Snowstorm before Birdsong Tower.

All three permanent characters retain their levels and personal equipment when they return in Chapter 5. Loose Chapter 2 gold does not carry forward. Casino coins are tracked separately and remain available later, but this route still defers the serious casino grind until Chapter 5. The final Endor visit is therefore both a tournament checkpoint and the last opportunity to convert ordinary gold into lasting equipment.

Santeem Castle: The Escape

Starting level: 1
Fixed pickups: Feather Hat, Fairy Water, Wing of Wyvern
Recovery: House of Healing inside the castle

The chapter opens in Santeem's throne room. After the King forbids Alena from leaving, speak with Brey in the throne room, Cristo on 1F, the guards at the front entrance, and the other castle residents. These conversations advance the repair work in Alena's bedroom. If the escape route is not ready, continue speaking with anyone you missed before returning upstairs.

From the throne room, take the stairs to the King's right up to 3F. Enter Alena's bedroom and speak with the repairman at the damaged wall. Search the room's dressers for a **Feather Hat** and equip it immediately; its +8 Defense is the best helmet Alena can use during this chapter.

Return to 1F and enter the House of Healing where Cristo was standing. Search the dressers in its back room for **Fairy Water**. Enter the room in the northwest part of 1F and search the right dresser for a **Wing of Wyvern**. After completing the castle conversations, return to Alena's bedroom. Stand directly in front of the repaired wall, use Search, and choose to kick it down. Walk through the opening, drop onto the roof, and step off the north edge to land outside the castle wall. Leave the castle grounds to the north.

> **Achievement Alert: Sneaking Out**
> **Trigger:** Escape Santeem Castle through the repaired bedroom wall and leave the grounds.

Walk west toward the nearby town. Cristo and Brey intercept Alena and insist on joining, creating the permanent Chapter 2 party. Enter Surene immediately rather than fighting before the two companions arrive.

Surene: Equipment and Early Levels

Recommended level before leaving: 4
Inn: 2G per person
Fixed pickups: None

Surene is the party's first safe base. Speak to everyone, including the poet Marone on the second-floor balcony of the main building; his information becomes a required link later. Save at the House of Healing, then make short training loops around Surene and Santeem until the party reaches approximately level 4.

Surene Shops

Tier	Weapon or Supply	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Club	30G	+7 attack	Cristo begins with one; pass it to Alena after upgrading him.
High	Copper Sword	100G	+12 attack	Efficient first weapon for Cristo; hand his Club to Alena.
Situational	Thorn Whip	200G	+14 attack	Better than the opening weapons, but saving for Tempe's Boomerangs is more efficient.

Tier	Weapon or Supply	Cost	Power	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Restores about 30 HP	Carry emergency healing on Alena or Brey so Cristo is not the party's only recovery source.

Tier	Armor	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Basic Clothes	10G	+4 defense	Too small an upgrade to matter.
Situational	Wayfarer's Clothes	70G	+7 defense	A cheap bridge for Brey if Leather Armor remains unaffordable.
High	Leather Armor	180G	+12 defense	Useful on all three characters; protect Brey first if he is falling in one or two hits.
High	Leather Shield	90G	+4 defense	Give the first one to Brey, whose low HP and Defense create the greatest failure risk. Cristo should receive the next.
Situational	Leather Hat	65G	+2 defense	Cheap protection for Cristo or Brey; do not replace Alena's free Feather Hat.

Use hand-me-downs instead of buying three complete sets at once. A Copper Sword for Cristo frees his Club for Alena, and one Leather Shield on Brey removes the party's weakest defensive point. Add Leather Armor as gold permits. Do not remain here until every slot is filled; Tempe's route and boss reward provide more gold and better weapon access.

Santeem and Surene Region Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Route Notes	Possible Drop
Red Slime	10	2	5G	Low-risk opening target.	Medical Herb
Kaskos Hopper	8	1	2G	Lowest-HP enemy in the region.	Medical Herb
Elerat	11	3	5G	Useful early gold relative to its HP.	Leather Hat
Troglodyte	13	4	10G	Better gold return but more capable of pressuring an unarmored Brey.	Medical Herb
Giant Worm	11	3	6G	Basic physical threat familiar from Chapter 1.	Medical Herb
Prank Gopher	10	2	4G	Basic physical threat.	Medical Herb

When the party is near level 4, rest and save in Surene. Travel north of Santeem Castle, follow the path east at the sign, and enter the mountain village of Tempe.

Tempe and the Offering

Recommended level: 5 on arrival; 6 before the boss
Recovery: Inn for 3G per person; save before accepting the offering
Fixed pickup: Lifeforce Nuts, available after the boss

Speak with the villagers to learn that monsters demand the sacrifice of young girls. Enter the building east of the inn and speak with the mayor; agree to help the village. The shaman in the House of Healing at the north end can then prepare Alena as the next offering.

Do not accept until the party is ready, because the conversation moves directly into the boss sequence. Reach level 6, refill Cristo and Brey's MP, place at least one Medical Herb on Alena or Brey, and improve Brey's armor. Cristo's

Upper, Surround, and Heal and Brey's Sap and Icebolt are the important tools; extra attack power on the casters is secondary.

Tempe Shop

The northwest shop opens after the boss, so its stock cannot be used for the first attempt.

Tier	Item or Equipment	Cost	Power	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Restores about 30 HP	Refill the party's emergency supply after the fight.
Situational	Antidote Herb	10G	Cures poison	Carry one for the route toward Frenor until Cristo learns Antidote.
Situational	Wing of Wyvern	25G	Return effect	Convenient but unnecessary while towns remain close together.
Skip	Thorn Whip	200G	+14 attack	Outclassed by the Boomerang for only 150G more.
High	Boomerang	350G	+18 attack	Strong, broadly equippable upgrade. Buy one for Alena first and add another later as funds permit.
Situational	Leather Armor	180G	+12 defense	Fill any remaining unarmored slot before the Frenor region.

When ready, speak to the shaman, agree to serve as the offering, and enter the chamber to the south. The party is carried to the outdoor platform, where a Chameleon Humanoid and two Rabidhounds attack.

Boss: Chameleon Humanoid and Two Rabidhounds

Preparation	Recommendation
Level	6
Party	Alena / Cristo / Brey
Key spells	Heal, Upper, Surround, Sap, Icebolt
Consumables	At least one Medical Herb outside Cristo's inventory
Recovery point	Tempe or Surene immediately before volunteering

Enemy	Count	HP Each	Known Threat	Possible Drop
Chameleon Humanoid	1	40	Can heal and prolong the encounter.	Lifeforce Nuts
Rabidhound	2	23	Two extra physical actions while both remain alive.	Wing of Wyvern

The full encounter awards **150 EXP and 100G**: 136 EXP and 60G from the Chameleon Humanoid plus 7 EXP and 20G from each Rabidhound. Have Cristo cast Upper on Brey first, since Brey is the easiest character to lose. Surround reduces the hounds' physical accuracy, while Brey's Sap accelerates whichever target the party chooses. Use Icebolt when another debuff is unnecessary.

The supplied strategies disagree on the opening target. Removing a Rabidhound first reduces the enemy action count; eliminating the Chameleon Humanoid first prevents healing. Use the first round to judge incoming damage. If Brey is under immediate pressure, remove the hounds one at a time. If the Chameleon erases meaningful damage with Heal, concentrate all attacks on it. Do not split damage across all three enemies.

Cristo should heal whenever a party member cannot safely absorb the next round. Alena attacks unless she must use the emergency herb because Cristo is occupied or acts too late.

> **Achievement Alert: The Offering**
> **Trigger:** Defeat the Chameleon Humanoid and both Rabidhounds, ending Tempe's sacrifices.

After the victory, the northwest shop opens and Tempe's northern exit becomes available. Return to the outdoor offering platform, stand on the visibly cracked tile at its center, and use Search to uncover **Lifeforce Nuts**. Save them for Chapter 5 allocation rather than committing the permanent HP increase before the full roster is available.

Rest, save, and leave through the House of Healing to the north. Follow the mountain route northeast, then turn east toward the waterfront town of Frenor.

Frenor and the False Princess

Recommended level: 6-7 on arrival; 9 before the cave
Recovery: Inn for 4G per person; House of Healing in the southwest
Fixed town pickup: Medical Herb after the ransom exchange

Speak with the townspeople to hear that the Princess of Santeem is staying at the inn. Since Alena is the real princess, enter the inn near the center of town and go upstairs. Speak with the occupants to trigger the kidnapping scene, then follow the abductors through the inn's concealed exterior route.

Return to town and speak with everyone again. The boy near the southeast shop has the ransom demand: bring the Golden Bracelet to the northwest graveyard at night. The bracelet is kept in the cave south of Frenor.

The inn and House of Healing become available after the kidnapping. When entering the House of Healing, watch the priest run forward from the rear garden and remember the square where he was standing. That tile holds a hidden item after the rescue.

Reach about level 9 before entering the cave. Cristo learns **Antidote at level 8**, removing much of the poison pressure, and Brey learns **Outside at level 7**. Preserve at least 8 MP on Brey so the party can leave immediately after finding the bracelet. Buy Chain Mail for Alena and Cristo as funds allow, a Wooden Hat for Cristo, and another Boomerang if basic attacks remain weak.

Frenor Shops

Tier	General Shop	Cost	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Keep emergency healing on Alena and Brey.
High	Antidote Herb	10G	Carry one even after Cristo learns Antidote in case he is defeated or low on MP.
Situational	Wing of Wyvern	25G	Backup Return effect.
Situational	Full Moon Herb	30G	Cures paralysis; no need to stockpile yet.

Tier	General Shop	Cost	Route Advice
High	Chain Mail	350G	+18 Defense and a worthwhile upgrade for Alena and Cristo.
High	Wooden Hat	120G	+6 Defense for Cristo.

The weapon shop east of the central pond opens only after May is rescued.

Tier	Weapon Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Copper Sword	100G	+12 attack	Already outclassed.
Skip	Thorn Whip	200G	+14 attack	Already outclassed.
Situational	Boomerang	350G	+18 attack	Useful hand-me-down weapon for Cristo or Brey.
High	Chain Sickle	550G	+20 attack	Buy for Alena after the rescue if the Iron Claw fund remains secure.
Situational	Iron Spear	880G	+28 attack	Strong on Cristo, but Bazaar's Morning Star is better and only 370G more.

Cave South of Frenor

Recommended level: 9
Fixed treasure: Wing of Wyvern, 360G, Agility Seed, Magic Potion, Golden Bracelet
Exit plan: Brey's Outside spell with at least 8 MP remaining

The upper floor is manageable, but the lower floor adds enemies that attack groups, drain MP, poison, or reduce Defense. Conserve Cristo's MP for healing and Antidote. Brey should use ordinary attacks against weak groups and reserve spellcasting for dangerous combinations.

Upper Floor

1. From the entrance, walk southwest a few steps and take the southern dark passage to a chest containing a **Wing of Wyvern**.
2. Return to the main passage and continue west into the large room.
3. Ignore the central platform briefly and take the northern dark passage to a chest containing **360G**.
4. Return to the large room and climb onto the central platform for the **Agility Seed**.
5. Walk counterclockwise around the platform, turn west, then follow the passage north and east to the stairs.

Lower Floor

1. Walk south from the stairs and take the eastern passage.
2. In the large room, enter the dark western branch and open the southern chest for a **Magic Potion**.
3. Return to the large room and continue south through the passage partly obscured by undergrowth.
4. Move clockwise through the room of rocks and bones; the bones are walkable floor rather than barriers.
5. Follow the final western route and open the lone chest for the **Golden Bracelet**.

Use Brey's Outside spell as soon as the bracelet is secured. The Magic Potion can restore enough MP if the trip consumed the reserve intended for escape.

Frenor Region and Cave Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Brahmird	20	7	17G	May begin asleep; defeat it before it wakes and uses its rolling attack.	Strength Seed
Blazeghost	12	6	16G	Casts Blaze, can evade physical blows, and may split when struck. Avoid feeding a long fight.	Fairy Water
Demon Toadstool	19	6	15G	Can poison; use Cristo's Antidote or an herb after battle.	Medical Herb
Carnivore Plant	17	7	18G	Appears in groups and can summon Healers; Surround helps contain physical pressure.	Medical Herb
Healer	16	7	11G	Remove it before repeated Heal casts prolong a group.	Medical Herb
Somnabeetle	23	12	15G	Often begins asleep but can cast Sleep and Sleepmore after waking.	Magic Potion
Vampire Bat	25	11	23G	May begin confused and attack its allies; leave a confused bat alone while handling active threats.	Agility Seed
Thevro	25	15	25G	Group fire damage can overwhelm the party; prioritize large groups and keep Cristo ready to heal.	Leather Shield
Crested Viper	31	18	25G	Can poison and cast Defense; Bounce can reflect the spell onto its group.	Feather Hat
Ozwarg	33	18	20G	Icebolt creates steady magical pressure.	Medical Herb
Orc	33	18	36G	Often appears in groups and casts Surround; magic remains accurate after physical accuracy falls.	Fairy Water
Kordra	32	25	39G	Dangerous critical hits make it a priority target.	Morning Star
Sand Master	30	22	27G	Group encounters and MP-draining attacks threaten the planned Outside cast. Run if the party's escape reserve is at risk.	Basic Clothes
Armor Scorpion	40	38	44G	High Defense; reduce it with Sap before relying on physical attacks.	Leather Armor

The Ransom Exchange

Return to Frenor and wait until night. Go to the graveyard in the northwest corner and speak to the kidnappers. Hand over the Golden Bracelet; May is released and gives the party the **Thief's Key**.

> **Achievement Alert: The Kidnapped Imposter**
> **Trigger:** Complete the nighttime exchange at Frenor's graveyard and rescue May.

After May leaves, revisit the House of Healing. Walk into the rear garden and Search the exact tile where the priest stood before running forward on the first visit. Pick up the hidden **Medical Herb**. Speak with the townspeople again to learn about the desert Bazaar, then visit the newly opened weapon shop if Alena still needs a Chain Sickle.

Leave Frenor and travel south past the Golden Bracelet cave. A shrine lies to the east, but it is not the next objective. Continue southwest into the desert and step onto the green oasis tile to enter the Bazaar.

The Bazaar and Santeem's Summons

Recommended level: 9-10
Inn: 6G per person
Fixed pickups: Strength Seed, Gum Pod

Explore the market and speak with the merchants. On the west side, a Santeem guard stops Alena and reports that something is wrong with the King. This is the story signal to return home, but collect the Bazaar's items and evaluate its equipment first.

Enter the small house on the Bazaar's south side. Search the two pots immediately beside the woman to find a **Strength Seed** and a **Gum Pod**. Retain the seed for Chapter 5 allocation.

Bazaar Shops

Tier	Item Shop	Cost	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Maintain emergency healing outside Cristo's MP pool.
High	Antidote Herb	10G	Backup for the poison-heavy route.
Situational	Fairy Water	20G	Suppresses weaker overworld encounters only after the party outlevels them.
Situational	Wing of Wyvern	25G	Backup Return effect.
Situational	Full Moon Herb	30G	Carry one before Birdsong Tower if paralysis has become a problem.

Tier	Weapon Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Situational	Boomerang	350G	+18 attack	Affordable hand-me-down weapon.
High	Chain Sickle	550G	+20 attack	Strong pre-tournament weapon for Alena.
High	Venomous Dagger	750G	+24 attack	Brey's best practical Chapter 2 weapon and potentially useful against Metal Slimes.
Situational	Iron Spear	880G	+28 attack	Good for Cristo, but save another 370G for the Morning Star when possible.
High	Morning Star	1,250G	+33 attack	Cristo's best conventional Chapter 2 weapon.

Tier	Armor Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Leather Armor	180G	+12 defense	Outclassed if the party already followed the Frenor upgrades.
Situational	Chain Mail	350G	+18 defense	Budget armor for Alena or Cristo.
High	Bronze Armor	700G	+25 defense	Strong Cristo upgrade before Birdsong Tower.
Situational	Leather Shield	90G	+4 defense	Cheap fallback for an empty slot.
High	Scale Shield	180G	+7 defense	Efficient protection for Cristo and Brey.
High	Wooden Hat	120G	+6 defense	Best available helmet for Cristo.

Cast Return to Santeem if Brey has learned it; otherwise walk back through the northern route. Enter the castle and speak to the King on 2F. He has lost his voice, so the chancellor directs the party to the old man behind the castle.

Go to Alena's room on 3F, pass through the broken wall, and drop to the roof. This time, use the Thief's Key on the western outbuilding. Speak with the old man, Goz, and search his dresser for a **Wing of Wyvern**. Goz remembers

that Marone once recovered from a damaged voice.

Enter Surene and speak with Marone on the second-floor balcony. He identifies Birdsong Nectar as the cure and says he obtained it at the Bazaar. Return to the Bazaar, walk behind the item merchant, and speak to him from the rear. He no longer has the nectar and directs the party to Birdsong Tower on the peninsula far southwest of the oasis.

Birdsong Tower

Recommended level: 12
Recovery: Basement inn, 6G per person
Required item: Thief's Key
Fixed treasure: Strength Seed, 1,200G, Wing of Wyvern, Birdsong Nectar

Brey should reach level 11 and learn **Snowstorm** before the climb. The spell can erase dangerous groups, but it is expensive, so reserve it for combinations such as multiple Butterfly Dragons or Pteranodons. Cristo should preserve most of his MP for healing and poison removal.

Birdsong Tower Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Flythrope	34	35	47G	Appears in groups and can cast StopSpell; remove it before the casters are silenced.	Magic Potion
Poison Lizard	34	18	21G	Poison gas can affect several party members and drain Cristo's MP after battle.	Antidote Herb
Butterfly Dragon	47	38	60G	Frequent group fire breath makes several at once a Snowstorm target.	Wing of Wyvern
Razor Wind	41	32	34G	Can cast Infernos; concentrate damage rather than letting a group keep casting.	Boomerang
Spectet	35	31	62G	Valuable gold but sturdier than earlier field enemies.	Leather Hat
Grislysaber	29	30	46G	Resists direct attack magic and can call more of itself; use physical attacks.	Copper Sword
Pteranodon	41	36	50G	Firebal threatens the full party; use Snowstorm against dangerous groups.	Agility Seed
Crested Viper	31	18	25G	Poison and Defense remain dangerous; Bounce can punish its spell use.	Feather Hat

Enter the central room on 1F. The stairs down lead to the basement inn, which allows a full recovery without returning to the Bazaar. Return to 1F, circle clockwise around the floor, open the large door with the Thief's Key, and climb the stairs beyond it.

Treasure Detour

1. On 2F, walk west to the wall, then south.
2. Follow the bending southeast route to the stairs.
3. On the upper landing, walk north a few steps and then west. Continue north through the apparently closed end into the small treasure room.
4. Open both chests for a **Strength Seed** and **1,200G**.
5. Return to 2F and backtrack to the original stairs from 1F.

Route to the Summit

1. From the original 2F stair area, go east through the passage and immediately south.
2. Follow the path west, pass through the southern opening, then continue east to the stairs in the southeast corner.
3. On the next floor, go north through the opening and take the northwest chest containing a **Wing of Wyvern**.
4. Return toward the stairs, take the western route, then follow the narrow path clockwise around the open pit. Falling returns the party to a lower floor but does not lose treasure.
5. Climb the final stairs and follow the upper floor's linear path to the summit.

Approach the two dancing elves. They flee and leave the **Birdsong Nectar** in the small sandy patch where they were standing. The supplied walkthroughs disagree about which compass corner contains it, so do not rely on a directional label: use Search on the sand tiles until the nectar is found. It cannot be seen as a chest.

Use the tower's Wing of Wyvern or Brey's Return spell to leave, then return to Santeem Castle. Stand directly in front of the King and use the Birdsong Nectar from the item menu. His voice returns, he describes ominous dreams, and he finally permits Alena to continue traveling.

> **Achievement Alert: Speak No Evil**
> **Trigger:** Use the Birdsong Nectar on the King of Santeem and restore his voice.

The Road to Endor

Return to Frenor, travel south past the Golden Bracelet cave, and enter the shrine that was bypassed earlier. Step onto the travel door in the northern room. On the far side, leave the portal room and use the shrine inn if needed. Ragnar may appear here at night, providing an optional link to Chapter 1, but speaking with him is not required for progression.

Leave the shrine and follow the grass route southeast through the mountains to Endor. The enemies here are stronger than those west of the portal, so arrive with full HP and enough MP to reach the city safely.

Endor Region Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Armor Scorpion	40	38	44G	High Defense; use Sap before committing to physical damage.	Leather Armor
Skeleton	52	53	54G	Can cast Defense and turn a physical exchange against the party.	Iron Claw
Razor Wind	41	32	34G	Infernos pressures the whole party.	Boomerang
Rogue Knight	54	55	49G	Appears in groups and can summon Healers; control reinforcements first.	Chain Mail
Healer	16	7	11G	Remove it before it restores more valuable targets.	Medical Herb
Pteranodon	41	36	50G	Firebal remains the principal group threat.	Agility Seed
Metal Slime	4	1,350	5G	Extremely high Defense, immune to attack magic, and likely to flee. Have everyone attack; Alena's critical hit or Brey's dagger effect can secure the kill.	Golden Barrette

Metal Slimes are excellent experience but are not required for an achievement; the set's metal-monster achievement specifically requires a **King Metal** much later. Do not delay the tournament waiting for a rare Metal Slime victory.

Endor and Tournament Preparation

Recommended level: 12-13
Town inn: 6G per person
Tournament inn: 8G per person
Fixed pickup: Lifeforce Nuts
Mandatory purchase: Iron Claw, 1,500G

Explore Endor and speak with its residents. The casino is beneath the inn, but the achievement route defers serious gambling until Chapter 5. Do not spend the 1,500G reserved for Alena's Iron Claw or the money needed for healing and armor.

> **Achievement Setup: High Roller (deferred)**
> **Requirement:** Hold at least 10,000 Casino coins at once. The casino is available now, but the routed attempt occurs in Chapter 5 when the party has a stronger economy. Any optional play here must not endanger the Iron Claw purchase.

Enter Endor Castle through the central door and speak with the Princess, then the King. The winner of the tournament is expected to marry the Princess; Alena can nullify that outcome by winning herself.

Leave the castle and re-enter through its western door to reach the coliseum corridor. Before going north, enter the break in the west wall and walk south to the basement stairs. Open the lone chest for **Lifeforce Nuts**, then return to the corridor.

Endor Shops

Tier	General Shop	Cost	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Fill Alena's free tournament inventory slots.
Situational	Antidote Herb	10G	No longer central once Cristo knows Antidote.
Situational	Fairy Water	20G	Optional overworld convenience.
Situational	Wing of Wyvern	25G	Backup Return effect.
Situational	Full Moon Herb	30G	Useful reserve for later chapters.
High	Wooden Hat	120G	Buy for Cristo if he still lacks one.

Tier	Weapon Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Chain Sickle	550G	+20 attack	Alena is about to replace it permanently.
High	Venomous Dagger	750G	+24 attack	Good final Chapter 2 weapon for Brey.
Situational	Iron Spear	880G	+28 attack	Outclassed by the Morning Star for Cristo.
High	Morning Star	1,250G	+33 attack	Cristo's strongest conventional purchase here.
Skip	Abacus of Virtue	1,600G	+35 attack	Taloon-only equipment and unavailable to the current party.

Tier	Armor Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Situational	Chain Mail	350G	+18 defense	Budget armor if Alena or Cristo still needs it.
Situational	Bronze Armor	700G	+25 defense	Good on Cristo, but Half Plate Armor is the lasting target.
High	Half Plate Armor	1,200G	+30 defense	Cristo's best Chapter 2 body armor.

Tier	Armor Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Iron Apron	1,500G	+32 defense	Taloon-only equipment.
High	Scale Shield	180G	+7 defense	Efficient budget shield for either caster.
High	Iron Shield	650G	+12 defense	Cristo's strongest Chapter 2 shield if the budget remains after the Iron Claw.

Speak to the coliseum attendant, then enter the fighter's quarters to the left. This room has an inn, a House of Healing, and a temporary shop selling Medical Herbs for 8G and the **Iron Claw for 1,500G**. Buy and equip the Iron Claw before entering the tournament. It gives Alena +38 Attack, remains in her personal equipment when she returns in Chapter 5, and stays her best weapon well into that chapter. This is the last guaranteed Iron Claw: the temporary shop closes after the tournament, although Skeletons and Phantom Messengers can drop replacement copies later.

Move the Thief's Key and all nonessential items from Alena to Cristo or Brey. Fill Alena's remaining inventory slots with Medical Herbs, then rest and save. Cristo and Brey do not participate in the matches, so only Alena's equipment, HP, and inventory matter once the gauntlet begins.

Endor Tournament

The tournament is five consecutive solo battles. Alena can use items between matches, and Roric, Vivian, and Sampson can each leave a Medical Herb. If Alena needs healing and her inventory is full, consume an herb before accepting or advancing past the replacement so it is not lost.

Round	Opponent	HP	Behavior	Strategy
1	Hun	70	Straight physical offense.	Attack continuously and heal only if Alena cannot safely absorb another hit.
2	Roric	90	Attacks with a Boomerang and sometimes guards.	Keep attacking through guarded rounds; use a herb afterward if needed.
3	Vivian	90	Casts Firebal and Icebolt and can heal herself.	Maintain pressure so her healing does not extend the fight; do not wait too long to use a herb against spell damage.
4	Sampson	90	Stronger physical attacks than the earlier opponents.	Heal at a more conservative threshold and let the Iron Claw carry the damage race.
5	Linguar	55	Splits into one real body and three mirages each round.	There is no reliable pattern in the supplied guides; choose a target, endure misses, and heal based on HP rather than impatience.

At level 12 the sequence is possible; level 13 provides a safer HP and damage margin. The Iron Claw is more important than squeezing in another minor armor purchase. Alena's natural Agility and critical-hit rate can shorten any round, but the route does not rely on a critical hit.

After Linguar falls, the announcer calls for the reigning champion, Necrosaro. He does not appear, so Alena is declared the tournament winner without a sixth fight. There is no achievement at the moment of tournament victory; continue through the chapter-ending return sequence.

The Empty Castle

As Alena leaves Endor Castle, a Santeem soldier delivers an urgent warning and collapses. The supplied walk-throughs disagree on whether Return can be cast during this sequence: Ramina routes the party back with Return, while BTB and Dragon's Den report that the spell is unavailable. Try Return if Brey has enough MP; if the game rejects it, walk back through the travel-door route. Random encounters are suppressed during the return trip, so no additional combat preparation is required.

Enter Santeem Castle. The halls are empty. Inspect 1F, visit the throne room on 2F, and climb to Alena's bedroom on 3F so Cristo and Brey's comments establish that the entire court has vanished. Return to 1F and leave through the front entrance. Reaching Santeem alone does not close the chapter; exiting after the investigation does.

> **Achievement Alert: The Empty Castle**
> **Trigger:** Investigate the deserted Santeem Castle after winning the tournament, then leave through the front entrance to complete Chapter 2.

Chapter 2 Completion Check

- **Achievements:** Sneaking Out, The Offering, The Kidnapped Imposter, Speak No Evil, and The Empty Castle unlocked.
- **Party levels:** Approximately 12-13, with Brey at least level 11 for Snowstorm.
- **Alena:** Iron Claw and Feather Hat secured; the Iron Claw remains with her for Chapter 5 and cannot be purchased after the tournament.
- **Cristo:** Half Plate Armor and Iron Shield preferred; Morning Star if the chapter budget allowed it.
- **Brey:** Defensive equipment prioritized; Venomous Dagger is the preferred purchased weapon.
- **Inventory:** Unused Strength, Agility, and Lifeforce seeds retained for Chapter 5 allocation.
- **Carried forward:** Each character's levels and personal equipment, plus the separately tracked casino-coin balance.
- **Not carried forward:** Loose Chapter 2 gold.
- **Next chapter:** Taloon begins his career in Lakanaba.

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Chapter 3: Taloon's Road to Riches

Section Achievements: Chapter 3

Achievement	Points	Trigger	Route Notes
It's a Trap	5	Collect the Iron Safe and leave.	Bring a movable boulder into the treasure room, take the Iron Safe, reopen the sealed exit, and leave the cave with it.
The Architect	5	Repair the bridge to Endor.	Free Grandpa Tom's son, borrow Tov, expose Foxville's illusion, and return Da Gardi to Bonmalmo.
Moving In	5	Purchase the shop in Endor.	Obtain royal permission, sell the Silver Statuette, and pay 35,000G for the vacant shop.
The Traveling Merchant	10	Complete Chapter 3.	Fill the royal equipment order, fund the Endor-Branca tunnel, and exit through its Branca side.

Chapter 3 follows Taloon, an employee in Lakanaba's weapon shop who wants to own a store of his own. His route is built around commerce: working for wages, recognizing valuable merchandise, selling armor where demand is highest, recovering a rare statuette, and using his own shop to turn inventory into the money needed for two major investments.

Taloon has no spells and begins far less combat-ready than Ragnar or Alena. He compensates with high HP growth, broad equipment access, unusually frequent monster drops during his chapter, and random special actions in battle. Those actions cannot be selected directly, so the safe route still depends on armor, Medical Herbs, and optional hired companions.

The chapter's critical path is:

1. Work at Lakanaba's weapon shop, buy basic equipment, and learn about the Iron Safe.
2. Solve the Cave North of Lakanaba and leave with the Iron Safe.
3. Visit Foxville and Bonmalmo, free Grandpa Tom's son, and borrow his dog Tov.
4. Expose Foxville, free the architect Da Gardi, and reopen the bridge to Endor.
5. Deliver the Prince's Letter and Royal Scroll to prevent the war and earn permission to own a shop.
6. Recover and sell the Silver Statuette, then buy the vacant Endor shop for 35,000G.
7. Deliver seven Broad Swords and seven Half Plate Armors to the King for 60,000G.
8. Give the 60,000G to the tunnel builder, wait for construction to finish, and cross to Branca.

Chapter 3 Economy Plan

Chapter 3 has three required cash thresholds:

Goal	Required Amount	Reliable Source
Buy the Endor shop	35,000G	Sell the Silver Statuette for 25,000G, then raise the remaining 10,000G through Lakanaba wages, fixed treasure, premium armor sales, and monster drops.
Fill the royal order	22,400G purchase cost	Seven Broad Swords at 2,000G and seven Half Plate Armors at 1,200G; Neta's markup or repeated loot sales fund the order.

Goal	Required Amount	Reliable Source
Restart tunnel construction	60,000G	The King pays exactly 60,000G when the full equipment order is delivered.

The optional Sword of Malice route is the fastest money engine but depends on a customer offering one while Taloon works in Lakanaba. If that happens, buy it into the employer's stock and never sell it to another customer. Taloon can later purchase stocked copies for 3,500G and give them to Neta, who resells merchandise at a large markup. If it never appears, the chapter remains fully completable through fixed treasure, ordinary equipment trading, and monster drops.

The Iron Safe prevents Taloon from losing gold after defeat during this chapter. Obtain it before carrying serious money. It occupies one inventory slot, so dungeon-loot trips still require inventory planning even though the cash itself is protected.

Lakanaba: Working Capital

Starting level: 1
Free recovery: Sleep at Taloon's home
Fixed pickup: Medical Herb
Repeatable errand: Escort Grandpa Tom for 10G

Neta gives Taloon a **Lunch** before he leaves for work. It restores HP and can replace one early Medical Herb, and she supplies another after Taloon returns home for a new day. Go downstairs and search the far-left pot for a hidden **Medical Herb**.

North of the house, Grandpa Tom asks to be taken to the House of Healing. Walk into him to push him westward, steer him through the entrance, and receive **10G**. Leaving and re-entering Lakanaba resets this small errand, so it can provide emergency seed money, but weapon-shop wages are much faster.

Speak to the innkeeper to hear about an Iron Safe in the cave north of town. Then enter the weapon shop in the southwest and tell the owner that Taloon is ready to work. Customers either buy the shop's goods or offer equipment for the shop to purchase. Agree to ordinary sales because Taloon's end-of-day commission rises with his sales volume.

The shop always stocks Clubs, Copper Swords, and Thorn Whips. Boomerangs, Chain Sickles, and Swords of Malice appear only after a customer sells one to the store. If a **Sword of Malice** appears, accept it and refuse every later request to buy it; this preserves it in shop stock for Taloon's own purchase later. Do not wait indefinitely for the random offer.

Work roughly two days, or until Taloon can buy a Thorn Whip and basic armor. The owner normally pays about 100G per completed shift. Sleep at home for free, accept the next Lunch from Neta, and repeat only as long as the guaranteed upgrades are useful.

Lakanaba Services and Shops

Service	Cost	Route Use
Home rest	Free	Restores Taloon and starts another workday; Neta supplies a Lunch.
Weapon-shop shift	Time	Generates commission and may add customer-sold weapons to persistent shop stock.
Grandpa Tom escort	10G reward	Repeatable but much slower than working once the shop is available.

Tier	Item Shop	Cost	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Taloon has no healing magic; carry at least two before the cave.
Situational	Antidote Herb	10G	Carry one for extended field trips.
Skip	Fairy Water	20G	Early encounters provide needed levels, gold, and sellable drops.
Situational	Wing of Wyvern	25G	Buy one before the Bonmalmo jail sequence if no enemy has dropped one.

Tier	Weapon Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Situational	Club	30G	+7 attack	Cheapest way to begin damaging enemies, but the Thorn Whip is the better departure purchase.
Skip	Copper Sword	100G	+12 attack	Only a small bridge between the Club and Thorn Whip.
High	Thorn Whip	200G	+14 attack	Reliable pre-cave weapon; replace it with the free Chain Sickle inside.
Skip	Boomerang	350G	+18 attack	Random stock and too close to the free Chain Sickle to justify waiting for it.
Skip	Chain Sickle	550G	+20 attack	Random stock; a guaranteed copy is in the cave.
Optional	Sword of Malice	3,500G	+45 attack	Random stock. Excellent for Taloon and later shop profits, but never required for the route.

Tier	Armor Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Wayfarer's Clothes	70G	+7 defense	Cheap but quickly outclassed.
Situational	Leather Armor	180G	+12 defense	Safe minimum before the cave.
High	Chain Mail	350G	+18 defense	Stronger opening target if another work shift is acceptable.
High	Bronze Armor	700G	+25 defense	Best Lakanaba body armor and a lasting purchase, but not required before the first dungeon.
High	Leather Shield	90G	+4 defense	Efficient early protection.
High	Leather Hat	65G	+2 defense	Cheap enough to fill the helmet slot immediately.

Taloon begins in Basic Clothes and needs a weapon before field combat becomes efficient. The practical departure set is Thorn Whip, Leather Armor or Chain Mail, Leather Shield, Leather Hat, two Medical Herbs, and the current Lunch. Reach approximately level 3 around Lakanaba, rest at home, save, then travel northeast to the isolated cave on the northern cape.

Lakanaba Region Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Route Notes	Possible Drop
Slime	8	1	2G	Basic opening target once Taloon owns a weapon.	Medical Herb
Stag Beetle	9	1	4G	Low-risk source of early gold.	Medical Herb
Prank Gopher	10	2	4G	Basic physical attacker.	Medical Herb
Giant Worm	11	3	6G	Slightly more durable but still suitable for the opening loop.	Medical Herb

Cave North of Lakanaba

Recommended level: 3-4
Fixed treasure: Chain Sickle, Iron Safe
Critical warning: Bring a movable boulder into the Iron Safe room before taking the chest.

Puzzle rooms in this cave do not generate random encounters, so take time to position the boulders correctly. The monsters elsewhere are the same low-tier enemies found around Lakanaba.

Reservoir Route

1. From the entrance, walk west and descend the stairs.
2. Follow the linear passage until it reaches two stairways; both connect to the same route.
3. Examine the barrier holding back the first reservoir. The released water carries Taloon down to the next stairs, and this first mechanism resets when revisited.
4. Continue until reaching the second reservoir barrier.
5. Before opening it, walk west past the barrier and then north to the chest containing the **Chain Sickle**. Equip it immediately.
6. Return to the barrier and release the second reservoir. The water carries Taloon to the floor below; unlike the first mechanism, this change remains in place.

Rolling Boulder Puzzle

From the landing, walk north and take the western branch, then descend at its end. Ignore the nearby southern stairs and continue west to the wall holding a large boulder. Stand below the barrier and walk south to release it.

The boulder advances whenever Taloon moves. Keep it close enough to follow the turns without letting it roll onto the wrong line. Move east into the next corridor, south at the bend, then west at the first available branch. Continue to the western wall and step north. The boulder rolls south into the pit, creating a bridge. Cross it and descend to the bottom floor.

If the boulder misses the pit, use the nearby stairs to reset the puzzle room and try again. No treasure is lost.

Iron Safe Trap

Two small movable boulders are on the bottom floor. Use the leftmost one.

1. Push the boulder north along the passage toward the room containing the gray chest.
2. Stop with the boulder inside the room and directly south of the chest before touching the treasure.
3. Open the chest and take the **Iron Safe**. Removing it raises a wall over the doorway and reveals a floor switch where the chest stood.
4. Push the boulder north onto that switch. The wall lowers and Taloon can leave.

If Taloon takes the Iron Safe without bringing a boulder into the room, he cannot reach a boulder after the wall closes. Do not save after trapping him; reset and repeat the bottom-floor puzzle.

Retrace the cave route and step outside with the Iron Safe still in Taloon's inventory.

> **Achievement Alert: It's a Trap**
> **Trigger:** Take the Iron Safe, escape its sealed treasure room, and leave the cave. The achievement description is "Collect the Iron Safe and leave."

Return to Lakanaba, rest at home, and improve Taloon's armor if needed. Raise him to approximately level 5 or 6 before continuing southeast into the forest toward Foxville.

Foxville: The False Village

Recommended level: 5-6
Fixed treasure on first visit: None
Later reward: Full Plate Armor

Travel east from Lakanaba, then turn south into the forest and enter the isolated village. Follow the narrow northern approach into town. Speak with everyone, especially the architect Da Gardi in the southeast house. He is supposed to be repairing Bonmalmo's bridge but has become distracted by his new life here.

Foxville's shop is part of the illusion. A listed Medical Herb produces a Gum Pod, and the supposed 10G Broad Sword is only a Cypress Stick. Buy neither. The looping exit and the villagers' repeated mannerisms are further warnings that the town is not what it seems.

Enter the house behind the false shop and speak with the mayor. Accept his offer to stay overnight. Taloon wakes alone in the forest with Foxville gone. Continue southwest to Bonmalmo; the illusion cannot be broken permanently until Taloon returns with a dog that hunts foxes.

Foxville's False Shop

Listed Item	Listed Cost	Actual Result	Route Advice
Medical Herb	8G	Gum Pod	Skip; this is a deliberate swindle.
Broad Sword	10G	Cypress Stick	Skip; the real Broad Sword costs 2,000G.

Bonmalmo: Prisoner, Prince, and Bridge

Recommended level: 5-6 on arrival; 9-10 before crossing to Endor
Inn: 10G
Required item: Wing of Wyvern
Story items: Tov, Prince's Letter
Reward from Foxville: Full Plate Armor

Bonmalmo is preparing to invade Endor, but the broken southern bridge has stalled its army. The King hired Da Gardi to repair it, connecting the bridge problem to the architect trapped in Foxville.

Visit the castle and note three people:

- The armor buyer in the southwest pays more than ordinary shops for armor.
- Reed, the Prince of Bonmalmo, is in the northwest and asks Taloon to meet him behind the weapon shop at night.
- Grandpa Tom's son is imprisoned in the basement cell east of the stairs.

Buy a **Wing of Wyvern** before entering the jail if Taloon does not already carry one. The stairs to the jail are behind the throne room. Guards patrol the basement; wait until they turn away, then move to the eastern cell and talk through the bars. Give Grandpa Tom's son the Wing of Wyvern so he can escape to Lakanaba. Being spotted only resets Taloon's position, so watch the patrol pattern and try again rather than rushing.

Tier	Item Shop	Cost	Route Advice

Chapter 3 Bonmalmo Shops

Tier	Item Shop	Cost	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Taloon remains his own healer.
Situational	Antidote Herb	10G	Carry one on longer trips.
Skip	Fairy Water	20G	Field battles remain useful for drops and money.
Required	Wing of Wyvern	25G	One is consumed to free Grandpa Tom's son.

Tier	Weapon Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Copper Sword	100G	+12 attack	Weaker than the cave's Chain Sickle.
Skip	Boomerang	350G	+18 attack	Weaker than the cave's Chain Sickle.
Skip	Chain Sickle	550G	+20 attack	Taloon should already own the free one.
Situational	Iron Spear	880G	+28 attack	Useful guaranteed upgrade if no Sword of Malice entered Lakanaba stock.
Commerce	Broad Sword	2,000G	+40 attack	Too expensive for early combat needs, but this is the source for the later royal order.

The Bonmalmo armor buyer is not a normal equipment shop. Save armor drops and the coming Full Plate Armor for him rather than selling them elsewhere.

Tov and the Secret of Foxville

Return north to Lakanaba. Grandpa Tom's son now stands near his father's house and lets Taloon borrow **Tov**, his fox-hunting dog. Go directly back to Foxville. Tov runs to the mayor's house and exposes the mayor's true form.

Speak to the fox and let him go. He gives Taloon **Full Plate Armor** in exchange for his freedom. Taloon cannot equip it, so reserve it for Bonmalmo's premium armor buyer. With the illusion broken, Da Gardi leaves to complete the bridge assignment.

Return to Lakanaba and speak with Grandpa Tom's son if Tov has not already left Taloon, then travel back to Bonmalmo. Sell the Full Plate Armor to the southwest buyer and speak with the King. Once Da Gardi's return has been acknowledged, leave the castle and check the southern route: the bridge to Endor is repaired.

> **Achievement Alert: The Architect**
> **Trigger:** Expose Foxville with Tov, free Da Gardi, and speak with the King of Bonmalmo so the bridge to Endor is repaired.

Before crossing, finish the Prince's request. Speak with Reed in the castle during the day if he has not yet arranged the meeting. Wait until night, walk behind the weapon shop on the east side of town, and accept the **Prince's Letter**. It must be used while standing in front of the Princess of Endor.

Use the repaired bridge as the next leveling boundary. South of Bonmalmo, the encounter table becomes more demanding; bring Taloon toward level 9 or 10 before committing to the repeated trips between Endor and Bonmalmo.

Foxville and Bonmalmo Region Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Route Notes	Possible Drop
Slime	8	1	2G	Minimal threat.	Medical Herb
Stag Beetle	9	1	4G	Minimal threat.	Medical Herb
Prank Gopher	10	2	4G	Basic physical attacker.	Medical Herb
Giant Worm	11	3	6G	Basic physical attacker.	Medical Herb
Demon Stump	21	7	13G	Can use its carried herb to extend combat.	Medical Herb
Healer	16	7	11G	Concentrate attacks before repeated Heal casts prolong a group.	Medical Herb

Cross the repaired bridge and follow the river south to Endor.

Endor: Preventing the War

Recommended level: 9-10
Inn: 6G
Story items: Prince's Letter, Royal Scroll
Major objective: Permission to purchase a shop

Enter Endor Castle and stand directly in front of the Princess. Use the **Prince's Letter** from Taloon's inventory rather than merely talking to her. The King overhears the proposal and gives Taloon a **Royal Scroll** for the King of Bonmalmo.

Return north across the repaired bridge, stand before the King of Bonmalmo, and use the Royal Scroll. He abandons the invasion when he realizes the marriage offers access to Endor's wealth without a war. Travel back to Endor and speak to its King again. He rewards Taloon by granting permission to operate a shop in the city.

The vacant shop is in the southwest corner of Endor. Speak with its owner upstairs to learn the price: **35,000G**. The permission is only one half of the requirement; Taloon still needs the purchase money.

In the northeast house, an art collector offers **25,000G** for the Silver Statuette hidden in a cave northeast of Endor. That leaves a 10,000G funding gap. Before leaving, inspect the incomplete tunnel east of Endor, then continue north to the actual statuette cave. The tunnel is not the dungeon and cannot yet be crossed.

Endor Equipment Priorities

Tier	Item or Equipment	Cost	Power	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Restores about 30 HP	Keep several on Taloon because neither he nor Strom can heal.
Situational	Wing of Wyvern	25G	Return effect	Useful for repeated Endor, Bonmalmo, and Lakanaba trips.
Skip	Chain Sickle	550G	+20 attack	Already obtained in the Iron Safe cave.
Situational	Iron Spear	880G	+28 attack	Guaranteed upgrade if Taloon lacks the Sword of Malice; the statuette cave contains one.
Commerce	Morning Star	1,250G	+33 attack	Taloon cannot equip it; collect the free cave copy as sale stock.
Situational	Abacus of Virtue	1,600G	+35 attack	Taloon can equip it, but save cash until the shop is purchased.

Tier	Item or Equipment	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Situational	Bronze Armor	700G	+25 defense	Adequate for the cave if already owned.
High	Iron Apron	1,500G	+32 defense	Taloon's best Chapter 3 body armor, but the shop fund takes priority.
High	Iron Shield	650G	+12 defense	Taloon's best Chapter 3 shield.
High	Wooden Hat	120G	+6 defense	Taloon's best Chapter 3 helmet and inexpensive.

The casino below Endor's inn is closed at this stage. Ragnar can be found there, but he does not join Taloon and is not part of the chapter route.

Optional Hired Companions

The Cave of the Silver Statuette can be cleared alone, but Endor offers two temporary allies. Hire them immediately before leaving so their five-day contracts cover the dungeon rather than routine errands.

Companion	Location	Fee	Role
Strom	West side of Endor near the vacant shop	400G	Durable physical attacker who reduces pressure on Taloon.
Laurent	Second floor of the inn	600G	Uses a Venomous Dagger and can cast Sleep and Firebal.

Their fees are small compared with the 35,000G objective, and the extra actions make both ordinary encounters and Metal Slime attempts safer. Hire both for the first clear unless Taloon is already overleveled or the player wants a solo challenge.

Cave of the Silver Statuette

Recommended level: 11
Fixed treasure: Wing of Wyvern, Morning Star, 760G, Medical Herb, Iron Spear, Broad Sword, Half Plate Armor, Silver Statuette
Required action: Drain the upper reservoir to expose the lower routes

Clear inventory space before entering. Taloon has only eight personal item slots, and the Iron Safe plus equipped gear consume several of them. The route identifies two valuable chests that can deliberately remain unopened for Chapter 5.

Entry and Drainage Switch

1. Follow the entrance passage until reaching stairs beside a boat. Ignore the stairs and board the boat.
2. Follow the waterway into the dark opening and fall with the boat to the lower flooded level.
3. Disembark on the northern landing. Take the western branch to the chest containing a **Wing of Wyvern**.
4. Return east, continue to the far wall, then turn south around the raised platform.
5. Take the stairs in the southeast corner to the reservoir-control floor.
6. Follow the northern route and turn west at the split. Continue north to the floor switch.
7. Stand on the switch and answer **Yes**. The water drains from this floor and floods the level below, opening both its boat route and the remaining treasure ledges.

Drained-Floor Treasure

Backtrack from the switch and collect:

- **Morning Star** from the chest near the western return route. Taloon cannot equip it, so reserve it for sale.
- **760G** from the northern room.
- **Medical Herb** from the far southern chest.
- **Iron Spear** from the northeast chest.

The nearby western stairs provide the quickest exit to the cave entrance after the statuette is secured.

Flooded-Level Treasure and the Statuette

Descend the newly exposed southeast stairs and board the waiting boat. Sail north, turn west, pass the opening to the north, and continue south into the isolated room containing a **Broad Sword**. The chest in the northwest portion of the flooded level contains **Half Plate Armor**.

The two adjacent chests in the top-right area of B3 are empty. They have separate opened flags but contain no items, so the efficient route can skip them.

Neither item is usable by Taloon. The long-term route leaves both chests unopened so the Chapter 5 party can collect the +40 Broad Sword and +30 Half Plate Armor directly. If Taloon is still well short of 35,000G and the player prefers less grinding now, collecting and selling them is valid, but it exchanges future equipment for only 2,400G of normal resale value.

Return to the boat and sail into the north-central room. Land on the decorated platform, descend the stairs, and follow the final passage north to the chest containing the **Silver Statuette**. Backtrack to the drained-floor western stairs and leave the cave. A Wing of Wyvern can shorten the return to Endor once Taloon is outside.

Statuette Cave Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Elefrover	28	14	18G	Straightforward physical threat; useful source of sellable armor.	Dancer's Costume
Sand Master	30	22	27G	Appears in groups and can reduce MP; harmless to Taloon's nonexistent MP but more relevant to Laurent.	Basic Clothes
Vampire Bat	25	11	23G	May begin confused and attack its allies; leave it alone while it remains helpful.	Agility Seed
Flythrope	34	35	47G	Can cast StopSpell, principally affecting Laurent.	Magic Potion
Ducksbill	22	14	10G	Sap lowers Defense and increases the risk to Taloon.	Leather Shield
Poison Lizard	34	18	21G	Poison gas can affect the group; carry an Antidote Herb for Taloon.	Antidote Herb
Giant Bantam	31	20	9G	Sleep attacks can remove Taloon's turn.	Medical Herb
Metal Slime	4	1,350	5G	Extremely high Defense and likely to flee. Have every available ally attack; do not risk the expedition chasing one.	Golden Barrette

Selling the Statuette and Buying the Shop

Return to the collector upstairs in Endor's northeast house and sell the Silver Statuette for **25,000G**. Taloon now needs another 10,000G.

Use the safest available combination:

1. Sell the Full Plate Armor to Bonmalmo's premium buyer if it is still in Taloon's inventory.
2. Sell the cave's Morning Star. Equip the Iron Spear if Taloon lacks a Sword of Malice; otherwise sell it as well.
3. Sell ordinary monster drops and work additional Lakanaba shifts.
4. Revisit the statuette cave for battles and any treasure intentionally chosen for current funding rather than Chapter 5.

The Iron Safe makes deliberate defeat a possible return shortcut without losing gold, but it is not required and still leaves Taloon needing revival. A Wing of Wyvern is cleaner when available.

Once Taloon holds at least 35,000G, go to the vacant shop in southwest Endor, climb upstairs, and pay the owner. Neta and the couple's child relocate from Lakanaba, and Neta begins operating the new store.

> **Achievement Alert: Moving In**
> **Trigger:** Pay 35,000G for the vacant Endor shop and complete the family move. The achievement description is "Purchase the shop in Endor."

Speaking with Neta from behind the counter now provides free rest. She also accepts merchandise, sells it during the next business day at a markup, and gives Taloon the proceeds. This is the point where the chapter's scalable money engine becomes available.

The Royal Equipment Order

Return to Endor Castle and speak with the King after buying the shop. He orders **seven Broad Swords and seven Half Plate Armors** for the royal guard and promises 60,000G when the order is complete. Deliver equipment to the guard in the small northeast room on 1F; he accepts partial shipments and reports how many pieces remain.

Order Item	Quantity	Purchase Location	Unit Cost	Total Cost
Broad Sword	7	Bonmalmo weapon shop	2,000G	14,000G
Half Plate Armor	7	Endor armor shop	1,200G	8,400G
Complete order	**14 pieces**			**22,400G**

Do not hand order stock to Neta by mistake. Equipment given to the castle guard counts toward the contract; equipment given to Neta becomes shop merchandise and must be replaced.

Reliable Profit Loop

Neta sells merchandise above normal retail value. Use the following loop regardless of whether Lakanaba stocked a Sword of Malice:

1. Give Neta one or more valuable weapons or armor pieces from behind the counter.
2. Leave Endor and remain outside until night.
3. Return to the shop and sleep upstairs.
4. Speak with Neta from behind the counter the next morning. First complete the merchandise prompt, then collect the previous day's proceeds.
5. Reinvest the profit into additional order pieces or high-value merchandise and repeat.

If the Sword of Malice entered Lakanaba's stock, buy as many 3,500G copies as Taloon can carry. Neta commonly sells each for roughly 5,000G or more, making this the fastest loop. If it never appeared, use Broad Swords, Half Plate Armors, fixed cave loot, and monster drops instead. The guaranteed route is slower but does not depend on a random customer.

The statuette cave remains a good source of both battles and equipment drops. Preserve the unopened Broad Sword and Half Plate Armor for Chapter 5 if possible; the royal order can be filled entirely with purchased copies, and unopened treasure remains available to the reunited party.

Deliver the order in batches as inventory fills. When the seventh sword and seventh armor are accepted, the castle pays Taloon **60,000G**. Do not spend this payment: it is exactly the amount required for the tunnel.

Endor-Branca Tunnel and Casino

Recommended level: 12-13
Required investment: 60,000G
Chapter exit: Cross the completed tunnel and climb the stairs on the Branca side

Leave Endor by the eastern bridge and enter the first cave on the route toward the statuette dungeon. Follow its unfinished passage to the old builder and give him all **60,000G**. Speak with him once more, leave the tunnel, and allow approximately one in-game day to pass.

> **Achievement Setup: Tunnel Rat (deferred)**
> Taloon's investment creates the tunnel required by this achievement, but it does not unlock during Chapter 3. The Hero will return in Chapter 5 and use the completed passage when its traveler count reaches the achievement condition.

Re-enter the tunnel after a day. Workers should now be present. Speak with the builder and the workers; one reports that Endor's casino has reopened. Return to Endor and check with Neta as the construction advances. When she says the tunnel is complete, the chapter exit is ready.

The casino beneath Endor's inn is optional. During Chapter 3, one coin costs **200G**, an extremely poor exchange rate. Taloon can use the shared coin balance established in Chapter 2, but the achievement route still postpones the serious grind until Chapter 5.

Casino Prize	Coin Cost	Chapter 3 Advice
Magic Potion	30	Skip; common recovery is not worth the Chapter 3 exchange rate.

Casino Prize	Coin Cost	Chapter 3 Advice
Wizard's Ring	500	Useful reusable MP recovery, but Taloon cannot benefit directly.
Staff of Jubilation	1,000	Optional future caster equipment.
Mirror of Ra	2,500	Optional; not required for the chapter route.
Meteorite Armband	4,000	Strong long-term prize, but easier to pursue in Chapter 5.
Metal Babble Shield	50,000	Excellent caster defense and far beyond the efficient Chapter 3 target.

Achievement Setup: High Roller (deferred)
The achievement requires a balance of at least 10,000 Casino coins. Do not buy coins at 200G each solely for this achievement. Preserve any existing balance and complete the routed poker grind in Chapter 5.

Final Inventory Conversion

Once the tunnel is complete, Taloon no longer needs combat equipment in this chapter. Ordinary gold will not transfer to the united party, but carried equipment will. Convert remaining profits before crossing the tunnel.

The maximum-value route uses the seven inventory slots not occupied by the Iron Safe:

- If available, buy **seven Swords of Malice** for 24,500G total. Their normal resale value is 2,625G each, giving the Chapter 5 party 18,375G of portable value.
- Otherwise, buy **seven Broad Swords** for 14,000G total. Their normal resale value is 1,500G each, giving the Chapter 5 party 10,500G.
- If Taloon will be used immediately when recruited, keep his best equipment instead of maximizing cargo. The recommended equipped set is Abacus of Virtue / Iron Apron / Iron Shield / Wooden Hat.

Only strip Taloon's equipment after all Chapter 3 combat is complete. Any gold left after filling his inventory can be converted into casino coins, but the 200G rate makes this a last resort rather than the primary carryover plan.

Return home and speak with Neta before leaving. Once she confirms that the passage is open, say goodbye, rest for free, and save. Enter the tunnel east of Endor, follow its now-complete linear route, and climb the stairs at the Branca end.

Achievement Alert: The Traveling Merchant
Trigger: Exit the completed Endor-Branca tunnel on the far side and complete Chapter 3.

Chapter 3 Completion Check

- **Achievements:** It's a Trap, The Architect, Moving In, and The Traveling Merchant unlocked.
- **Taloon:** Approximately level 12-13, with all required combat finished before inventory conversion.
- **Business:** Endor shop purchased and royal order completed.
- **Infrastructure:** Endor-Branca tunnel funded, completed, and crossed.
- **Chapter 5 setup:** Tunnel Rat prerequisite established; any unopened Broad Sword and Half Plate Armor remain in the statuette cave.
- **Portable value:** Remaining inventory converted to Swords of Malice, Broad Swords, or Taloon's preferred equipment.
- **Carried forward:** Taloon's level and personal inventory, plus the shared casino-coin balance.
- **Not carried forward:** Loose Chapter 3 gold.
- **Next chapter:** Nara and Mara begin their search for their father's killer in Monbaraba.

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Chapter 4: The Sisters of Monbaraba

Section Achievements: Chapter 4

Achievement	Points	Trigger	Route Notes
Private Dance	5	Try Pufpuf	Recruit Orin, return to Monbaraba at night, and accept the dancing girl's offer in the bar while a male companion is present.
Edgar's Pupil	5	Get Orin to join your party	Find Orin beside the Lamp of Darkness in the Cave West of Kievs and speak with him.
Refugees	10	Complete Chapter 4	Defeat Balzack, survive the forced Keeleon defeat and prison escape, then sail from Haville.

Chapter 4 follows Nara and Mara, sisters from Kievs who have spent years seeking Balzack, the former pupil who murdered their father Edgar and stole his research into the Secret of Evolution. Nara is the steadier healer and support caster; Mara supplies fire magic and Sap. Both begin fragile and MP-dependent, so their route rewards defensive equipment, deliberate spell use, and the early recruitment of a physical companion.

The chapter's critical path is:

1. Finish Mara's last performance in Monbaraba, collect the town's hidden items, and equip both sisters.
2. Visit their home village of Kievs and follow the lead to Edgar's surviving pupil.
3. Explore the Cave West of Kievs, recover the Lamp of Darkness and Sphere of Silence, and recruit Orin.
4. Return to Monbaraba with Orin for the earliest `Private Dance` opportunity.
5. Investigate Keeleon Castle and Haville to learn how the Counselor's fear reveals the hidden throne room.
6. Enter Aktemto Mine and recover the Gunpowder Jar.
7. Frighten the Counselor, follow him to the concealed switch, and defeat Balzack.
8. Accept the forced defeat against Keeleon, escape prison with the Boarding Pass, and sail from Haville.

Chapter 4 Party Development Plan

Character	Chapter Role	Important Spell Levels	Development Priority
Nara	Healing, status control, and wind offense	Heal 1, Sleep 5, Infernos 8, NumbOff 10, Healmore 13	Protect her MP for healing, improve her armor first, and give her the Morning Star for reliable physical turns.
Mara	Fire offense and Defense reduction	Blaze 1, Sap 3, Firebal 7, Return 8, Outside 9, Bang 11	Protect her low HP, use Sap to enable Orin, and preserve enough MP to leave Aktemto Mine with Outside.
Orin	Temporary physical front line and lock breaker	No spells	Recruit as soon as possible; let him absorb attacks and handle routine physical damage while the sisters conserve MP.

Nara and Mara retain their levels and personal equipment when they return in Chapter 5. Orin is temporary and cannot be equipped or directly controlled. Loose Chapter 4 gold does not carry forward, so Haville becomes the final conversion point before boarding the ship.

Monbaraba: Final Performance

Starting level: 1
Inn: 3G per person
Starting payment: 100G
Fixed pickups: Medical Herb, Strength Seed

Watch Mara's performance in the theater. The owner pays the sisters **100G** afterward. Once Nara is under player control, search the top pot in their house for a hidden **Medical Herb**.

Explore Monbaraba and speak with its residents during both day and night. The nightlife provides additional information about Edgar and Balzack. In the theater basement, enter the rear room and search the **third dresser from the left** for a **Strength Seed**. Keep it unused for Chapter 5 allocation.

The sisters need armor more urgently than weapons. Nara can contribute with her starting attack and Heal, while Mara's early value comes from Blaze and Sap. Selling their starting Silk Robe and Dancer's Costume can help fund two Leather Dresses, but only do so when the replacements are purchased immediately.

Monbaraba Shops

Tier	Weapon or Supply	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Club	30G	+7 attack	Minimal upgrade.
Skip	Copper Sword	100G	+12 attack	Nara can use it, but better weapons become available shortly.
Situational	Thorn Whip	200G	+14 attack	Useful early Mara weapon if gold remains after armor.
High	Boomerang	350G	+18 attack	Equippable by either sister, but buy only after their defenses are stable.
High	Medical Herb	8G	Restores about 30 HP	Carry emergency healing outside Nara's MP pool.

Tier	Armor	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Wayfarer's Clothes	70G	+7 defense	Too small an improvement.
Skip	Silk Robe	110G	+10 defense	Starting gear can help fund the better option.
High	Leather Dress	250G	+14 defense	Best body armor sold in Monbaraba; obtain one for each sister.
High	Leather Hat	65G	+2 defense	Cheap protection until Kievs sells Feather Hats.

Train near town until both sisters are approximately level 4. Rest whenever MP becomes low rather than continuing with only weak physical attacks. Follow the road north from Monbaraba, pass the sign, and enter Kievs.

Monbaraba and Kievs Region Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Red Slime	10	2	5G	Low-risk opening target.	Medical Herb
Kaskos Hopper	8	1	2G	Lowest-HP enemy in the region.	Medical Herb
Monjar	10	3	8G	Basic physical threat.	Medical Herb
Troglodyte	13	4	10G	More pressure on an unarmored Mara than its HP suggests.	Medical Herb

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Rabidhound	23	7	20G	Stronger than the surrounding enemies; use Sap and focused attacks.	Wing of Wyvern
Angel Head	14	7	11G	Prioritize it when its status pressure interferes with casting.	Antidote Herb
Sizarmage	17	11	13G	Can cast Blaze; remove it before repeated spell damage accumulates.	Cypress Stick
Minon	16	5	18G	Straightforward target and useful source of travel items.	Wing of Wyvern

Kievs: Edgar's Home

Recommended level: 4 on arrival; 6-7 before the cave
Inn: Free
Fixed pickup: Lifeforce Nuts

The innkeeper recognizes Edgar's daughters and lets them rest for free, making Kievs the chapter's best early leveling base. Speak with everyone to learn that Edgar discovered the Secret of Evolution, attempted to destroy it, and had another pupil named Orin who may be hiding in the cave west of town.

Enter Edgar's house in the northeast and search the pots for **Lifeforce Nuts**. Save them for the reunited party. The chest in the basement of the northeast house is empty; the basement otherwise contains only story context. At night, a friendly Slime appears in town for optional dialogue.

Kievs Shop

Tier	Item or Equipment	Cost	Power	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Restores about 30 HP	Keep one on Mara in case Nara is disabled.
High	Antidote Herb	10G	Cures poison	Neither sister has Antidote during the cave's recommended level range. Carry several.
Situational	Wing of Wyvern	25G	Return effect	Provides a quick return after leaving the cave.
Skip	Leather Dress	250G	+14 defense	Buy only if a sister still lacks one.
High	Feather Hat	280G	+8 defense	Best Chapter 4 helmet for both sisters.
High	Chain Sickle	550G	+20 attack	Nara can equip it; Mara cannot. Skip if saving directly for Nara's Morning Star.

Raise both sisters to level 6 or 7. Cross the bridge north of Kievs, travel west, then cross the next bridge south to the cave entrance.

Cave West of Kievs

Recommended level: 6-7
Fixed treasure: Wing of Wyvern, Lamp of Darkness, 240G, Lifeforce Nuts, Sphere of Silence
Optional recruit: Orin

The cave is long enough to exhaust an undisciplined spell budget. Nara should reserve MP for Heal, while Mara uses Blaze or Firebal only against groups that threaten more damage than basic attacks can manage. Neither sister is expected to know Outside at the recommended entry level, so plan to walk back out.

Route to the Lamp and Orin

1. Follow the opening passage until a northern side room appears. It contains only an NPC, so continue west on the main route.
2. At the next branch, go north to the chest containing a **Wing of Wyvern**.
3. Return to the main route, continue east, then turn north at the apparent dead end and step on the yellow elevator switch.
4. On the next floor, walk south, pass west through the columns, circle north around the small pool, and enter the western room.
5. Use that room's elevator to descend again.
6. On the lower floor, walk east to the wall, turn south, and cross the long bridge west.
7. Open the chest for the **Lamp of Darkness**, then speak with Orin beside it and accept his help.

> **Achievement Alert: Edgar's Pupil**
> **Trigger:** Speak with Orin beside the Lamp of Darkness and have him join the party. The achievement description is "Get Orin to join your party."

Orin acts independently, cannot receive equipment, and immediately changes the party's risk profile. Let him handle routine physical offense while Nara and Mara preserve MP. His strength also enables him to break locked doors during the coming Keeleon investigation.

Route to the Sphere of Silence

Return by elevator to the floor with the pool. Walk east from the pool and turn south. At the fork:

1. Take the western branch to the chest containing **240G**.
2. Backtrack and take the eastern branch south.
3. Enter the room to the east and open the chest for **Lifeforce Nuts**.
4. Return to the main path and continue south to the next elevator.
5. Follow the short passage on the new floor to another elevator.
6. At the bottom, walk north and follow the western path to the lone chest containing the **Sphere of Silence**.

The Sphere is the intended answer to Balzack's spellcasting. Keep it in Nara or Mara's inventory and do not sell it. Backtrack through the elevators to the entrance, then use the Wing of Wyvern outside or return on foot to Kievs.

Cave West of Kievs Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Lava Doll	15	12	17G	Small but more dangerous in groups; conserve spells only when the group is controlled.	Magic Potion
Sizarmage	17	11	13G	Blaze works against the sisters; focus it early.	Cypress Stick
Demon Toadstool	19	6	15G	Can poison, and neither sister has Antidote yet.	Medical Herb
Blazeghost	12	6	16G	Resists Blaze and may split after physical hits; Firebal remains effective.	Fairy Water
Troglodyte	13	4	10G	Basic physical threat.	Medical Herb

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Magemonja	25	18	30G	Casts Icebolt; reduce its turns before spell damage accumulates.	Leather Hat
Xemime	20	15	28G	No special route concern beyond its improved durability.	Wooden Hat

Return to Monbaraba: Private Dance

The `Private Dance` interaction requires a male character in the party, so Nara and Mara cannot trigger it alone. Orin provides the earliest opportunity. Return to Monbaraba after recruiting him; walk back through Kievs or use Return once Mara has learned it.

Make it night with the Lamp of Darkness if necessary, enter Monbaraba's bar, and speak with the dancing girl. Accept her free private dance and allow the scene to finish.

> **Achievement Alert: Private Dance** – Needs correction, cannot be achieved in chapter 4.
> **Trigger:** Accept the Monbaraba dancing girl's Puff-Puff offer while Orin is accompanying the sisters.

This detour is easiest now because the Lamp guarantees nighttime and Orin will leave near the end of the chapter. Rest in Monbaraba or at Kievs, then travel north and slightly east of Kievs to Keeleon Castle.

Keeleon Castle: First Investigation

Recommended level: 8
Fixed treasure: None on this visit
Required companion: Orin

The castle's doors are locked, but Orin forces them open. Explore both floors and speak with everyone. The new ruler occupies a throne room that cannot be reached through any visible doorway, and the Counselor sits in a room in the southeast corner of 1F.

The important clues are:

- Balzack has become the ruler associated with Keeleon's experiments.
- The Counselor knows the route to the concealed throne room.
- He panics at loud noises and previously imprisoned someone for frightening him.

Remember the Counselor's room and the dead-end passage beside it. The route cannot advance until the sisters obtain a suitable noisemaker. Leave the castle and walk north to Haville.

Chapter 4 Keeleon Region Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Lava Doll	15	12	17G	Low HP, but groups can tax the sisters' resources.	Magic Potion
Magemonja	25	18	30G	Casts Icebolt; prioritize it when several casters appear.	Leather Hat
Liclick	43	28	61G	Can cast Surround; use Mara's group magic if physical accuracy falls.	Cypress Stick
Zappersaber	30	25	18G	A sturdier physical enemy with a useful status-curing drop.	Full Moon Herb

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Xemime	20	15	28G	Common in groups but has no special route concern.	Wooden Hat
Infurnus Beetle	20	16	21G	Can emit fireballs against the group.	Club
King Slime	150	100	150G	Forms from a large Slime group, opens with FendSpell, and can reduce a target to critical HP. Use Sap or Sleep before FendSpell when possible.	Mystic Acorns

Haville: Finding the Noisemaker

Recommended level: 9-10
Inn: 6G per person
Fixed treasure: None

Haville is the chapter's equipment hub and eventual escape port. Speak with the townspeople to learn that ships leave for Endor. More importantly, visit the jail and question the prisoner who previously frightened Keeleon's Counselor. He used a **Gunpowder Jar** taken from Aktemto Mine, identifying the next required item.

Upgrade the sisters before traveling west. Nara benefits most from sustained defense because she must remain alive to heal; Mara needs enough protection to survive while casting. Orin's fixed equipment cannot be changed.

Haville Shops

Tier	Item Shop	Cost	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Keep one on Mara as emergency healing.
Situational	Antidote Herb	10G	The mine's gas is story atmosphere, not a poison hazard, but some field enemies can still poison.
Skip	Fairy Water	20G	The party still needs levels before Balzack.
Situational	Wing of Wyvern	25G	Quick return after leaving the mine.
Situational	Full Moon Herb	30G	Carry one if paralysis has disrupted recent fights.

Tier	Weapon Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Chain Sickle	550G	+20 attack	Nara should save for the Morning Star.
Skip	Iron Fan	620G	+22 attack	Mara can equip it, but the Venomous Dagger is stronger.
High	Venomous Dagger	750G	+24 attack	Best dependable Chapter 4 weapon for Mara.
High	Morning Star	1,250G	+33 attack	Nara's strongest practical Chapter 4 weapon.
Situational	Poison Needle	1,300G	+1 attack	Mara can use its instant-defeat chance, but it is unreliable for the required route.

Tier	Armor Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Leather Dress	250G	+14 defense	Already outclassed if the Monbaraba route was followed.
High	Fur Coat	600G	+22 defense	Strong general-purpose body armor for Mara.
High	Half Plate Armor	1,200G	+30 defense	Nara's best Chapter 4 body armor.
Skip	Leather Shield	90G	+4 defense	Save for the Scale Shield.

Tier	Armor Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
High	Scale Shield	180G	+7 defense	Efficient protection for Nara; Mara cannot equip it.
High	Feather Hat	280G	+8 defense	Best Chapter 4 helmet for both sisters.

The preferred end-of-chapter sets are **Morning Star / Half Plate Armor / Scale Shield / Feather Hat** for Nara and **Venomous Dagger / Fur Coat / Feather Hat** for Mara.

Before going to Aktemto, visit the House of Prophecy on the small peninsula west of Haville. The nun's vision is optional foreshadowing rather than a progression gate. Leave the shrine and continue northwest to Aktemto.

Aktemto and the Mine

Recommended level: 12-13
Inn: 8G per person
Fixed treasure: Mystic Acorns, Silver Tarot Cards, Gunpowder Jar
Exit plan: Mara's Outside spell

Aktemto is being poisoned by gas from its mine. Speak with the residents, rest, and save before descending at the north end of town. Mara should know **Outside at level 9** and **Bang at level 11**; Nara should be approaching **Healmore at level 13**. Preserve enough MP for healing and one Outside cast.

Mine Route

1. Enter the mine and immediately walk east to the chest containing **Mystic Acorns**.
2. Return to the route north. At the first split, go east and continue north to the wall.
3. Turn east, then north again. At the next split, go west and north to the chest containing the **Silver Tarot Cards**.
4. Backtrack to the split and take the eastern route to the ladder.
5. On the next floor, travel north as far as possible, then turn east to another ladder.
6. On the lowest required floor, speak with the miners and open the nearby chest for the **Gunpowder Jar**.

Do not equip or use the Silver Tarot Cards during the required route. Their random battle effects are less dependable than Nara's Morning Star, and they retain value for Chapter 5. Use Outside after securing the Gunpowder Jar unless the party deliberately wants more experience on the return climb.

Aktemto Region and Mine Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Weretiger	50	30	50G	Its roar can steal a character's turn; focus it when paired with casters.	Wayfarer's Clothes
Mad Clown	36	27	52G	Casts Firebal; eliminate groups before repeated spell damage accumulates.	Lifeforce Nuts
Brahmird	20	7	17G	May begin asleep; do not wake it before active threats are controlled.	Strength Seed
Zappersaber	30	25	18G	Straightforward physical pressure.	Full Moon Herb
Viceter	35	43	18G	Appears in groups and can summon reinforcements; use Firebal, Bang, or Infernos.	Medical Herb
Dark Doriard	28	25	30G	Can cast Sleepmore and disrupt the party.	Wooden Hat
Rogue Wisper	40	20	28G	Resists Mara's fire magic; Nara's Infernos and physical attacks are safer.	Fairy Water

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Vampdog	38	36	24G	Durable enough to justify focused attacks.	Thorn Whip
Garcoil Rooster	52	50	51G	High HP but no special route mechanic.	Feather Hat
Baby Salamand	40	59	58G	Fireball breath threatens the full party.	Medical Herb
Metal Scorpion	42	39	38G	High Defense; use Sap or direct magic.	Scale Shield
Vileplant	37	40	34G	Treat groups as spell targets before they overwhelm the sisters.	Luck Seed

Return to Haville after leaving the mine. Restore HP and MP, verify the Sphere of Silence and Gunpowder Jar are in the sisters' inventories, and save before returning south to Keeleon Castle.

Keeleon Castle: Balzack

Recommended level: 13
Required items: Gunpowder Jar, Sphere of Silence
Recovery: Haville immediately before entry
Outcome: Balzack victory followed by a scripted loss to Keeleon

Enter the castle and go to the southeast corner of 1F. Take the narrow dead-end passage beside the Counselor's room and use the **Gunpowder Jar**. The blast sends the Counselor toward the hidden throne room.

Follow at a distance. If the sisters get too close, the Counselor stops rather than revealing the entrance. Remain behind the corner while he crosses the northern hall and disappears through the wall. Search the wall where he vanished, press the concealed switch, and enter the throne room. Heal before speaking with Balzack.

Boss: Balzack

Preparation	Recommendation
Level	13
Party	Nara / Mara / Orin
Opening item	Sphere of Silence
Key spells	Healmore or Heal, Sap, Firebal or Bang
HP threshold	Keep both sisters above roughly 20 HP and heal earlier after heavy damage.

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Known Threats	Drop
Balzack	240	500	0G	Strong physical attacks, Firebal, and fire breath.	None required

Have Nara or Mara use the **Sphere of Silence on the first round** to block Balzack's spellcasting. It does not stop his physical attacks or fire breath, so Nara must continue monitoring the entire party. Mara should cast Sap until Orin and Nara can deal reliable physical damage, then use Firebal or Bang when healing is covered. Orin attacks automatically and should provide most of the sustained damage.

Do not conserve MP for after this victory; the following sequence restores the party before its scripted outcome. Once Balzack's 240 HP are depleted, the party receives **500 EXP**.

Scripted Battle: Keeleon

Keeleon appears immediately after Balzack. This battle is intentionally unwinnable. Do not consume rare items, reset, or grind because the party is defeated quickly; let the scripted loss proceed. The story continues in the castle prison rather than producing a normal game over.

Prison Escape and Orin's Stand

The sisters awaken in a cell beneath Keeleon Castle. Speak with the old prisoner, then pass through the opening in the wall into the adjoining escape route. Open the chest for the **Boarding Pass**.

Follow the passage toward the surface. Guards discover the escape, and Orin remains behind to hold them off while Nara and Mara flee. He leaves the party permanently here, so `Private Dance` should already be complete.

Travel north to Haville. No additional boss blocks the port, but do not board until the chapter-end inventory is ready.

Haville Departure

The ship leaves from the northwest port. Before showing the Boarding Pass, spend remaining gold on equipment or sellable items because loose Chapter 4 gold will not carry into Chapter 5.

Prioritize:

1. Nara's Half Plate Armor, Scale Shield, Feather Hat, and Morning Star.
2. Mara's Fur Coat, Feather Hat, and Venomous Dagger.
3. Extra Half Plate Armor or another high-value item for the Hero's early Chapter 5 equipment.
4. Medical Herbs only after durable equipment and portable value are covered.

Keep the Silver Tarot Cards and unused stat items. The Sphere of Silence used in this chapter does not remove the need to recover it again during Chapter 5; that later retrieval will be called out before Esturk's Palace.

Enter the northwest port and speak to the deckhand, who accepts the **Boarding Pass**. Once aboard, talk to every passenger, then speak with the captain. His confirmation is the point of no return. Agree to depart for Endor.

> **Achievement Alert: Refugees**
> **Trigger:** Set sail from Haville after the Keeleon prison escape and complete Chapter 4.

Chapter 4 Completion Check

- **Achievements:** Private Dance, Edgar's Pupil, and Refugees unlocked.
- **Party levels:** Approximately level 13, with Mara knowing Outside and Bang and Nara at or near Healmore.
- **Nara equipment:** Morning Star / Half Plate Armor / Scale Shield / Feather Hat preferred.
- **Mara equipment:** Venomous Dagger / Fur Coat / Feather Hat preferred.
- **Inventory:** Silver Tarot Cards and unused Mystic Acorns, Strength Seed, and Lifeforce Nuts retained.
- **Story items:** Gunpowder Jar consumed; Boarding Pass used; Sphere of Silence must be reacquired in Chapter 5.
- **Temporary companion:** Orin leaves during the Keeleon escape.
- **Carried forward:** Nara and Mara's levels and ordinary personal inventory.
- **Not carried forward:** Loose Chapter 4 gold.
- **Next chapter:** The Hero's journey begins, and the four earlier parties start converging.

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Chapter 5 Begins: The Hero, Endor, and the Wagon

Section Achievements: Chapter 5 Opening

Achievement	Points	Trigger	Route Notes
Tunnel Rat	5	Be the 1000th person to use the new tunnel	Cross Taloon's completed Endor-Branca tunnel for the first time as the Hero.
Hidden Treasure - Endor	5	Find the hidden treasure in Endor	Open the concealed Lifeforce Nuts chest below the western coliseum approach; if it was opened in Chapter 2, verify that the achievement already unlocked.
Caravan	10	Acquire the wagon	Recover the Symbol of Faith from the Cave of Betrayal and show it to Hector at the Desert Inn.

Chapter 5 begins the continuous main quest. The Hero starts alone at level 1, while the characters developed during Chapters 1-4 retain their levels and ordinary personal equipment until they rejoin. This opening section reunites the Hero with Nara and Mara, introduces the tactics system, and secures the wagon that will eventually carry the larger cast.

The section's critical path is:

1. Complete the opening events in the hidden village and salvage its remaining items.
2. Equip and level the Hero around the Woodman's Shack and Branca.
3. Cross Taloon's completed tunnel to Endor and complete the delayed `Tunnel Rat` setup.
4. Verify Endor's hidden Lifeforce Nuts chest, then recruit Nara and Mara.
5. Recover any useful Chapter 3 treasure left in the Silver Statuette cave or purchase equivalent Hero equipment.
6. Return through Branca and meet Hector at the Desert Inn.
7. Clear the Cave of Betrayal's solo encounters, recover the Symbol of Faith, and acquire the wagon.

The Hero's Hometown

Starting level: 1
Starting equipment: Copper Sword, Basic Clothes
Fixed pickups: Medical Herb, Feather Hat

The chapter opens in the secluded village where the Hero has been raised and trained. Speak with the Hero's mother to receive a Lunch for the Hero's father. Explore the village and talk to everyone before going north to the pond. Give the Lunch to the Hero's father, return home, speak with the Hero's mother again, and sit down for the meal.

The village is attacked during the resulting sequence. When control returns in the underground shelter, walk north and search the pots for a **Medical Herb**. Climb out and inspect the ruined village. The former flower patch is now a two-by-two square of sand; search its center tiles for a hidden **Feather Hat** associated with Celia. The Hero cannot equip it, but it sells for 210G and provides most of the first equipment budget.

No enemy encounter occurs inside the village. Once the Medical Herb and Feather Hat are accounted for, leave through the southern exit.

Woodman's Shack and Early Training

Walk a short distance south to the Woodman's Shack. Search all three pots inside to collect a second **Medical Herb**, **50G**, and **Leather Armor**. Equip the Leather Armor immediately, then speak with the woodsman for background about the Hero's origins.

The Hero begins with Expel but no healing spell. Fight only short loops near the shack and Branca until reaching level 3 or 4; Blaze is learned at level 3, while Healmore does not arrive until level 5. Use Medical Herbs before low HP turns an ordinary encounter into a return from defeat.

Hometown and Branca Region Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Kaskos Hopper	8	1	2G	Lowest-risk opening target.	Medical Herb
Elerat	11	3	5G	Manageable alone once the Leather Armor is equipped.	Leather Hat
Stag Beetle	9	1	4G	Basic physical attacker.	Medical Herb
Slime	8	1	2G	Basic training target near Branca.	Medical Herb
Giant Worm	11	3	6G	Slightly more durable but still safe near town.	Medical Herb
Monjar	10	3	8G	Good early gold relative to its HP.	Medical Herb
Babble	12	6	8G	Can poison the solo Hero; carry an Antidote Herb before extended loops.	Antidote Herb
Blazeghost	12	6	16G	Can cast Blaze, evade attacks, and split when struck. End the fight quickly or use Expel if survival matters more than rewards.	Fairy Water

Branca and the Completed Tunnel

Recommended level: 2 on arrival; 3-4 before leaving
Inn: 3G
Fixed pickups: None

Branca is the first full service point. Speak with the King and townspeople to learn that the Hero must stop the return of the Ruler of Evil and that two survivors from earlier chapters were last seen in Endor. Taloon's completed tunnel provides the direct route southwest.

Sell the unusable Feather Hat for 210G. The free Leather Armor is adequate for the tunnel trip, so prioritize a weapon and shield. A Boomerang and Scale Shield cost 530G together; buy the Boomerang first if battles are slow and the shield first if the Hero is consuming too many herbs. The Wooden Hat is another inexpensive lasting upgrade.

Branca Shops

Tier	Item Shop	Cost	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Required until Healmore is learned at level 5.
High	Antidote Herb	10G	Carry one against Babbles.
Skip	Fairy Water	20G	The Hero needs the early experience and gold.
Situational	Wing of Wyvern	25G	Useful after longer field trips but not required for the tunnel.

Tier	Weapon or Armor	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Club	30G	+7 attack	Weaker than the starting Copper Sword.
Skip	Copper Sword	100G	+12 attack	Already equipped.
Skip	Thorn Whip	200G	+14 attack	Too small an improvement.
High	Boomerang	350G	+18 attack	Best Branca weapon and useful against groups.
Skip	Leather Armor	180G	+12 defense	Already obtained at the shack.
Situational	Chain Mail	350G	+18 defense	A useful bridge if funds permit.
Skip	Leather Shield	90G	+4 defense	Save for the Scale Shield when possible.
High	Scale Shield	180G	+7 defense	Best shield sold in Branca.
Skip	Leather Hat	65G	+2 defense	Save for the Wooden Hat.
High	Wooden Hat	120G	+6 defense	Best helmet sold in Branca.

Save after reaching level 3 or 4. Leave Branca and travel southwest to the tunnel built by Taloon. The passage is linear. Walk all the way through and climb the stairs on the Endor side.

> **Achievement Alert: Tunnel Rat** – Needs correction, this will not trigger until some internal condition is met and the guard stops you.
> **Trigger:** Complete the Hero's first crossing of the finished Endor-Branca tunnel. This is the delayed payoff for Taloon's Chapter 3 investment and satisfies "Be the 1000th person to use the new tunnel."

If the achievement does not appear at the first staircase, speak with the tunnel workers and finish exiting onto the Endor side before checking again.

Endor: Hidden Treasure and Reunion

Recommended level: 3-4
Inn: 6G per person
Party gained: Nara, then Mara
Hidden treasure: Lifeforce Nuts

Before recruiting the sisters, resolve the Endor treasure check. Enter the castle through the western doorway leading toward the coliseum. In the hallway, take the small opening on the west side to step onto the castle exterior. Walk south along the outer wall to the concealed stairwell, descend, and open the lone chest for **Lifeforce Nuts**.

> **Achievement Alert: Hidden Treasure - Endor** – Needs correction. chest described is wrong, the chest is in the lower right building of endor and is the cursed sword the multi-edged sword
> **Trigger:** Open the concealed Lifeforce Nuts chest below Endor's western coliseum approach.

This chest was available during Chapter 2 and is already collected if that section was followed. In that case, the chest remains empty and the achievement should already be unlocked; there is no second early-game Endor treasure to find. The locked royal-room and hidden-shop treasures require later keys and are unrelated to this achievement check.

Find Nara just south of the House of Healing on Endor's west side. Accept her fortune reading. She recognizes the Hero and joins. Enter the casino beneath the inn and speak with Mara near the slot machines on the north side; with Nara present, Mara also joins.

Chapter 5 battle control changes here. The Hero is the only permanent character whose individual action can be selected. Nara and Mara act according to the chosen tactic and the current battle state. Begin with **Normal**, switch

to **Defensive** when healing is falling behind, and remember that **Save MP prevents Healus** later in the game. The sisters retain their Chapter 4 levels and equipment, so they should immediately stabilize the low-level Hero.

Taloon's former shop is now a vault operated by Neta. Deposit unused stat seeds, obsolete key items, and valuables that do not need to occupy combat inventory. Gold placed in the vault is protected from the normal defeat penalty.

The wedding of Prince Reed and the Princess of Endor can be viewed from the coliseum for optional story continuity. It is not an achievement or progression requirement.

Endor Shops and Immediate Priorities

Tier	Item or Equipment	Cost	Power	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Restores about 30 HP	Restock the Hero until Healmore is available.
Situational	Antidote Herb	10G	Cures poison	Carry one until the party's status recovery is dependable.
Situational	Full Moon Herb	30G	Cures paralysis	Useful insurance against paralysis.
High	Wooden Hat	120G	+6 defense	Buy if the Hero did not obtain one in Branca.
Skip	Chain Sickle	550G	+20 attack	Save for a Broad Sword or recover the deferred Chapter 3 weapon.
Skip	Venomous Dagger	750G	+24 attack	The sisters should already have their preferred Chapter 4 weapons.
Skip	Iron Spear	880G	+28 attack	A temporary Hero upgrade only.
Skip	Morning Star	1,250G	+33 attack	Hero cannot equip it; Nara should already own one.
Skip	Abacus of Virtue	1,600G	+35 attack	Taloon-only.
Situational	Chain Mail	350G	+18 defense	Budget Hero armor if Chapter 3 treasure was not preserved.
Situational	Bronze Armor	700G	+25 defense	Solid interim Hero armor.
High	Half Plate Armor	1,200G	+30 defense	Target equipment for the solo Cave of Betrayal fights.
Skip	Iron Apron	1,500G	+32 defense	Taloon-only.
Situational	Scale Shield	180G	+7 defense	Adequate until the Iron Shield is affordable.
High	Iron Shield	650G	+12 defense	Preferred shield before the Cave of Betrayal.

Do not begin the `High Roller` grind yet unless the account already has a substantial Chapter 2 balance. The Hero's equipment and upcoming solo fights take priority over casino prizes.

Bonmalmo, Lakanaba, and Equipment Preparation

The next required dungeon separates the Hero from Nara and Mara for two fixed battles. Use the familiar Endor region to raise the Hero independently instead of assuming the sisters' Chapter 4 levels will carry him.

Travel north from Endor to Bonmalmo. The most important purchase is the **Broad Sword for 2,000G**, followed by Half Plate Armor, Iron Shield, and Wooden Hat. If Chapter 3 left the Broad Sword and Half Plate Armor unopened

in the Cave of the Silver Statuette, recover those copies instead of buying them. The cave's water-level puzzle was already solved, and the Chapter 3 cave route identifies both chests.

Chapter 5 Bonmalmo Shops

Tier	Item or Equipment	Cost	Power	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Restores about 30 HP	Carry several until the Hero learns Healmore.
Situational	Antidote Herb	10G	Cures poison	Useful while traveling alone or before Nara's recovery is dependable.
Skip	Fairy Water	20G	Repels weaker enemies	The Hero still needs experience.
Situational	Wing of Wyvern	25G	Return effect	Useful for the optional trip north to Lakanaba.
Skip	Copper Sword	100G	+12 attack	Starting equipment.
Skip	Boomerang	350G	+18 attack	Already available in Branca and weaker than the target weapon.
Skip	Chain Sickle	550G	+20 attack	A short-lived upgrade.
Situational	Iron Spear	880G	+28 attack	Buy only if the Broad Sword remains unaffordable.
High	Broad Sword	2,000G	+40 attack	Preferred Hero weapon for the Cave of Betrayal.
Situational	Fur Coat	600G	+22 defense	Better than Chain Mail, but the Hero can equip stronger armor.
Situational	Bronze Armor	700G	+25 defense	Acceptable interim protection.
High	Half Plate Armor	1,200G	+30 defense	Preferred Hero armor for the solo encounters.
High	Iron Shield	650G	+12 defense	Preferred shield for the solo encounters.
High	Wooden Hat	120G	+6 defense	Best helmet sold in this region for the Hero.
Skip	Feather Hat	280G	+8 defense	The Hero cannot equip it.

Lakanaba is optional. Its shops have reverted to their ordinary stock, so do not expect a Sword of Malice stocked during Chapter 3 to remain available. The useful reason to visit is the field east of town, where Metal Slimes can appear. Mara's Poison Needle may score an instant defeat, while ordinary attacks and the Hero's critical hits can also work. Each Metal Slime is worth 1,350 EXP, but it is likely to flee; do not make this rare encounter the only leveling plan.

The achievement `The One That Didn't Get Away` requires a **King Metal**, not a Metal Slime, so no achievement is expected here.

Aim for Hero level 7 before leaving the Endor region. Healmore arrives at level 5 and Return at level 7. The later target is level 10 or 11 before the Cave of Betrayal, where Firebal at level 9 gives the Hero a dependable group attack.

Return to Endor, cross the completed tunnel back to Branca, and rest and save. Leave Branca to the east. When the road opens through the mountains to the south, follow it to the Desert Inn.

Desert Inn and Hector

Recommended Hero level: 7 on arrival; 10-11 before entering the cave
Inn: 6G per person
Fixed pickup: Lunch
Visible objective: Primrose and the wagon

The horse and wagon are visible outside, but their owner will not trust the party yet. Enter the northern house and speak with **Hector**. When he asks to be left alone, answer **No**. He explains that a former companion betrayed him during an expedition to a cave east of the inn.

Walk along the grassy northern edge of Hector's room to reach the northeast chest and take the **Lunch**. Speak with the other residents, rest, and save.

Before leaving for the cave, equip the Hero with the best available set:

Slot	Preferred Equipment	Minimum Practical Substitute
Weapon	Broad Sword	Iron Spear or Boomerang
Armor	Half Plate Armor	Bronze Armor or Chain Mail
Shield	Iron Shield	Scale Shield
Helmet	Wooden Hat	Leather Hat

The Hero, not the whole party, must be level 10 or 11. Nara and Mara are removed for the cave's two important fights, so their equipment cannot compensate for an underleveled Hero. Carry Medical Herbs even after learning Healmore; they preserve MP and remain usable if spellcasting becomes undesirable.

Desert Inn Region Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Lilypa	21	13	15G	Can raise enemy Defense with Upper; use magic if physical damage collapses.	Basic Clothes
Thevro	25	15	25G	Group fire damage can pressure the party.	Leather Shield
Pixie	29	16	20G	No special route concern beyond improved durability.	Agility Seed
Sand Master	30	22	27G	Can drain MP; protect the Hero's healing reserve.	Basic Clothes
Armor Scorpion	40	38	44G	High Defense; Mara's Sap makes physical attacks practical.	Leather Armor
Mad Clown	36	27	52G	Can cast Firebal; remove groups before repeated spell damage accumulates.	Lifeforce Nuts
Mandrake	30	26	17G	Treat groups as spell targets when their pressure builds.	Mystic Acorns

Train near the inn, where recovery is close, until the Hero reaches the target. Then travel east across the series of bridges and continue to the Cave of Betrayal.

Cave of Betrayal

Recommended Hero level: 10-11
Fixed treasure: Symbol of Faith
Random encounters: None inside

Required spells: Healmore; Firebal strongly recommended
Exit restriction: Outside does not work

The cave contains no random battles. Its danger comes from two mandatory solo encounters, so there is no way to gain a missing level after entering. Save at the Desert Inn first.

Walk north from the entrance and force the party through the unusual wall. Continue along the linear route and break through the next wall. The floor collapses ahead, separating Nara and Mara from the Hero.

Continue alone and take the stairs down. Walk north until the Hero sees what appear to be the sisters. Follow them to the dead end, fully heal, and speak with either one to expose the first pair of impostors.

Solo Battle 1: Two Liclicks

Enemy	Count	HP Each	EXP Each	Gold Each	Threat	Possible Drop
Liclick	2	43	28	61G	Surround can sharply reduce the Hero's physical accuracy.	Cypress Stick

The pair is worth **56 EXP and 122G**. Begin with physical attacks while accuracy is intact. If Surround causes repeated misses, use Firebal to bypass the accuracy penalty and damage the group. Use Healmore before the Hero falls into range of two consecutive enemy attacks.

After the fight, the Hero drops to another floor. Follow the apparent sisters and speak to them when they are found with another pair of monsters. This group is also an ambush.

Solo Battle 2: Tricksy Urchins and Vampire Bats

Enemy	Count	HP Each	EXP Each	Gold Each	Threat	Possible Drop
Tricksy Urchin	2	35	450	20G	The strongest attackers in the group and the primary targets.	None
Vampire Bat	2	25	11	23G	May act unpredictably, but still adds pressure while alive.	Agility Seed

The group is worth **922 EXP and 86G**, making it a substantial catch-up reward for the Hero. Target the Tricksy Urchins first. Firebal damages their group efficiently; finish survivors with physical attacks. Keep the Hero above roughly 25-30 HP and cast Healmore before gambling on another offensive round. Once both Urchins are gone, remove the Vampire Bats.

Finding the Real Sisters

After the second battle, climb the nearby stairs, follow the passage, and descend the next staircase. Walk all the way south to find the real Nara and Mara at the dead end. They ask a question to prove the Hero's identity: when asked whether **Nara** was in Endor's casino, answer **No**. Mara was the sister at the slot machines. The real sisters rejoin.

Take the eastern stairs up. Break through the wall while traveling south, then use the southern stairs to return to 1F. Go west, break through the wall into the southern room, and descend the central stairs followed by the next staircase to reach the bottom.

In the lowest chamber, force a path through the cluster of breakable walls in the center. Open the revealed chest for the **Symbol of Faith**. Outside is disabled in this cave, so retrace the physical route to the entrance.

Acquiring the Wagon

Return west to the Desert Inn and speak with Hector again. He recognizes the Symbol of Faith as proof that the party remained loyal through the same trial that destroyed his trust. Hector joins as a temporary companion and gives the party **Primrose and the wagon**.

> **Achievement Alert: Caravan**
> **Trigger:** Show Hector the Symbol of Faith and acquire Primrose and the wagon.

The wagon allows additional companions to travel with the active party once more of the chosen ones are recruited. Hector occupies the fourth active slot for now and adds physical offense during the upcoming desert crossing. Rest and save at the inn, but stop here for this section; Aneaux begins the next route segment.

Chapter 5 Opening Completion Check

- **Achievements:** Tunnel Rat and Caravan unlocked; Hidden Treasure - Endor either unlocked now or already completed during Chapter 2.
- **Hero level:** Approximately 10-11.
- **Hero equipment:** Broad Sword / Half Plate Armor / Iron Shield / Wooden Hat preferred.
- **Permanent party:** Hero / Nara / Mara.
- **Temporary companion:** Hector.
- **Travel:** Primrose and the wagon acquired.
- **Key checks:** Endor's concealed Lifeforce Nuts chest verified; any deferred Chapter 3 cave equipment recovered or intentionally left behind.
- **Recovery:** Desert Inn remains the nearest save and rest point.
- **Next destination:** Aneaux, reached by leaving the desert through its southeast corner and traveling west.

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Konenber and the Great Lighthouse

Section Achievements: Konenber and the Great Lighthouse

Achievement	Points	Trigger	Route Notes
Hidden Treasure - Great Lighthouse	5	Find all three hidden treasures in the Great Lighthouse	Open the concealed 1F Luck Seed and 400G chests, then the isolated 5F Golden Barrette chest. The route also clears every other lighthouse chest.
Starboard the Helm!	10	Acquire the boat	Restore the lighthouse beacon, return to Konenber, and recruit Taloon at the shipyard.

With the wagon secured, the party can cross the desert and continue toward the western coast. This section introduces the first Small Medals in the achievement route, contains the only permanently missable medal in the set, and ends when Taloon joins with his ship. Do not finish the Great Lighthouse before collecting both Konenber medals.

The section's critical path is:

1. Leave the Desert Inn through the southern desert, exit at the southeast corner, and visit Aneaux.
2. Search Aneaux's graveyard and confirm the story behind the displayed Zenithian Armor.
3. Reach Konenber and collect both Small Medals, especially the one aboard Taloon's unfinished ship.
4. Prepare the Hero for the Great Lighthouse and save in Konenber.
5. Meet Taloon inside the lighthouse, clear every treasure chest, and recover the Fire of Serenity.
6. Defeat the Lighthouse Bengal and two Flamers, then restore the beacon.
7. Return to Konenber, recruit Taloon, and acquire the ship.

Crossing the Desert to Aneaux

Leave the Desert Inn through its southern exit with the wagon. The desert's exit is in the southeast corner; mountains block a direct route farther west. Once outside the sand, travel west to Aneaux.

The enemies here are stronger than those around Branca, but the active party now has the Hero, Nara, Mara, and Hector. The distance is short, so use the sisters' MP when a dangerous group appears rather than carrying unnecessary risk into town.

Desert and Aneaux Region Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Armor Scorpion	40	38	44G	High Defense; Mara's Sap improves the party's physical damage.	Leather Armor
Arrop	27	47	16G	Its attack can put a character to sleep; remove it before lost turns accumulate.	Wayfarer's Clothes
Rogue Knight	54	55	49G	Can appear in groups and summon Healers.	Chain Mail
Healer	16	7	11G	Eliminate it before it restores a more dangerous target.	Medical Herb
Thevro	25	15	25G	Group fire damage can pressure the full party.	Leather Shield

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Mad Clown	36	27	52G	Firebal can damage the whole active group.	Lifeforce Nuts
Metal Slime	4	1,350	5G	Extremely high Defense and likely to flee; attack with everyone and hope for a critical hit or Poison Needle effect.	Golden Barrette
Giant Eyeball	42	27	40G	Becomes more dangerous near defeat; finish it instead of leaving it wounded.	Medical Herb
Barrenth	55	70	68G	The region's most durable ordinary opponent.	Fur Coat
Dark Doriard	28	25	30G	Can cast Sleepmore and disrupt several turns.	Wooden Hat

Aneaux and the Armor Legend

Recommended Hero level: 11
Cheaper inn: 5G per person
Expensive inn: 10G per person
Fixed pickup: Strength Seed

Speak with the guide near the entrance if you want a tour, but do not pay twice as much for lodging: the cheaper inn provides the same recovery as its competitor.

Go to the graveyard in the northwest corner. Search the ground directly in front of the center tombstone for a hidden **Strength Seed**. Keep it with the other unused stat items for later allocation.

The temple displays what residents claim is the legendary Zenithian Armor. Return to the graveyard at night and speak with the ghost of the warrior Ruvas, who confirms that the displayed armor is not the original. This conversation is optional, but it establishes the equipment lead that will matter later.

Aneaux Shops

Tier	Item Shop	Cost	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Cheap emergency recovery for the lighthouse.
Situational	Antidote Herb	10G	Poison is not the lighthouse's main threat.
Skip	Fairy Water	20G	The party still benefits from experience on the coastal route.
Situational	Wing of Wyvern	25G	Backup Return effect.
Situational	Full Moon Herb	30G	Useful against paralysis, including the upcoming boss's shriek.

Tier	Weapon Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Boomerang	350G	+18 attack	Outclassed for the Hero and already available elsewhere.
Skip	Chain Sickle	550G	+20 attack	Outclassed by the Hero's Broad Sword.
Skip	Iron Fan	620G	+22 attack	Mara should already have a stronger Venomous Dagger.
Skip	Venomous Dagger	750G	+24 attack	Buy only if Mara missed it in Haville.
Skip	Iron Spear	880G	+28 attack	Outclassed by the Broad Sword.
Skip	Morning Star	1,250G	+33 attack	Buy only if Nara missed it in Haville.

Tier	Armor Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Fur Coat	600G	+22 defense	Buy only if Mara still needs it.
Situational	Bronze Armor	700G	+25 defense	Adequate fallback for the Hero.
High	Half Plate Armor	1,200G	+30 defense	Buy if the Hero did not recover or purchase one earlier.
High	Iron Shield	650G	+12 defense	Preferred Hero shield for the lighthouse.
High	Wooden Hat	120G	+6 defense	Buy if the Hero still lacks one.
Situational	Feather Hat	280G	+8 defense	Useful only if Nara or Mara missed her Chapter 4 helmet.

Leave Aneaux and travel southwest to the port town of Konenber.

Konenber: Two Small Medals

Recommended Hero level: 11 on arrival; 12-13 before the lighthouse
Inn: 6G per person
Fixed pickups: 2 Small Medals
Permanent missable: One of the two ship medals; collect both before completing the lighthouse

Speak with the townspeople to learn that the Great Lighthouse east of Konenber has gone dark, making the surrounding waters unnavigable. Taloon owns the new ship under construction and has gone to investigate the lighthouse himself.

Collect both Small Medals before following him:

1. Board the old ship at the western port. Go downstairs into its first room and search the dresser for **Small Medal 1**.
2. Enter the shipyard building in the northwest, board Taloon's unfinished ship, go downstairs, and search the dresser for **Small Medal 2**.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 2/32.** One Konenber ship medal becomes permanently unavailable after the Great Lighthouse mission. The supplied sources do not identify it consistently, so do not leave Konenber for the lighthouse until both medals are in inventory.

Konenber Shops

Tier	Item Shop	Cost	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Carry emergency healing without spending Nara's MP.
Situational	Antidote Herb	10G	Not a lighthouse priority.
Skip	Fairy Water	20G	The lighthouse experience is valuable.
Situational	Wing of Wyvern	25G	Return already covers the trip if enough MP remains.
High	Full Moon Herb	30G	Carry at least one in case the boss's shriek disables a key character.

Tier	Weapon Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Chain Sickle	550G	+20 attack	Outclassed for the current party.
Skip	Venomous Dagger	750G	+24 attack	Buy only if Mara still needs one.

Tier	Weapon Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Iron Spear	880G	+28 attack	Outclassed by the Broad Sword.
Skip	Morning Star	1,250G	+33 attack	Buy only if Nara still needs one.
High	Broad Sword	2,000G	+40 attack	Buy for the Hero if the Chapter 3 cave copy was not recovered.

Tier	Armor Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Bronze Armor	700G	+25 defense	The Hero should target Half Plate Armor.
High	Half Plate Armor	1,200G	+30 defense	Preferred Hero armor for the lighthouse.
High	Iron Shield	650G	+12 defense	Preferred Hero shield.
Skip	Feather Hat	280G	+8 defense	The sisters should already own theirs.
High	Golden Barrette	540G	+12 defense	Strong helmet upgrade for Nara and Mara; buy one for each as funds allow.

Train in the coastal region or return to the desert for Metal Slime attempts until the Hero reaches level 12 or 13. Restore the party at the inn and save. From Konenber, travel east to the shoreline, turn north into the forest, cross the eastern bridge, then turn south to the Great Lighthouse.

Great Lighthouse

Recommended Hero level: 12-13
Fixed rewards: Luck Seed, 400G, Magic Potion, Strength Seed, Full Moon Herb, Boomerang, Fire of Serenity, Golden Barrette
Trap chest: Man-Eater Chest
Recovery: Konenber; plan a separate treasure trip and boss trip if MP runs low

The encounter rate is high and several enemies use group attacks or disruptive magic. Do not spend all of Nara and Mara's MP during the treasure sweep. It is efficient to collect the lower-floor treasure, return to Konenber, then make a direct fully-rested boss run.

Enter through the large door and walk around the central structure toward the north stairs. Taloon appears and explains that an evil flame has corrupted the beacon. The **Fire of Serenity** elsewhere in the tower can extinguish it. Taloon then returns to Konenber while the party completes the dangerous work.

Lighthouse Treasure Checklist

Floor	Treasure	Exact Route	Achievement Role
1F	Luck Seed	Walk through the north wall of the central plus-shaped structure; open the left chest.	Hidden treasure 1 of 3
1F	400G	In the same concealed room; open the right chest.	Hidden treasure 2 of 3
3F detour	Magic Potion	From the first 2F hub, take the western route and its stairs; walk north to the dead end.	Standard treasure
2F	Strength Seed	Return to the 2F hub and follow the eastern passage to its end.	Standard treasure
3F	Full Moon Herb	On the main ascent, take the eastern branch at the northern fork.	Standard treasure
3F west room	Boomerang	Continue west past the statues and follow the corridor south; open the right chest.	Standard treasure
3F west room	Man-Eater Chest	The left chest beside the Boomerang attacks when opened.	Trap chest; open and defeat it for complete chest coverage

Floor	Treasure	Exact Route	Achievement Role
4F	Fire of Serenity	Take the stairs by the statues, then walk directly south to the chest.	Required story item
5F	Golden Barrette	From the summit entry room, follow the western outer route around to the isolated northwest room.	Hidden treasure 3 of 3

The local RAM-derived treasure records identify the Boomerang as the right chest and the Man-Eater as the left chest in the 3F western room. This resolves the left/right disagreement between the supplied walkthroughs.

1F Hidden Room

Before climbing, approach the center structure that resembles a plus sign. Walk through its north wall from either side to enter the concealed room. Open the left chest for the **Luck Seed** and the right chest for **400G**. These are the first two achievement-tracked hidden treasures.

Return to the visible route and climb to 2F.

2F Treasure Branches

Walk south toward the central tile arrangement. Go west down the corridor, follow it south into the small room, and climb the stairs. On the upper landing, walk north to the dead-end chest containing a **Magic Potion**, then return to 2F.

From the central arrangement, follow the eastern passage to its end and open the chest for a **Strength Seed**. Backtrack to the center and take the stairs directly south of it to resume the ascent.

3F Western Room

Follow the looping passage and enter the eastern opening to speak with the stranded monster if desired. Return to the route and continue south until the northern fork. Take the eastern branch first for the **Full Moon Herb**, then backtrack and take the western branch toward the statues.

Before climbing the stairs beside the statues, continue west and follow the corridor south to two chests. Heal first. The **right chest contains a Boomerang**. The **left chest is a Man-Eater Chest** with 100 HP; it can cripple a character with one attack, so focus the full party on it and heal immediately after a heavy hit. Defeating it awards 150 EXP and 25G, with a possible Cypress Stick drop.

Return to the statues and climb the stairs.

Fire of Serenity and Final Hidden Treasure

On 4F, walk directly south and open the chest for the **Fire of Serenity**. Return to the stairs and go northeast to the staircase leading to the summit.

Leave the small entry room on 5F and walk south. Turn west into the narrow path, follow it north, turn west at the top, then take the parallel path south. Continue around to the isolated room in the northwest corner and open the chest for a **Golden Barrette**.

> **Achievement Alert: Hidden Treasure - Great Lighthouse**
> **Trigger:** Open the 5F Golden Barrette chest after collecting the hidden Luck Seed and 400G on 1F. If it does not unlock immediately, verify every row in the lighthouse treasure checklist before leaving.

Equip the Golden Barrette on Nara or Mara if either still wears a Feather Hat. Keep the three stat items unused for later allocation.

Great Lighthouse Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Grislysaber	29	30	46G	Resists direct attack magic and can summon more of itself; use physical attacks.	Copper Sword
Thevro	25	15	25G	Group fire damage adds up quickly.	Leather Shield
Metal Slime	4	1,350	5G	Attack with everyone; magic is ineffective and the target often flees.	Golden Barrette
Rogue Knight	54	55	49G	Can summon Healers; remove reinforcements before they extend combat.	Chain Mail
Healer	16	7	11G	Eliminate it before it restores stronger enemies.	Medical Herb
Crested Viper	31	18	25G	Can poison and cast Defense; use magic if physical damage is reduced.	Feather Hat
Mad Clown	36	27	52G	Firebal threatens the full party.	Lifeforce Nuts
Rogue Wisper	40	20	28G	Often wastes turns in Chapter 5; leave it until active threats are controlled.	Fairy Water
Pteranodon	41	36	50G	Firebal makes groups dangerous.	Agility Seed
Vileplant	37	40	34G	Can cast StopSpell; defeat it before the healers are silenced.	Luck Seed
Garcoil Rooster	52	50	51G	Durable physical enemy with no special route mechanic.	Feather Hat
Skeleton	52	53	54G	Defense can undermine the party's physical offense.	Iron Claw
Weretiger	50	30	50G	Its roar can steal turns.	Wayfarer's Clothes
Kordra	32	25	39G	Critical hits make it a priority target.	Morning Star
Man-Eater Chest	100	150	25G	Fixed trap encounter with a very strong physical attack.	Cypress Stick

Boss: Lighthouse Bengal and Two Flamers

After collecting the Golden Barrette, return to the summit's southern side and approach the monsters circling the corrupted beacon.

Preparation	Recommendation
Hero level	12-13
Active party	Hero / Nara / Mara / Hector
Starting tactic	Normal or Offensive
Opening targets	Flamers, one at a time
Hero's role	Physical damage against Flamers; Healmore when the AI healers cannot safely recover the group
Recovery	Return to Konenber before the fight if the treasure sweep consumed substantial MP

Enemy	Count	HP Each	EXP Each	Gold Each	Known Threat	Possible Drop
Flamer	2	75	110	52G	Firebal damages the active party; fire magic is ineffective against it.	Morning Star
Lighthouse Bengal	1	70	2,000	350G	Its shriek can disable a character for a turn.	Fur Coat

The encounter awards **2,220 EXP and 454G**. Focus both Flamers before attacking the Lighthouse Bengal. The Hero's physical strikes are the most dependable damage because Mara avoids ineffective fire magic and Nara may spend turns healing or attempting control spells. Removing one Flamer quickly cuts the incoming Firebal pressure in half.

Keep the Hero ready to cast Healmore when multiple characters are injured. If a key character loses a turn to the Bengal's shriek, continue reducing the remaining Flamer rather than spreading damage. Once both Flamers fall, the Bengal is a straightforward physical target.

After the battle, stand beside the central beacon and use the **Fire of Serenity**. The corrupted flame disappears and the waters around Konenber become navigable. Cast Outside, then Return to Konenber.

Taloon and the Ship

Find Taloon outside the shipyard in Konenber's northwest corner. Speak with him and accept him into the party. Taloon brings the personal inventory prepared at the end of Chapter 3; redistribute useful equipment and sell portable-value items only as needed.

The completed ship becomes available as soon as Taloon joins.

> **Achievement Alert: Starboard the Helm!**
> **Trigger:** Recruit Taloon in Konenber after restoring the Great Lighthouse and acquire the ship.

Do not search for the second Konenber medal now: Taloon's ship has left its construction state, and that medal is no longer obtainable if it was missed. The old-ship medal remains available, but the completion route already collected both before the lighthouse.

Before Sailing to Mintos

- **Achievements:** Hidden Treasure - Great Lighthouse and Starboard the Helm! unlocked.
- **Small Medals:** 2/32 collected; both ship medals secured before the permanent cutoff.
- **Hero level:** Approximately 14-15 after the lighthouse boss.
- **Roster:** Hero, Nara, Mara, and Taloon permanent; Hector remains a temporary companion.
- **Travel:** Wagon and ship available.
- **Key equipment:** Broad Sword, Half Plate Armor, Iron Shield, and Wooden Hat or better on the Hero; Golden Barrettes on Nara and Mara as available.
- **Treasure:** All nine lighthouse chests or encounters resolved, including the three hidden achievement targets.
- **Next destination:** Sail directly south from Konenber, land on the southern coast, and walk east to Mintos.

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Mintos, Padequia, Keeleon, and Santeem

Section Achievements: Mintos, Padequia, Keeleon, and Santeem

Achievement	Points	Trigger	Route Notes
Miracle Plant	5	Help Cristo recover from his illness	Recover the Padequia Seed, have it grown in Soretta, and use the Padequia Root on Cristo in Mintos.
Rematch	5	Defeat Keeleon	Recover the Magic Key from Edgar's hidden laboratory, meet Ragnar at Keeleon, and win the rematch.
You've Changed	5	Defeat the evolved Balzack	Return to occupied Santeem Castle and defeat Balzack's transformed state.

The ship opens the world, but this section follows a deliberate route rather than scattering the party across every reachable shore. First cure Cristo and reunite Alena's group. Then recover the Magic Key, rescue Ragnar from Keeleon, complete the most efficient key-and-medal detours, and settle the sisters' unfinished fight with Balzack in Santeem.

The section's critical path is:

1. Sail from Konenber to Mintos, collect the Treasure Map and two Small Medals, and recruit Brey.
2. Visit Soretta and clear the Cave of the Padequia Seed.
3. Grow the Padequia Root, cure Cristo, and recruit Alena and Cristo.
4. Raid Burland's Thief's Key treasury before crossing to the Keeleon continent.
5. Follow the Magic Key clues through Keeleon, Haville, Kievs, and Edgar's hidden laboratory.
6. Defeat Keeleon and recruit Ragnar, completing the eight chosen ones.
7. Collect the nearby island, Endor, and Seaside Village medals and key-gated treasure.
8. Return to Santeem, defeat evolved Balzack, and recover the Magma Staff and Flute of Uncovering.

Sailing to Mintos

Board the ship at Konenber and sail directly south until reaching the next continent. Land on its northern coast and walk east to Mintos. Ocean encounters are generally less frequent than land encounters, but the ship can be attacked anywhere outside a town or dungeon.

Early Ocean Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Bangler	35	48	30G	Straightforward sea enemy; focus groups before they accumulate damage.	Magic Potion
Man O' War	40	35	12G	Can interfere with the party's actions; remove it before slower allies lose turns.	Full Moon Herb
Plesiosaur	48	65	38G	Resists most fire magic other than the Blaze family; use physical attacks or Blaze spells.	Stilleto Earrings
Guzzle Ray	40	70	24G	High experience for its HP, but still capable of pressuring weaker casters.	Lifeforce Nuts

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Sealthrope	150	98	55G	Much more durable than the early sea enemies; keep healing available.	Wing of Wyvern
Runamok Albacore	47	75	33G	Stronger than its HP suggests; concentrate attacks.	Iron Helmet
Piranian	55	80	43G	Use focused physical damage rather than stretching the fight.	Chain Sickle

Mintos: Map, Medal, and a Sick Companion

Recommended Hero level: 14-15
Inn: 9G per person
Fixed pickups: Small Medal, Treasure Map
Recruit: Brey

Search the ground immediately west of the well near the center of town for **Small Medal 3**.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 3/32.** This is the first medal collected after acquiring the ship.

East of the well, Howden lectures a small audience. Speak with him and answer **No** when he asks whether he is a master of the sea. His follow-up exchange awards the **Treasure Map**, which shows the party's world position and marks a later destination.

Enter the large inn and go to the second floor. Cristo is bedridden, Brey is watching over him, and Alena has already left to search for a cure. Speak with Brey and accept him into the traveling party. The local leads identify the Padequia, a medicinal plant once grown in Soretta to the southeast.

Mintos Shops

Tier	Item Shop	Cost	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Cheap reserve healing while Cristo is unavailable.
Situational	Antidote Herb	10G	Nara can cover most poison recovery, but a backup saves MP.
Skip	Fairy Water	20G	The recently recruited characters benefit from experience.
Situational	Wing of Wyvern	25G	Return is normally available, but an item backup is inexpensive.
Situational	Full Moon Herb	30G	Keep one for paralysis recovery.

Tier	Weapon Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Iron Spear	880G	+28 attack	Outclassed for the Hero and Taloon.
Skip	Morning Star	1,250G	+33 attack	Buy only if Nara missed it in Chapter 4.
Skip	Broad Sword	2,000G	+40 attack	The Hero should already own one or a Sword of Malice.
High	Sword of Malice	3,500G	+45 attack	Strong upgrade for the Hero or Taloon if Chapter 3 supplied no carried copies.
Skip	Abacus of Virtue	1,600G	+35 attack	Taloon should already have one or a stronger weapon.

Tier	Armor Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Half Plate Armor	1,200G	+30 defense	Replace it with Full Plate Armor when affordable.
Skip	Iron Apron	1,500G	+32 defense	Taloon should already be equipped from Chapter 3.
High	Full Plate Armor	2,300G	+35 defense	Strong Hero upgrade before Keeleon.
High	Iron Shield	650G	+12 defense	Fill any missing Hero, Taloon, or Nara shield slot.
Situational	Golden Barrette	540G	+12 defense	Buy only if Nara or Mara still lacks one.
High	Iron Helmet	1,100G	+16 defense	Strong upgrade for the Hero and Taloon.

The priority is not to equip every reserve character equally. Give the active four enough durability for the Padequia cave, then preserve gold for later equipment. A practical party is Hero / Nara / Mara / Taloon; Brey can replace Taloon if his levels need attention, but several cave enemies resist ice magic.

Shrine East of Mintos

Leave Mintos and travel east to the small forest shrine. Its two travel doors are not usable for the current route, but the grounds contain a medal. Follow the grassy outer edge behind the building, enter the narrow strip between the walls, walk to the dead end, and search for **Small Medal 4**.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 4/32.** Return to the front of the shrine after collecting it; no travel door is needed yet.

Continue east to the mountain range, turn south along its edge, and enter Soretta just beyond the mountains.

Soretta and the Lost Padequia Crop

Recommended Hero level: 15
Inn: 12G per person
Fixed pickups: None before the cave

Soretta's Padequia crop died in a drought years ago. The King now works in the southeastern field. Speak with him to learn that a former king preserved one Padequia Seed in a cave southwest of the kingdom.

Soretta has no weapon or armor shop. Its item shop sells Medical Herbs for 8G, Antidote Herbs for 10G, and Full Moon Herbs for 30G. Rest, save, and arrange a four-person cave party. Hero / Nara / Mara / Taloon provides healing, fire offense, Sap, and physical damage; use Brey instead of Taloon only if leveling him is worth carrying ice magic into a dungeon containing Iceloths.

Travel southwest to the cave at the end of the peninsula.

Cave of the Padequia Seed

Recommended Hero level: 15-16
Fixed treasure: Agility Seed, Mystic Acorns, Robe of Serenity, 800G, Padequia Seed
Trap chest: Man-Eater Chest
Wagon restriction: Only the four active characters enter

Directional floor tiles carry the party in the arrow's direction until the route releases them. Plan from the destination of each strip rather than trying to walk against it. The cave is not especially long, but repeated wrong turns can consume substantial healing MP.

B1: Agility Seed

Follow the entrance corridor to the first arrow-tile area. Ignore the first strip on the left. Approach the isolated chest from below by taking the lower arrow route upward, then open it for an **Agility Seed**. Use the arrows to the right to return to the main passage, continue southwest, and descend the stairs.

B2: Alena and the Treasure Loop

Alena is walking with the adventurers first seen leaving Branca. She refuses to abandon her own search, so she does not join yet.

1. Go to the northwest corner and find the two adjacent arrow columns pointing north.
2. Take the **left column**, then continue north along the wall to the chest containing **Mystic Acorns**.
3. Use the arrows to the right, regain control in the northeast area, and move southeast to the two columns pointing south.
4. Take the **left southbound column**. After it releases the party, walk west and take the left arrow strip there.
5. Walk north past the ice formations, then turn west before stepping onto the arrow row along the north wall.
6. Enter the large door below and open the chest for the **Robe of Serenity**. Mara or Brey can use this +33 Defense armor; equip it on whichever one is active and least protected.
7. Leave the room and walk directly east across the two usable tiles to reach the northeast chest containing **800G**.
8. Use the adjacent arrows to return southeast. Take the left southbound column again, then move west.
9. After the arrows release the party, walk south and then east below the tile field. Avoid stepping onto the upper arrows while following the narrow path to the stairs.

B3: Padequia Seed

The bottom floor compresses the puzzle into one dense arrow field.

1. Walk north and step onto the north-pointing tile in the northeast corner. It carries the party to the northwest section.
2. Move five steps west, then step south onto the downward arrow strip.
3. From the landing near the southern side, approach the nearby chest first if completing every encounter. It is a **Man-Eater Chest**, not treasure.
4. From the trap chest, walk four steps north and step east onto the arrow tile. It deposits the party beside the central chest.
5. Open the central chest for the **Padequia Seed**.

Use Outside and Return to reach Soretta. If the active caster cannot leave, retrace the arrow route and stairs manually.

Padequia Cave Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Iceloth	75	85	38G	Emits freezing winds and is immune to ice magic; use physical attacks and fire.	Fur Coat
Conjurer	38	70	31G	Usually appears alone; remove it before its magic becomes disruptive.	Luck Seed

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Healer	16	7	11G	Defeat it before it restores stronger enemies.	Medical Herb
Vampdog	38	36	24G	Durable physical threat.	Thorn Whip
Infurnus Knight	58	77	76G	Stronger than the surrounding field enemies; Sap improves physical damage.	Half Plate Armor
Thevro	25	15	25G	Group fire damage can wear down the active party.	Leather Shield
Mage Toadstool	43	45	30G	Casts Icebolt and resists most magic; Nara's Infernos remains useful.	Magic Potion
Man-Eater Chest	100	150	25G	Fixed trap with a dangerous physical attack.	Cypress Stick

Growing the Root and Saving Cristo

Return to the King in Soretta's southeastern field with the Padequia Seed. He plants it immediately and gives the party the resulting **Padequia Root**.

Return to Mintos and go upstairs in the inn. Alena is now beside Cristo. Speak with her, stand beside Cristo's bed, and use the Padequia Root from the item menu. Cristo recovers, and both Alena and Cristo join the party. The Thief's Key returns with Alena.

> **Achievement Alert: Miracle Plant**
> **Trigger:** Use the Padequia Root on Cristo in the Mintos inn and complete his recovery.

Hector leaves when Alena and Cristo join, but Primrose and the wagon remain. The permanent roster now includes the Hero, Nara, Mara, Taloon, Brey, Alena, and Cristo; only Ragnar is still missing.

After Cristo Recovers

- **Achievement:** Miracle Plant unlocked.
- **Small Medals:** 4/32.
- **Roster:** Seven permanent characters recruited; Hector departed.
- **Key item:** Thief's Key restored through Alena.
- **Equipment:** Robe of Serenity assigned to Mara or Brey; Full Plate Armor and Iron Helmets purchased as needed.
- **Next objective:** Use the Thief's Key for Burland's treasury, then follow Ragnar's trail to Keeleon and recover the Magic Key.

Optional Detour: Burland Treasury

With Alena back, the party again carries the Thief's Key. Burland's first-floor treasury is now worth clearing before the Keeleon route.

Cast Return to Endor, board the ship, follow the river south to the ocean, then sail west around the cape and north through the channel between the travel-door shrines. Continue north past Tempe and Lakanaba, turn east near the Cave North of Lakanaba, and enter the narrow river leading southeast to Burland. The Chapter 5 monsters around Burland are much stronger than the Chapter 1 enemies; run from combinations that threaten the current party.

Inside Burland Castle, go to the northwest corner of 1F and open the locked door with the Thief's Key. Cross the damaging blue floor to six chests containing:

Chest	Reward	Immediate Use
1	Lifeforce Nuts	Save for deliberate endgame allocation.
2	160G	Current equipment fund.
3	Iron Helmet	Equip on the Hero or reserve for Ragnar.
4	Agility Seed	Save for later allocation.
5	Strength Seed	Save for later allocation.
6	320G	Current equipment fund.

The floor damage is severe. Cast Healmore after every few steps rather than waiting for the entire party to reach critical HP. Once all six chests are open, leave the treasury and return to Mintos.

Following Ragnar to Keeleon

After Cristo recovers, a traveler outside the inn room reports that a soldier seeking the Hero headed toward Keeleon. Sail directly west from Mintos until reaching the familiar continent, then land near Keeleon Castle on its eastern side.

Healie, now human, waits near the western side of the courtyard. Speak with him to learn that Ragnar was captured while confronting Keeleon and that the castle now requires a Magic Key. Continue north to Haville and speak with the weapon-shop owner, who connects Magic Keys with Edgar's alchemy. Travel south to Kievs and question the residents near Edgar's house; they identify a hidden laboratory in the Cave West of Kievs.

The traveling merchant inside the Kievs inn now sells late-game equipment:

Tier	Item	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Situational	Broad Sword	2,000G	+40 attack	Buy only if the Hero still lacks a stronger weapon.
High	Sword of Malice	3,500G	+45 attack	Strong Hero or Taloon weapon before later upgrades.
High	Battle Axe	5,500G	+50 attack	Buy for Ragnar after he joins.
High	Full Plate Armor	2,300G	+35 defense	Durable armor for the Hero or Ragnar.
High	Cloak of Evasion	3,000G	+28 defense	Useful for Alena, Brey, or Mara because it can evade physical attacks.
High	Iron Mask	3,500G	+25 defense	Best available non-medal helmet for the Hero or Ragnar.

Rest for free in Kievs and enter the Cave West of Kievs.

Edgar's Hidden Laboratory and the Magic Key

Recommended Hero level: 17-18 on arrival; 18-19 before Keeleon
Fixed pickups: Small Medal, Magic Key
Required key: Thief's Key

Follow the Chapter 4 cave route back to the lower chamber where the Lamp of Darkness was found beside Orin. Search the now-empty treasure chest. A button in its bottom reveals a nearby staircase. Descend into Edgar's hidden laboratory.

Search the **left pot along the north wall** for **Small Medal 5**, then open the laboratory chest for the **Magic Key**.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 5/32.** Keep the medal in the shared inventory or vault; turning medals in later does not invalidate the route count.

The Magic Key opens red doors as well as the lower-tier doors already handled by the Thief's Key, so it supersedes Alena's earlier key.

Use the cave encounters or the area around Kievs to bring the Hero to level 18 or 19. Phantom Messengers should be priority targets because they cast Beat and Sap, summon Phantom Knights, resist most magic, and are immune to fire. Mystic Dolls cast Chaos in groups and share strong magic resistance; use physical attackers and change tactics if spellcasters keep selecting ineffective attacks.

Chapter 5 Keeleon Region Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Bisonbear	80	89	49G	Stores strength for a heavier next attack; defeat it during the setup turn.	Iron Apron
Mystic Doll	40	37	300G	Casts Chaos, appears in groups, and resists magic; prioritize it with physical attacks.	Golden Barrette
Bisonhawk	52	49	39G	Solid physical threat without a special route gate.	Iron Spear
Infurnus Knight	58	77	76G	Stronger than the surrounding enemies; Sap helps physical damage.	Half Plate Armor
Phantom Knight	80	106	47G	Can cast Healmore; remove it before it sustains a group.	Broad Sword
Somnabeetle	23	12	15G	Sleep and Sleepmore can disrupt the party after it wakes.	Magic Potion
Flamer	75	110	52G	Firebal pressures the active party; fire magic is ineffective.	Morning Star
Phantom Messenger	100	200	54G	Casts Beat and Sap, summons Phantom Knights, and resists magic.	Iron Claw
Ouphnest	25	80	10G	Modest HP but unusually high experience.	Chain Mail
Dragonpup	67	96	50G	Acts twice and can summon Butterfly Dragons.	Chain Sickle
Butterfly Dragon	47	38	60G	Group fire breath makes multiples dangerous.	Wing of Wyvern
Demonite	40	80	75G	Treat groups as priority spell or physical targets.	Luck Seed
Curer	60	68	43G	Remove it before healing extends the encounter.	Mystic Acorns

Boss: Keeleon Rematch

Return to Keeleon Castle and enter through the easternmost door with the Magic Key. Follow the corridor north toward the hidden throne-room route. Ragnar is being escorted by guards; speak with him to begin the confrontation. He handles the guards while the active party fights Keeleon.

Preparation	Recommendation
Hero level	18-19
Active party	Hero / Alena / Mara / Cristo or Nara
Starting tactic	Normal
Primary damage	Hero and Alena physical attacks; Mara's Blazemore
Hero's secondary role	Healmore before a weak character enters range of two enemy actions
Recovery	Rest and save in Kievs or Haville immediately before the fight

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Known Threats	Fixed Reward
Keeleon	400	5,100	0G	May act twice in a round; uses powerful physical attacks, Firebal, fireballs, and freezing winds.	Full Plate Armor

Cristo can reduce Keeleon's offense with StopSpell and Surround when the AI selects them successfully, while Nara is a more healing-focused alternative. Mara's Blazemore can deal roughly 80 damage when it lands. Keep the Hero ready to heal because one accurate physical hit followed by a possible second action can defeat a low-HP caster before the AI reacts.

Do not spread the party's effort across unnecessary buffs. Maintain Normal tactics, let Alena and Mara press damage, and use the Hero's turn for Healmore whenever a possible two-action round could defeat someone. Keeleon falls after 400 damage and awards 5,100 EXP plus Full Plate Armor.

> **Achievement Alert: Rematch**
> **Trigger:** Defeat Keeleon in the Chapter 5 throne-room battle.

Ragnar joins immediately after the victory, completing the eight permanent chosen ones. Give him Keeleon's Full Plate Armor, then obtain a Battle Axe and Iron Mask in Kievs and an Iron Shield in Endor as funds allow. Ragnar's Chapter 1 Sword of Malice remains usable until the Battle Axe is affordable.

Magic Key and Medal Sweep

Complete these stops before sailing to Santeem. They turn the newly acquired key into immediate equipment and advance the medal route from 5/32 to 7/32.

Island Shack North of Haville

Sail directly north from Haville to the tiny island with a green center. Enter the old man's shack and search the **right pot** for **Small Medal 6**.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 6/32.** The old man also provides background about the buried Ruler of Evil.

Endor's Magic Key Treasure

Return to Endor. Open the Magic Key door on the southeast building to reach the hidden armor shop.

Tier	Hidden Armor Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
High	Cloak of Evasion	3,000G	+28 defense	Strong evasion armor for Alena, Brey, or Mara.
Situational	Swordedge Armor	9,800G	+50 defense	Powerful Hero/Ragnar armor, but expensive and eventually outclassed.
High	Metal Babble Armor	15,000G	+95 defense	Best body armor available for eligible characters; buy gradually rather than delaying the story for several sets.

The two chests visible below the shop require a route through the castle. Enter Endor Castle, walk behind the central 1F staircase, face the middle section of the dark rear wall, and use the Magic Key. Follow the concealed stairs to the roof, step off onto the shop, and descend to the chests. Take the **Strength Seed** and **Multi-Edge Sword**. The sword is cursed and damages its wielder in proportion to damage dealt; store it in the vault rather than equipping it.

Return at night. Enter the castle without touching the pacing guard, climb through the throne room to the royal bedroom, and open its Magic Key door. Search the far-right dresser for **Small Medal 7**, then open the two chests for the **Pink Leotard** and **Feather Hat**. Give the Pink Leotard to Alena if it improves her current armor.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 7/32.** Endor's earlier hidden-treasure achievement is separate from this night-only royal-room medal.

The casino is now a practical option, but it is not required for the current bosses. Continue deferring the full `High Roller` grind unless the player wants a Meteorite Armband or Metal Babble Shield immediately. Story progress does not close the casino.

Optional Preparation: Seaside Village

This detour secures a medal and the key item for the later Cascade Cave side route. From Endor, sail south down the river, turn west in the ocean, and follow the large continent to the village on its eastern coast. Seaside Village is not added to the Return list, so complete both searches during the same visit.

Search the ground directly below the central statue for **Small Medal 8**.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 8/32.** No medals from this section remain outstanding.

At night, walk to the southern beach near the inn and identify the single tile left dry while the tide covers the surrounding sand. Remember that square. Return during the day and search the same tile for the **Stone of Drought**. It will open Cascade Cave after the Final Key is obtained.

Seaside Village Shops

Tier	Item Shop	Cost	Route Advice
High	Medical Herb	8G	Cheap emergency recovery.
Situational	Antidote Herb	10G	General travel backup.
Situational	Full Moon Herb	30G	Paralysis recovery.
Skip	Scent Pouch	150G	Increases encounters and is unnecessary for this route.

Tier	Armor Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Situational	Full Plate Armor	2,300G	+35 defense	Useful only if the Hero or Ragnar still lacks equivalent armor.
High	Cloak of Evasion	3,000G	+28 defense	Strong for Alena, Brey, or Mara.
High	Sacred Robe	4,400G	+38 defense	Good Cristo or Nara armor and reduces incoming spell damage for the Santeem boss.
Situational	Iron Shield	650G	+12 defense	Fill any eligible empty shield slot.
High	Iron Helmet	1,100G	+16 defense	Upgrade for Cristo or Taloon if the Hero and Ragnar already use Iron Masks.

Seaside Region Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Bomb Crag	300	150	40G	Extremely durable but normally passive; do not waste scarce MP unless it becomes necessary.	Lifeforce Nuts
Flamer	75	110	52G	Firebal pressure; fire magic is ineffective.	Morning Star
Rhinothrope	70	126	39G	Strong physical attacker.	Battle Axe
Lethal Armor	64	120	58G	Can cast Sleepmore; prioritize groups before the party loses turns.	Full Plate Armor
Bengal	100	115	62G	Can cast StopSpell and interfere with healing.	Fur Coat
Chillanodon	85	104	33G	Freezing breath and blizzard attacks threaten the full party; resistant to ice.	Strength Seed

Return to Santeem

Recommended Hero level: 22-23
Recovery: Rest and save in Surene
Fixed post-boss treasure: Strength Seed, Flute of Uncovering, Magma Staff

From Seaside Village, return to the ship and sail east into open water. Follow the continent's eastern coastline north, then angle northeast after passing it. Birdsong Tower marks the correct region; Surene and Santeem lie north of the tower.

Rest in Surene and use the Magic Key on the northeast building's locked door to reach its upper shop before the boss.

Tier	Surene Hidden Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Situational	Poison Needle	1,300G	+1 attack	Useful for Brey or Mara in metal-monster attempts.
Skip	Broad Sword	2,000G	+40 attack	The front line should have stronger options by now.
Situational	Staff of Force	2,500G	+55 attack	Strong caster weapon, but each physical attack consumes 3 MP.
High	Battle Axe	5,500G	+50 attack	Reliable Hero or Ragnar upgrade.
High	Cloak of Evasion	3,000G	+28 defense	Durable option for Alena, Brey, or Mara.

Tier	Surene Hidden Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
High	Iron Mask	3,500G	+25 defense	Excellent Hero or Ragnar helmet.

Save, then form the active party **Hero / Alena / Mara / Ragnar**. Alena and Ragnar provide durable physical damage, Mara supplies Blazemore, and the Hero covers healing. Enter Santeem Castle and go directly to the throne room; talking to roaming monsters can trigger unnecessary Minidemon battles.

Boss: Evolved Balzack

Preparation	Recommendation
Hero level	22-23
Active party	Hero / Alena / Mara / Ragnar
Starting tactic	Normal or Offensive
Primary damage	Alena and Ragnar attacks; Mara's Blazemore
Hero's role	Attack on a safe opening, then prioritize Healmore and recovery
Defensive option	Sacred Robe on an eligible healer if using Nara or Cristo instead

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Known Threats	Drop
Balzack, evolved	500	6,500	0G	Always acts twice; uses heavy physical damage, Snowstorm, and freezing wind.	None

The NES monster data identifies this form as acting twice. Snowstorm is the central threat, and two Snowstorms in one round can overwhelm a weakened party. The Hero can attack on the first safe round, then use Healmore whenever a weaker character cannot comfortably absorb another Snowstorm. Alena and Ragnar should continue attacking while Mara uses Blazemore.

Do not use FendSpell indiscriminately. A protected character cannot receive healing magic from another party member, which can make group recovery harder. If the chosen party cannot stabilize after a heavy opening, switch Mara for Nara or Cristo and use a more defensive tactic, accepting a slower fight in exchange for additional healing.

> **Achievement Alert: You've Changed**
> **Trigger:** Defeat Balzack's evolved form in the Santeem throne room.

Santeem Treasure and Immediate Cleanup

After the victory, the flame blocking the northeast treasure room on 1F disappears. Use the Magic Key and Step-Guard to cross the damaging floor, then open the three chests:

1. **Strength Seed**
2. **Flute of Uncovering**
3. **Magma Staff**

The compact source list also names Mystic Acorns here, but neither its walkthrough prose nor the RAM-derived fixed-treasure records support a fourth post-Balzack chest. The verified route therefore tracks only these three rewards. Keep the Flute and Magma Staff; both are required later.

Return to Surene and revisit the hidden shop if needed. Exit south from that shop, follow the narrow grass north behind the main building, then walk west to the concealed sign. It points the party toward Zenithia and Stancia.

As an optional final cleanup, visit Frenor at night. Search the sandy ground where the House of Healing priest stands during the day for **Mystic Acorns**. This is separate from the Medical Herb recovered there after May's rescue in Chapter 2.

Before Sailing to Stancia

- **Achievements:** Miracle Plant, Rematch, and You've Changed unlocked.
- **Small Medals:** 8/32 collected.
- **Permanent roster:** Hero, Ragnar, Alena, Cristo, Brey, Taloon, Nara, and Mara all reunited.
- **Travel:** Ship and wagon available; Hector has departed.
- **Keys:** Thief's Key and Magic Key available.
- **Required future items:** Magma Staff, Flute of Uncovering, and Stone of Drought retained.
- **Equipment:** Full Plate Armor from Keeleon assigned; Ragnar upgraded with Battle Axe, Iron Shield, and Iron Mask as funds allow.
- **Next destination:** Stancia, reached through the waterways of the northwestern island.

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Stancia and the Zenithian Helm

Section Achievement: Stancia and the Zenithian Helm

Achievement	Points	Trigger	Route Notes
Not So Funny	5	Get the Zenithian Helm	Fail the King's contest once, recruit Panon in Monbaraba, then return with Panon leading the active party.

The sign behind Surene points toward Stancia, an island kingdom whose royal family holds the first piece of equipment required to enter Zenithia. No dungeon blocks this prize. The challenge is learning the King's condition, finding the one performer who can answer it, and arranging the temporary companion correctly before the second audience.

The section's critical path is:

1. Sail to Stancia's northwestern island and enter through its eastern river.
2. Use the town boat to collect two Small Medals and inspect the day and night shops.
3. Enter the throne-room line and let the current party fail the King's challenge.
4. Return to Monbaraba and recruit the jester Panon from the theater.
5. Place Panon first in the active party and speak with the King again.
6. Receive and equip the Zenithian Helm, then leave Stancia so Panon departs.

Sailing to Stancia

From Santeem Castle, board the ship and sail west. Turn north around the coastline near Tempe, then continue into the northern sea until the rocky circular island appears. The Treasure Map can confirm the party's position.

Stancia Castle sits behind waterways that prevent a direct landing. Enter the river from the island's eastern side, land the ship southeast of the castle, then walk north and around the outer terrain to reach the town entrance.

Stancia Region Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Flamer	75	110	52G	Firebal pressures the active party; fire magic is ineffective.	Morning Star
Lethal Armor	64	120	58G	Appears in groups and can cast Sleepmore; remove it before several allies lose turns.	Full Plate Armor
Chillanodon	85	104	33G	Freezing winds and stronger blizzard breath threaten the group; resistant to ice.	Strength Seed
Bomb Crag	300	150	40G	Extremely durable but normally passive; conserve MP unless it becomes active.	Lifeforce Nuts
Rhinothrope	70	126	39G	Strong physical pressure but no story-specific mechanic.	Battle Axe

The trip from the landing point is short. Do not remain outside solely to grind unless the Hero is below the previous section's level target; Stancia provides an inn and the route contains no boss.

Navigating Stancia

Recommended Hero level: 24
Inn: 7G per person
Fixed pickups: 2 Small Medals
Key reward: Zenithian Helm

Speak with the boatman at the entrance to receive the small town boat. Stancia's streets are mostly waterways, so use this boat to reach its homes, shops, and castle entrances.

Collect both medals before addressing the King:

1. Sail to the house in the northeast part of town, go upstairs, and search the pots for **Small Medal 9**.
2. During the day, enter Stancia Castle through either side entrance. Explore the eastern side of 1F and search the dresser in the far-right room for **Small Medal 10**.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 10/32.** Both Stancia medals remain accessible after the Helm event, but collecting them now keeps the route count synchronized.

Stancia Shops

Stancia's first weapon merchant operates from a boat in the northwest waterways. A second weapon shop opens only at night in the southwest. The Sword of Lethargy is the only major new offensive option, but the Helm route does not require buying it.

Tier	Item Shop	Cost	Route Advice
Situational	Antidote Herb	10G	General travel backup.
Situational	Full Moon Herb	30G	Cures paralysis; it does not cure sleep. Carry one as general status recovery.
Situational	Wing of Wyvern	25G	Return already serves the route, but an item backup is inexpensive.
Skip	Scent Pouch	150G	Extra encounters are unnecessary here.

Tier	Day Weapon Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Broad Sword	2,000G	+40 attack	Outclassed by the current front-line weapons.
Situational	Sword of Malice	3,500G	+45 attack	Buy only if the Hero or Taloon still lacks an equivalent weapon.
High	Battle Axe	5,500G	+50 attack	Reliable Hero or Ragnar weapon if one still needs it.
Situational	Staff of Force	2,500G	+55 attack	Equippable by Cristo, Brey, Nara, and Mara, but each physical attack consumes 3 MP.

Tier	Night Weapon Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
High	Battle Axe	5,500G	+50 attack	Same front-line option sold during the day.
High	Sword of Lethargy	8,000G	+60 attack	Strong Hero or Ragnar weapon whose attacks can put enemies to sleep; useful but not required for the Helm.

Tier	Armor Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Situational	Full Plate Armor	2,300G	+35 defense	Useful only if the Hero or Ragnar still lacks stronger armor.
High	Cloak of Evasion	3,000G	+28 defense	Strong evasion armor for Alena, Brey, or Mara.
High	Sacred Robe	4,400G	+38 defense	Excellent spell-resistant armor for Cristo or Nara.
High	Dragon Mail	5,200G	+45 defense	Strong Hero or Ragnar armor that reduces breath damage.
Situational	Iron Shield	650G	+12 defense	Fill any eligible empty shield slot.
Situational	Iron Helmet	1,100G	+16 defense	Useful for Cristo or Taloon if the front line already uses Iron Masks.

The King's Challenge

Use the town boat to enter Stancia Castle through the central entrance. Climb the first stairs, walk south, then climb again to the throne room. Several performers are waiting in line because the King has promised any reward to the person who can make him laugh.

Join the line and wait until the party reaches the front. Speak with the King. The Hero attempts the challenge and fails. This first audience establishes that ordinary party members cannot solve the problem and unlocks the route's performer clue.

Talk with the castle and town residents after the failed attempt. They mention a talented jester named Panon. The only established performance town is Monbaraba, so leave Stancia and cast Return there.

Recruiting Panon in Monbaraba

Enter Monbaraba's theater during the day. Go downstairs and continue to the rear room behind the stage. Panon is waiting there. Speak with him and accept his offer to join.

Panon is a temporary companion with fixed equipment and unpredictable actions. No combat is required for this route, so his battle value does not matter. Return to Stancia immediately.

Before entering the castle, use the Member command to place Panon in the active party, then move him into the **first party position**. Merely carrying him in the wagon or placing him behind the Hero does not satisfy the audience setup described by the supplied walkthrough.

Receiving the Zenithian Helm

Return to the throne room with Panon leading and speak with the King. Panon does not perform a conventional joke. Instead, he confronts the King about using the contest to distract a frightened kingdom, persuading him to entrust the royal heirloom to the chosen ones.

The King gives the party the **Zenithian Helm**. Equip it on the Hero immediately for +30 Defense.

> **Achievement Alert: Not So Funny**
> **Trigger:** Receive the Zenithian Helm from the King of Stancia after presenting Panon as party leader.

Leave Stancia by foot or cast Return. Panon departs once the party leaves, freeing the temporary companion slot. The Helm remains equipped on the Hero and is the first of the four Zenithian equipment pieces collected by this route.

Stancia Completion Check

- **Achievement:** Not So Funny unlocked.
- **Small Medals:** 10/32 collected.
- **Zenithian equipment:** Helm 1/4; Shield, Armor, and Sword remain.
- **Hero equipment:** Zenithian Helm equipped for +30 Defense.
- **Temporary companion:** Panon recruited, presented to the King, and released after leaving Stancia.
- **Missable checks:** Both Stancia medals collected before departure.
- **Next destination:** Burland, where the King can explain what happened to the Zenithian Shield.

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Gardenbur and the Zenithian Shield

Section Achievements: Gardenbur and the Zenithian Shield

Achievement	Points	Trigger	Route Notes
Hidden Treasure - Gardenbur	5	Find the hidden treasure in Gardenbur	Walk through the concealed passage behind the central staircase and open the Fire Claw chest.
Proof of Innocence	5	Get the Zenithian Shield	Defeat Bakor, receive the Final Key, free the hostage, and open the Shield chest in Gardenbur's locked basement.

The Zenithian Helm points the party toward the remaining three pieces. Stancia's residents identify Burland as the last known home of the Zenithian Shield, but that lead ultimately sends the party to the isolated kingdom of Gardenbur. This section also establishes the Rosaville story lead, converts the first ten Small Medals into useful equipment, and earns the Final Key.

The section's critical path is:

1. Ask the King of Burland about the Zenithian Shield.
2. Sleep at Izmit to witness the dream involving Rosa, Saro, and a hidden staircase.
3. Visit the Small Medal King and spend the first ten routed medals.
4. Use the Magma Staff to open the mountain passage into Gardenbur.
5. Collect Gardenbur's Small Medal, Agility Seed, and hidden Fire Claw.
6. Trigger the Bronze Amulet accusation and leave one reserve character as collateral.
7. Clear the Cave Southeast of Gardenbur and defeat Bakor.
8. Receive the Final Key, release the hostage, and claim the Zenithian Shield.

Burland's Shield Lead

Cast Return to Burland. If Burland is not yet in the Return list, sail to the river between Burland and Izmit and land on the castle side. Speak with the King. He explains that a former king gave the Zenithian Shield to the Queen of Gardenbur roughly a century ago. The Counselor adds that volcanic activity isolated Gardenbur behind mountains.

The Magma Staff recovered at Santeem is the answer to that barrier. Keep it in an active character's inventory rather than the vault.

Chapter 5 encounters in this region are far stronger than Ragnar's original opposition:

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Slime	8	1	2G	No meaningful threat at the current level.	Medical Herb
Kaskos Hopper	8	1	2G	No meaningful threat at the current level.	Medical Herb
Elerat	11	3	5G	No meaningful threat at the current level.	Leather Hat
Beleth	125	132	70G	Casts Firebane and Bounce; physical attacks avoid reflected magic.	Staff of Force
Skullknight	180	216	82G	Can cast Healmore once and summon Phantom Knights.	Iron Spear

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Archbison	90	121	72G	Durable physical opponent without a major gimmick.	Strength Seed
Tyranosaur	90	116	45G	Strong physical pressure; keep weaker casters out of the first slots.	Bronze Armor

Izmit's Shared Dream

Travel north to Izmit and stay at the inn. The party shares a dream of the elf Rosa imprisoned at the top of a tower. Saro visits her, plays a distinct melody that reveals a staircase at the tower's base, and speaks of destroying humanity. Rosa calls for help as the dream ends.

This is setup rather than an achievement trigger. Remember both the tower layout and Saro's melody: the Flute of Uncovering found in Santeem reproduces it. Rosaville will be handled after Gardenbur.

Small Medal King

Inn: 10G per person
Small Medals found so far: 10/32
House of Healing: None

From the Burland and Izmit river, sail northwest to the ocean. Turn east and follow the continent's northern coastline until it curves south. A tiny island shrine lies just south of a cave embedded in the claw-shaped coast. Enter the shrine to meet the Small Medal King.

Prize	Medal Cost	Route Advice
Staff of Punishment	1	Skip for now; it is soon outclassed.
Hat of Happiness	4	High priority for Brey or Mara because it restores MP while walking.
Sword of Miracles	6	High priority for Cristo; its attacks restore some of the wielder's HP.
Metal Babble Helm	20	Strong late-game target that requires more medals than the route currently has.

With ten medals, buy one **Sword of Miracles** and one **Hat of Happiness**. The guide's running total tracks medals found, including those exchanged, so it remains 10/32 after these purchases. If conserving all medals for a different prize order, store them in the Endor vault rather than occupying active inventory.

Speak with the knight at the inn for an early clue that the Zenithian Armor lies in the Shrine of Breaking Waves. That dungeon belongs to the next route section.

Opening the Road to Gardenbur

Return to Burland and board the ship. Sail east through the river until reaching land, disembark, then travel south around the lake and continue southeast. A narrow trail turns north toward a visibly thin section of mountain wall.

Stand directly south of that single mountain tile and use the **Magma Staff**. The eruption removes the obstruction and opens the path east to Gardenbur. The change is permanent; the staff remains in inventory for its combat use and does not need to be used again here.

Gardenbur Region Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Chillanodon	85	104	33G	Uses freezing winds and stronger blizzard breath; immune to ice magic.	Strength Seed
Beleth	125	132	70G	Firebane and Bounce punish careless offensive casting.	Staff of Force
Skullknight	180	216	82G	Can heal itself and summon Phantom Knights.	Iron Spear
Mantam	85	108	40G	Durable physical enemy; focus it before weaker allies are worn down.	Wing of Wyvern
Tyranosaur	90	116	45G	Strong physical damage but no spell resistance noted by the route sources.	Bronze Armor
Great Ohrus	120	128	54G	Acts twice and resists ice magic; use physical damage or fire.	Abacus of Virtue

Gardenbur Castle

Recommended Hero level: 24-25
Inn: 8G per person
Fixed pickups before the accusation: Small Medal, Fire Claw
Fixed pickup after the audience: Agility Seed

Gardenbur's only shop sells armor. Make any purchases before triggering the theft accusation so the party is fully prepared before a member is detained.

Tier	Armor Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Leather Dress	250G	+14 defense	Outclassed at this stage.
Skip	Dancer's Costume	400G	+8 defense	Cosmetic and weaker than current equipment.
High	Cloak of Evasion	3,000G	+28 defense	Strong evasion option for Alena, Brey, or Mara.
Situational	Pink Leotard	6,300G	+40 defense	Strong female armor, but one copy was available free in Endor.
High	Golden Barrette	540G	+12 defense	Inexpensive helmet for an eligible character who still lacks one.

Small Medal 11

Go to the kitchen on the west side of 1F and search the pots for **Small Medal 11**.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 11/32.** Collect this pot before leaving for the thief's cave.

Hidden Fire Claw

Approach the central staircase on 1F and climb to 2F. Immediately walk back down the same stairs. Once Alena returns to 1F, walk north through the wall directly behind the staircase to reveal the concealed passage. Follow it to the hidden basement and cross the damaging floor to the chest containing the **Fire Claw**.

Equip the Fire Claw on Alena. It provides +60 Attack and can be used as an item in battle for a fire effect, although her later Stilleto Earrings will usually produce better damage through two attacks and more critical-hit opportunities.

> **Achievement Alert: Hidden Treasure - Gardenbur**
> **Trigger:** Open the concealed Fire Claw chest behind Gardenbur Castle's central staircase.

The Bronze Amulet Accusation

On 1F, enter the small room just north of the armor shop and speak with the woman inside. She tells the party to inspect the dresser, then leaves. Search the drawers; they are empty. A nun enters and accuses the party of stealing the Bronze Amulet.

After the jail scene, wait for the guard to return and escort the party to the Queen. Maintain innocence during the audience. The Queen agrees to release the party on the condition that Bakor, the actual thief, is captured, but she keeps one permanent companion as collateral.

Leave a reserve who is not needed in the planned cave party. **Taloon** is the simplest choice if the active team is Hero / Alena / Mara / Cristo. The detained companion receives no cave experience and cannot be accessed through the wagon until released.

Before leaving the throne-room area, enter the small room immediately east of the Queen and search its dresser for an **Agility Seed**. Rest, save, and travel southeast to the thief's cave.

Cave Southeast of Gardenbur

Recommended Hero level: 25
Fixed treasure: Small Medal, Agility Seed, 1,200G, Strength Seed, Iron Mask, Dragon Shield
Boss reward: Agility Seed
Recommended active party: Hero / Alena / Mara / Cristo

This cave has a dense network of ladders and looping ledges. Keep Mara for Blazemore and Cristo for healing and StopSpell; Alena supplies consistent physical damage. If Cristo repeatedly selects ineffective instant-death magic, Nara is a safer healing substitute.

B1 Treasure Route

1. From the entrance, walk all the way south, then turn west and follow the outer path north.
2. Descend the ladder and continue south to the intersection.
3. Take the narrow eastern path to its end and open the chest for **Small Medal 12**.
4. Return west to the wall, then walk north and follow the path as it turns east.
5. Take the narrow southern passage. Follow its long loop south and around, ignoring the first two ladders, then approach the central platform from the north and open the chest for an **Agility Seed**.
6. Backtrack to the two ladders, go north, and climb onto the raised platform.
7. Follow the linear path east. Ignore the first narrow passage leading south and continue to the eastern ladder.
8. Descend and continue south to the next ladder, then climb to the chest containing **1,200G**.
9. Backtrack to the narrow southern passage that was skipped, follow it to the sandy staircase, and descend to B2.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 12/32.** The cave medal is the only new medal in the Gardenbur route.

B2 Equipment Route

1. Walk south and take the left ladder.
2. Turn west, take the narrow path south, climb two ladders, and walk north to the **Strength Seed** chest.
3. Return south and turn east. Continue to the two ladders leading south, descend them, and keep walking south.
4. At the western side path beside the next ladder, climb onto the raised platform. Follow it north, west, and north up another ladder.
5. Turn west, descend, then walk north to the chest on the west-wall platform containing an **Iron Mask**.
6. Continue to the southwest corner of B2 and open the chest containing the **Dragon Shield**.
7. Retrace the route to the east side. In the southeast corner, climb the ladder and follow the linear western passage to the stairs down to B3.

Equip the Dragon Shield on the Hero or Ragnar; its +30 Defense and breath protection make it a major upgrade. The Iron Mask provides +25 Defense to the other front-line fighter.

Gardenbur Cave Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Dragonit	105	180	100G	Appears in groups, resists fire, and uses scorching breath; prioritize group survival.	Cloak of Evasion
Tyranosaur	90	116	45G	Strong physical attacker.	Bronze Armor
Hambalba	90	144	76G	Durable target; concentrate damage rather than spreading attacks.	Full Moon Herb
Chillanodon	85	104	33G	Dangerous cold breath and ice immunity.	Strength Seed
Skullknight	180	216	82G	Healmore and summoned Phantom Knights can extend combat.	Iron Spear
Archbison	90	121	72G	Durable physical enemy.	Strength Seed
Mantam	85	108	40G	Focus physical and fire damage.	Wing of Wyvern
Beleth	125	132	70G	Bounce makes careless offensive spellcasting dangerous.	Staff of Force

Boss: Bakor

The containers on B3 are empty. Restore the party before speaking with the sleeping thief. Bakor runs around the chamber when confronted; catch and speak with him to begin the fight.

Preparation	Recommendation
Hero level	25
Active party	Hero / Alena / Mara / Cristo
Starting tactic	Normal
Control option	Cristo's StopSpell or sleep from a Sword of Lethargy
Damage after Increase	Hero's Zap and Mara's Blazemore
Recovery	Cristo plus the Hero's Healmore as needed

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Known Threats	Fixed Reward
Bakor	1,000	7,400	0G	Increase, Snowstorm, and physical attacks.	Agility Seed

Normal tactics let Cristo choose healing or StopSpell while Mara attacks. If StopSpell lands before Bakor casts Increase, the physical fighters can end the battle efficiently. A Sword of Lethargy on the Hero can also put Bakor to sleep and deny turns.

If Increase raises Bakor's Defense, stop wasting physical turns. The Hero should cast Zap while Mara uses Blazemore; Alena can continue attacking for critical-hit chances. Keep enough HP to survive Snowstorm followed by a physical hit. Defeating Bakor awards 7,400 EXP and an **Agility Seed**, and a Gardenbur soldier takes him into custody.

Use Outside and return to Gardenbur Castle.

Final Key and Zenithian Shield

Speak with the Queen after Bakor's capture. She clears the party's name and gives the Hero the **Final Key**, which opens every door and supersedes the Magic Key.

Go to the jail and release the companion held as collateral. From the stairs leading to the jail, walk directly east to the other staircase and descend into the locked basement. Use the Final Key, cross the damaging floor with StepGuard, and open the lone chest for the **Zenithian Shield**. Equip it on the Hero for +55 Defense.

> **Achievement Alert: Proof of Innocence**
> **Trigger:** Open the locked Gardenbur basement chest and obtain the Zenithian Shield after receiving the Final Key.

The Queen recommends Rosaville to the south. Do not begin that route yet: the next section starts with the newly available Final Key treasure sweep, then continues to Rosaville and the remaining Zenithian equipment leads.

Gardenbur Completion Check

- **Achievements:** Hidden Treasure - Gardenbur and Proof of Innocence unlocked.
- **Small Medals:** 12/32 found; exchanged medals remain included in this cumulative route count.
- **Zenithian equipment:** Helm and Shield obtained, 2/4.
- **Keys:** Final Key obtained; it supersedes the earlier keys.
- **Unique equipment:** Fire Claw secured for Alena; Dragon Shield and Iron Mask collected from the cave.
- **Party:** Hostage released and full permanent roster available again.
- **Required future items:** Magma Staff, Flute of Uncovering, and Stone of Drought retained.
- **Next route:** Final Key treasure sweep, then Rosaville.

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Rosaville, Shrine of Breaking Waves, and the Dire Palace

Section Achievements: Rosaville, Shrine of Breaking Waves, and the Dire Palace

Achievement	Points	Trigger	Route Notes
Underwater Oasis	5	Get the Zenithian Armor	Navigate the Shrine of Breaking Waves by ship and open the armor chest beside its second Small Medal.
A Monstrous Announcement	5	Attend the conference at the Dire Palace	Use the Staff of Transform, enter the second-floor conference room in monster form, take a seat, and hear Saro's announcement.

The Final Key turns the next route into a combination of world cleanup and major progression. Before approaching the monsters' headquarters, collect every newly available medal and unique item, recover the Sphere of Silence before its cutoff, obtain the Zenithian Armor, complete the optional Cascade Cave, and retrieve the Staff of Transform from the Royal Crypt.

The section's critical path is:

1. Use the Final Key in Branca, Lakanaba, Haville, and Konenber.
2. Reach Rosaville, reveal Rosa's hidden tower, defeat Saroknight, and recover the Sphere of Silence.
3. Sail through the Shrine of Breaking Waves and claim the Zenithian Armor.
4. Use the Stone of Drought to clear optional Cascade Cave and obtain the Metal Babble Sword.
5. Enter the Royal Crypt and recover the Staff of Transform.
6. Sail through Riverton and activate the Colossus to cross the inland barrier.
7. Infiltrate Dire Palace in monster form, clear its treasures, and attend the conference.

Final Key Treasure Sweep

The Final Key opens every door encountered so far. Complete this four-stop sweep before Rosaville so the party enters the next dungeons with stronger equipment and three additional medals.

Branca Castle

Enter the castle and go to the northeast jail. Open the Final Key door and loot the three chests for **Mystic Acorns**, **120G**, and **Small Medal 13**.

Lakanaba Weapon Shop Basement

Return to Lakanaba and descend into the basement of the weapon shop where Taloon worked. Open the three locked chests for a **Strength Seed**, **Ice Blade**, and **Chain Sickle**. The Ice Blade provides +75 Attack and is a strong Hero or Ragnar weapon until the Metal Babble or Zenithian Sword becomes available.

Haville Jail

Enter the jail on Haville's east side and open the barred cells. Search the pot in the first cell for **Small Medal 14**, then search the pot in the third cell with the Yeti for **Small Medal 15**.

Konenber Inn

Go upstairs in the Konenber inn, open the Final Key door to the northeast room, and take the **Sword of Decimation** from the chest. It is cursed; store or sell it rather than equipping it.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 15/32.** The sweep adds one medal in Branca and two in Haville. Lakanaba and Konenber provide equipment but no new medals.

Rosaville and Rosa's Tower

Recommended Hero level: 25
Inn: 9G per person
Fixed boss reward: Sphere of Silence
Conservative cutoff: Obtain the Sphere before the Dire Palace conference

From the Small Medal King's island, sail southwest until finding a river. Follow it south into the continent, choosing branches not blocked by bridges, until the ship reaches the inland dead end. Disembark and walk southeast to Rosaville.

The northern tower matches the shared dream in Izmit. Speak with the residents to learn that Rosa is an elf whose ruby tears attracted human cruelty and that Saro built the tower to protect her.

Rosaville Shops

One shopkeeper near the entrance operates the item, weapon, armor, and healing services.

Tier	Item Shop	Cost	Route Advice
Situational	Wing of Wyvern	25G	Return is normally available, but an item backup is inexpensive.
Skip	Scent Pouch	150G	Additional encounters are unnecessary here.

Tier	Weapon Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Battle Axe	5,500G	+50 attack	Outclassed by stronger options now available.
Required	Stilleto Earrings	7,500G	+5 attack	Buy for Alena; two attacks per round create more critical-hit opportunities than the Fire Claw.
Situational	Sword of Lethargy	8,000G	+60 attack	Strong Hero or Ragnar weapon with a sleep effect.
Situational	Dragon Killer	15,000G	+90 attack	Powerful Hero or Ragnar weapon, but expensive with free endgame weapons approaching.

Tier	Armor Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Skip	Full Plate Armor	2,300G	+35 defense	Current front-line equipment should match or exceed it.
High	Sacred Robe	4,400G	+38 defense	Strong spell-resistant armor for Cristo or Nara.
High	Dragon Mail	5,200G	+45 defense	Strong Hero or Ragnar armor with breath protection.
Situational	Iron Helmet	1,100G	+16 defense	Useful for Cristo or Taloon if still under-equipped.
High	Iron Mask	3,500G	+25 defense	Strong Hero or Ragnar helmet.

Walk to the east side of Rosa's tower and stand where Saro appeared in the Izmit dream. Use the **Flute of Uncovering** to reveal the hidden staircase. The route to the top is linear and has no random encounters. Unlock the upper door and confront Rosa's guard.

Boss: Saroknight

Preparation	Recommendation
Hero level	25
Active party	Hero / Ragnar / Alena / Taloon, or another physical-heavy group
Primary concern	Sphere of Silence can block the party's spells
Secondary concern	Saroknight can call Chillanodons for help
Recovery	Heal before speaking with the guard at the top

Enemy	HP	Base EXP	Gold	Known Threats	Fixed Reward
Saroknight	800	6,800	0G	Physical attacks, Sphere of Silence, and summoned Chillanodons.	Sphere of Silence

Use a physical-heavy party so spell sealing does not dismantle the offense. Focus Saroknight rather than allowing summoned help to turn the fight into an endless cycle; eliminate Chillanodons when their breath damage becomes unsafe. The final EXP can exceed 6,800 when additional enemies are defeated.

Saroknight drops the **Sphere of Silence**. Keep it in active inventory or the vault.

> **Critical Missable: Sphere of Silence**
> The supplied NES sources identify this copy as permanently missable but do not establish the exact event that removes Saroknight. Secure it before the Dire Palace conference so the Esturk sequence cannot close the opportunity.

Speak with Rosa after the battle. She asks the Hero to stop Saro even though doing so may mean killing him. Her Slime explains that the **Staff of Transform** in the Royal Crypt can disguise the party for entry into the monsters' palace. This conversation advances the infiltration route, but it does not yet satisfy `Rosa's Fate`.

Rosaville Region Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Chillanodon	85	104	33G	Powerful cold breath and ice immunity.	Strength Seed
Beleth	125	132	70G	Firebane and Bounce punish careless spell targeting.	Staff of Force
Tyranosaur	90	116	45G	Strong physical pressure.	Bronze Armor
Hemasword	114	180	80G	Resists most attack magic; use physical damage.	Broad Sword
Hambalba	90	144	76G	Can occasionally paralyze a target.	Full Moon Herb
Dragonit	105	180	100G	Group scorching breath and fire resistance make it dangerous to weaker allies.	Cloak of Evasion
Skullknight	180	216	82G	Can cast Healmore and summon Phantom Knights.	Iron Spear

Shrine of Breaking Waves

Recommended Hero level: 27
Required key: Final Key
Fixed treasure: 2 Small Medals, Zenithian Armor
Travel rule: Keep the party aboard the ship through the water route

Sail to the cave directly north of the Small Medal King's island and open its entrance with the Final Key. The shrine is short, but its enemies are substantially stronger than the Rosaville region and many resist one or more schools of magic.

First Hidden Landing

From the entrance, sail east and then north along the long waterway. Seven rows of rock pillars divide the banks. Count upward from the bottom. Immediately after passing the **fourth row**, disembark on the left bank, walk west through the dark wall, and follow the hidden passage south to the chest containing **Small Medal 16**.

Return to the ship and continue north. Follow the water around into the large central rock maze. Sail south within the chamber, take the northwest route through the rocks, turn west out of the maze, and continue south to the small island with stairs.

Descend and open the two chests in the northwest part of the room. One contains **Small Medal 17** and the other contains the **Zenithian Armor**. Equip the armor on the Hero for +70 Defense and its protective effects.

> **Achievement Alert: Underwater Oasis**
> **Trigger:** Open the Shrine of Breaking Waves chest containing the Zenithian Armor.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 17/32.** Both shrine medals are collected before leaving.

Shrine of Breaking Waves Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Necrodain	130	315	50G	Resists most magic; use physical attackers.	Zombie Mail

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Maskan	91	290	102G	Summons more Maskans, casts Infermore, and resists fire and explosion magic.	Stilleto Earrings
Karon	110	234	91G	Uses the Staff of Thunder, casts Vivify, and resists most magic except fire.	Wizard's Ring
Plesiodon	380	135	57G	Extremely durable and resistant to ice, but not especially aggressive.	Silk Robe
Snowjive	90	261	151G	Casts Blizzard and is dangerous in groups; resistant to ice.	Gum Pod
Fury Face	130	225	186G	Uses multiple breath attacks and resists fire.	Full Moon Herb
Dragon Rider	141	351	108G	Acts twice, uses scorching gas, resists fire, and is immune to explosive magic.	Strength Seed

Use Outside after opening the armor room and Return to a safe town. The Hero now carries three of the four Zenithian equipment pieces; only the Sword remains.

After the Zenithian Armor

- **Achievement:** Underwater Oasis unlocked.
- **Small Medals:** 17/32 found.
- **Zenithian equipment:** Helm, Shield, and Armor obtained, 3/4.
- **Missable item:** Sphere of Silence recovered from Saroknight before Esturk's Palace.
- **Next objective:** Use the Stone of Drought at Cascade Cave, then retrieve the Staff of Transform from the Royal Crypt.

Optional Side Route: Cascade Cave

Recommended Hero level: 28
Required items: Stone of Drought, Final Key
Fixed treasure: Sandglass of Regression, Small Medal, Mask of Corruption, 1,040G, Metal Babble Sword

Cascade Cave is optional for story progression but contains the strongest immediately available physical weapon. Complete it now so Ragnar can carry that weapon through the remaining required dungeons.

From Santeem, sail west until reaching the eastern coast of the continent south of the Small Medal King's island. Follow the coast south, land where forest meets the shoreline, and walk west to the cave inside a small lake. The entrance is difficult to see from the ocean.

Walk north to the waterfall, stand directly in front of its center, and use the **Stone of Drought**. The water recedes and exposes the entrance. Open the Final Key door and take the **Sandglass of Regression** from the first chest. It rewinds an ongoing battle and can be used once per day. The supplied NES sources disagree on whether it returns to the battle's beginning or only several rounds earlier.

Cascade Cave Route

1. Descend behind the Sandglass room.
2. Walk north, turn west beside the water, follow the path south and west, then continue north to the chest containing **Small Medal 18**.
3. Walk south to the wall, turn west, and follow the linear route to the stairs.

4. On B3, walk directly south to the southwest chest containing the **Mask of Corruption**. It is cursed and must not be equipped despite its extreme Defense value.
5. Return to the stairs, go east, descend the stone steps, then continue east and south down the next steps to the chest containing **1,040G**.
6. Backtrack north, follow the path east and down, enter the narrow eastern passage, then descend the long southern steps and take the stairs at the end.
7. Follow the bottom floor's linear route to the **Metal Babble Sword**.

Equip the Metal Babble Sword on Ragnar. Its +130 Attack gives him elite sustained damage while allowing the Hero to continue using the current sword until the Zenithian Sword is recovered.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 18/32.** Cascade Cave contains one medal.

Cascade Cave Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Minidemon	95	193	43G	Casts Blazemore and uses freezing breath; eliminate groups quickly.	Mask of Corruption
Balakooda	120	165	69G	Can cast Blazemore and Increase; use magic after its Defense rises.	Iron Fan
Doolsnake	130	170	124G	StopSpell can disable healers and offensive casters.	Golden Barrette
Maelstrom	100	180	84G	Strong aquatic opponent; maintain recovery instead of racing weakened allies.	Cloak of Evasion
Hemasword	114	180	80G	Resists most magic; use physical damage.	Broad Sword
Raygarth	98	221	100G	Scorching breath pressures the active party.	Iron Shield

Use Outside and Return after obtaining the sword. Rest and save in Endor before the Royal Crypt.

Royal Crypt and the Staff of Transform

Recommended Hero level: 29-30
Required key: Final Key
Fixed treasure: Staff of Antimagic, Small Medal, Staff of Transform
Recovery: Unlimited HP/MP spring inside

From Endor, sail south down the river. Enter the shrine on the southern cape where the river opens into the ocean. Open the northern Final Key door and descend the stairs beyond it.

Arrow-Tile Route

1. On the first lower floor, walk north and step onto either upward arrow column. Both deliver the party to the northern stairs.
2. On the next floor, walk east, take either arrow row, and descend the adjacent staircase.
3. Walk west and use the arrows that carry the party to the north end of B3. Open the nearby chest for the **Staff of Antimagic**.

4. From that chest, walk west and follow the passage south. Enter the eastern side corridor, follow it north without touching the arrows on the right, and enter the western room for **Small Medal 19**.
5. Return to the original B3 route and continue south along the lower wall. At the split, take the eastern passage to the staircase.
6. On the next floor, walk west and then north to the recovery spring. Stand beside it to restore the full party's HP and MP.
7. Go south from the spring, walk around the arrow tiles, and reach the staircase in the southwest corner.
8. Back on the separated portion of B1, walk west, follow the path south and east, then continue south past the nearby arrows to the final room.
9. Open the chest for the **Staff of Transform**.

The Staff of Antimagic provides +50 Attack to Cristo, Brey, Nara, or Mara and can suppress enemy spells when used in battle. The Staff of Transform is a required field item; keep it in active inventory for Dire Palace.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 19/32.** The Royal Crypt contains one medal.

Royal Crypt Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Hemasword	114	180	80G	Resists most attack magic; use physical damage.	Broad Sword
Dragonit	105	180	100G	Group scorching breath and fire resistance threaten weaker allies.	Cloak of Evasion
Tyranobat	98	187	74G	Its roar can steal turns.	Wing of Wyvern
Hambalba	90	144	76G	Can occasionally paralyze a party member.	Full Moon Herb
Bebanbar	100	211	88G	Casts Firebane and resists fire magic.	Staff of Healing
Metal Babble	5	10,050	10G	Extremely high Defense and likely to flee; Alena's critical hits and Poison Needles provide the best chances.	Hat of Happiness

Metal Babbles are excellent for leveling, but they do not satisfy `The One That Didn't Get Away`, which specifically requires a King Metal. Use the spring for bounded training if desired, then leave with Outside or the exit arrows.

Riverton

Recommended Hero level: 31
Inn: 10G per person
Fixed pickup: Small Medal

Sail toward the mountain-ringed continent in the south-central world. Enter its river from the north and take the eastern branch; the ship transitions directly into Riverton even though the town is not visibly marked on the world map.

Sail to the small island in the middle of town. Stand **two tiles south of the person** there and search the southernmost grass tile for **Small Medal 20**.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 20/32.** Riverton contains one hidden ground medal.

A merchant on the west side wants a gas lighter than air so he can finish a flying machine. This is a later objective; no item currently in inventory satisfies it.

Riverton Shops

Tier	Weapon or Supply	Cost	Power	Route Advice
Situational	Wing of Wyvern	25G	Return effect	Convenient backup while exploring the isolated continent.
Skip	Battle Axe	5,500G	+50 attack	Ragnar should now use the Metal Babble Sword.
Situational	Sword of Lethargy	8,000G	+60 attack	Useful sleep weapon for the Hero if no stronger sword is available.
Situational	Dragon Killer	15,000G	+90 attack	Powerful but expensive with the Zenithian Sword approaching.

Tier	Armor Shop	Cost	Power	Route Advice
High	Sacred Robe	4,400G	+38 defense	Strong Cristo or Nara armor.
High	Dragon Mail	5,200G	+45 defense	Strong breath-resistant armor for Ragnar.
Situational	Iron Shield	650G	+12 defense	Outclassed for the main front line.
High	Dragon Shield	7,100G	+30 defense	Excellent Hero or Ragnar shield when the other uses the Zenithian Shield.
Situational	Iron Helmet	1,100G	+16 defense	Useful for Cristo or Taloon.
High	Iron Mask	3,500G	+25 defense	Strong Ragnar helmet.

Rest and save, then sail out through Riverton's southern exit. Continue to the end of the river, disembark, and walk south to the Shrine of the Colossus.

Shrine of the Colossus

Recommended Hero level: 31
Required key: Final Key
Fixed treasure: Small Medal, 640G, Agility Seed, Demon Hammer
Trap chest: Mimic
Wagon restriction: Choose the active four before crossing the river

Open the Final Key door on the shrine's left side and approach the giant statue. Enter through its lower body and walk north. Before taking the central stairs, follow the outer path behind them to the chest containing **Small Medal 21**.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 21/32.** This is the Colossus's only medal.

Climbing the Colossus

1. Descend the central stairs. Walk west and enter the southern room for the chest containing **640G**.
2. Return to the central stairs, travel east, and take the northern staircase up.
3. On the next floor, walk northwest to the stairs along the north edge.
4. Walk west, then south through the opening. Turn east and continue to the two statues.
5. Enter the room south of the statues and take the **Agility Seed**.

6. Return north, go east from the statues, turn south through the opening, and follow the linear route to the next stairs.
7. Continue southeast and east, ignoring the two side rooms, and climb the next staircase.
8. Walk south out onto the statue's hand and open the chest for the **Demon Hammer**. It has +70 Attack but is cursed; store it rather than equipping it.
9. Return downstairs, walk north, and follow the passage into the central room. Take the staircase along its northern wall.
10. On the next floor, follow the path south, east, and north into the small stair room. The chest beyond contains a **Mimic**; fight it only for complete encounter coverage.
11. Climb to the head and jump through the **western opening** to land on the hand connected to the control route.
12. Follow the remaining stairs to the controls and activate the Colossus.

The statue carries the party across the otherwise impassable river. The wagon does not accompany the active group, so verify the four intended Dire Palace members before activating the controls. A balanced group is Hero / Ragnar / Alena / Cristo; the Staff of Transform works regardless of who carries it.

Colossus Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Rhinoband	142	245	68G	Acts twice, casts Upper and Defense, and resists fire and wind magic.	Demon Hammer
Bebanbar	100	211	88G	Firebane and fire resistance make physical attacks preferable.	Staff of Healing
Leaonar	150	224	119G	Acts twice and can store strength for a heavy attack.	Leather Dress
Blizag	85	286	100G	Freezing winds plus Beat and Defeat make it a priority target.	Mystic Acorns
Jumbat	113	172	84G	Durable but lacks a route-specific gimmick.	Robe of Serenity
Karon	110	234	91G	Uses Staff of Thunder and Vivify; weak to fire compared with other magic.	Wizard's Ring
Fury Face	130	225	186G	Multiple breath attacks threaten the full party.	Full Moon Herb
Necrodain	130	315	50G	Resists most attack magic.	Zombie Mail
Snowjive	90	261	151G	Blizzard is dangerous in groups.	Gum Pod
Dragon Rider	141	351	108G	Two actions and scorching gas; resists fire and ignores explosive magic.	Strength Seed
Minidemon	95	193	43G	Blazemore and freezing breath pressure weaker allies.	Mask of Corruption
Mimic	190	350	48G	Defeat can kill party members outright; keep revival available.	Dancer's Costume

After the Colossus stops, leave from either marked side exit and walk southeast, then east to Dire Palace.

Dire Palace Infiltration

Recommended Hero level: 31-32
Required item: Staff of Transform
Fixed pickups: 2 Small Medals, Aeolus' Shield, Lifeforce Nuts
Trap chests: 2 Mimics in the external treasure room

The palace admits the party while they appear to be monsters. Before speaking to anyone, use the **Staff of Transform** until the party takes a convincing monster form. If it produces humans or harmless animals, use it again. The transformation expires after walking, so reapply it whenever the disguise ends.

Palace Treasure Route

1. From the entrance, walk north and descend the stairs on the left.
2. In the basement kitchen, search the pots for **Small Medal 22**.
3. Return to 1F and follow the eastern hallway. Use the Staff again before speaking with the monsters for optional intelligence.
4. Climb the southern stairs into the empty throne room.
5. Descend the northwest stairs, follow the hallway south, and leave through the exterior opening.
6. Walk west onto the grass and follow the narrow path north around the palace wall to the hidden staircase in the northwest corner.
7. Descend into the treasure room. The **two southern chests are Mimics**. The northern chests contain **Small Medal 23** and the **Aeolus' Shield**.
8. Exit and re-enter the palace to reset the route to the main entrance.

Equip the Aeolus' Shield on Ragnar. Its +50 Defense is stronger than the Dragon Shield, though the Dragon Shield remains useful when breath protection is more important.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 23/32.** Dire Palace contains two medals, bringing this section's total from 12 to 23.

Before entering the conference room, follow the Minidemon upstairs, then jump through the opening beside the meeting entrance. After landing outside, cast StepGuard and cross east over the damaging floor. Descend the stairs and search the ground directly in front of the tombstone for hidden **Lifeforce Nuts**. Re-enter the palace and restore the monster disguise.

Dire Palace Enemies

The disguise prevents forced battles when speaking with residents, but random encounters and Mimic fights remain dangerous.

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Ryvern	120	393	116G	Poisoning attacks, summoned Podokesaurs, fire resistance, and lightning immunity.	Poison Needle
Bebanbar	100	211	88G	Casts Firebane and resists fire.	Staff of Healing
Mighty Healer	140	162	55G	Casts Healmore; defeat it before it sustains stronger enemies.	Lifeforce Nuts
Impostor	153	582	316G	High-value but dangerous opponent; use focused physical damage.	Mirror of Ra
Leaonar	150	224	119G	Two physical actions and stored-strength attacks.	Leather Dress
Rhinoband	142	245	68G	Two actions plus Upper and Defense.	Demon Hammer
Necrodain	130	315	50G	Resists most magic.	Zombie Mail
Minidemon	95	193	43G	Blazemore and freezing breath.	Mask of Corruption
Bengal	100	115	62G	StopSpell can interfere with recovery.	Fur Coat

The Monster Conference

Use the Staff of Transform immediately before entering the second-floor conference room. Speak with every monster in the room. One directs the disguised party to sit in the row behind the others. Take the indicated seat and wait without leaving.

Saro arrives and announces that the miners beneath Aktemto have uncovered the palace of Esturk, the Ruler of Evil, and that his resurrection is imminent. The assembled monsters leave for Aktemto.

> **Achievement Alert: A Monstrous Announcement**
> **Trigger:** Remain disguised, take a seat in the Dire Palace conference room, and witness Saro's announcement about Esturk.

Leave Dire Palace and cast Return to Haville. Rest, reorganize the active party, and save, but do not enter Aktemto Mine yet; that begins the next section.

Dire Palace Route Completion Check

- **Achievements:** Underwater Oasis and A Monstrous Announcement unlocked.
- **Small Medals:** 23/32 found.
- **Zenithian equipment:** Helm, Shield, and Armor obtained, 3/4.
- **Unique equipment:** Metal Babble Sword assigned to Ragnar; Aeolus' Shield secured; cursed Mask of Corruption and Demon Hammer stored.
- **Required items:** Sphere of Silence and Staff of Transform secured before advancing from Dire Palace to Aktemto.
- **Optional route:** Cascade Cave fully cleared, including the Sandglass of Regression.
- **Travel state:** Colossus activated; Dire Palace added to the Return list.
- **Recovery:** Haville is the staging point for the return to Aktemto.
- **Next destination:** Aktemto Mine and Esturk's Palace.

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Esturk's Palace and the Balloon

Section Achievements: Esturk's Palace and the Balloon

Achievement	Points	Trigger	Route Notes
There's Gas Inside	10	Acquire the hot air balloon	Defeat Esturk, recover the Gas Canister, and deliver it to the balloon builder in Riverton.
Rosa's Fate	5	Find out what happened to Rosa	After acquiring the balloon, sleep at the Izmit inn and witness the second dream about Rosa and Saro.

Saro's conference reveals that the miners beneath Aktemto have uncovered Esturk's buried palace. This section follows that discovery to the Ruler of Evil, recovers the Gas Canister after the battle, and converts it into the balloon needed to reach the world's isolated regions. The immediate return to Izmit then resolves the dream sequence begun before Gardenbur.

The section's critical path is:

1. Return to Haville, prepare the active party, and enter Aktemto Mine.
2. Follow the newly opened mine route and collect its hidden Small Medal.
3. Use the recovery tile outside Esturk's Palace.
4. Clear both palace medals, 2,480G, the stat seeds, and the two Mimics.
5. Defeat the Rhinoking and Bengal guarding Esturk, then defeat Esturk himself.
6. Backtrack to the formerly guarded chest and recover the Gas Canister.
7. Deliver the canister in Riverton and receive the hot air balloon.
8. Return to Izmit and sleep at the inn to discover Rosa's fate.

Aktemto Revisited

Recommended Hero level: 32
Inn: 8G per person
Required preparation: Sphere of Silence already recovered from Rosaville
New mine pickup: Small Medal

Cast Return to Haville after leaving Dire Palace, rest, save, and organize the active party before walking northwest to Aktemto. The earlier mine floors and their routes are unchanged. Descend past the location where the Gunpowder Jar was found in Chapter 4; the new excavation begins on B3 beside a corpse.

A safe Esturk party is **Hero / Alena / Ragnar / Cristo**. Alena and Ragnar supply durable physical damage, Cristo offers Healus and revival, and the Hero can alternate between offense and direct recovery. **Hero / Alena / Ragnar / Mara** deals damage faster through Blazemore but gives the Hero more healing responsibility. Use the safer party unless the team is comfortably above the level target.

Verify the Sphere of Silence is already owned before entering the expanded mine. It is not required to defeat Esturk, but it is a documented missable whose precise cutoff is not identified consistently by the supplied NES sources.

Route Through the Expanded Mine

1. From the B3 ladder beside the corpse, walk north to the water.
2. Turn west, then north, and follow the passage.
3. Take the first eastern branch.
4. In the next section, take the passage north.
5. When another path opens to the right, go east and descend the ladder to B4.
6. Walk northeast from the ladder and take the northern passage.
7. At the split, go east to the dead end beside the water.
8. Stand on the southern edge of the path against the water and use Search to uncover **Small Medal 24**.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 24/32.** This is a hidden ground pickup rather than a chest.

Backtrack west and take the northern route. Pass through the opening beside the wounded miner and continue north to the small building. Step onto the white tile inside to restore the active party's HP and MP completely. It does not remove poison or other persistent status conditions, so cure those separately.

The palace entrance lies east of the recovery building. Use the tile immediately before entering and return to it whenever the treasure sweep consumes too many resources.

Expanded Mine and Palace Approach Enemies

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Necrodain	130	315	50G	Resists most attack magic; use physical damage.	Zombie Mail
Maskan	91	290	102G	Summons more Maskans, casts Infermore, and resists fire and explosion magic.	Stilleto Earrings
Dragon Rider	141	351	108G	Acts twice, uses scorching gas, resists fire, and is immune to explosive magic.	Strength Seed
Chaos Hopper	90	261	99G	Chaos can turn allies against the party; remove groups quickly.	Scent Pouch
Ryvern	120	393	116G	Poisoning attacks, summoned Podokesaurs, fire resistance, and lightning immunity.	Poison Needle
Eigerhorn	250	387	122G	Casts Snowstorm and uses critical-HP body attacks after becoming frightened.	Lifeforce Nuts
King Healer	150	384	300G	Powerful healing can prolong dangerous groups; defeat it first.	Copper Sword
Podokesaur	114	270	81G	Casts Healus and can erase the party's progress against a group.	Agility Seed
Rhinoking	220	855	150G	Durable physical enemy with strong armor.	Full Plate Armor
Bengal	100	115	62G	StopSpell can disable the active healers.	Fur Coat

Esturk's Palace Treasure Route

Fixed treasure before Esturk: 2 Small Medals, 2,480G, Strength Seed, Agility Seed
Trap chests: 2 Mimics
Post-boss treasure: Gas Canister
Escape restriction: Outside fails until the party returns to Aktemto Mine

Enter the palace and walk north through the first doorway.

1. Open the chest in the first small room for **Small Medal 25**.
2. The chest in the adjoining room to the left is a **Mimic**. Defeat it only after confirming the active party can recover from Defeat.
3. Continue west along the hall to the separate northwest room and take **2,480G**.
4. Continue south. Enter the room on the right and open its two chests for a **Strength Seed** and **Agility Seed**.
5. Take the southern stairs up.
6. Follow the path north and east. Ignore the first staircase and continue south to the stairs leading down.
7. Follow the lower route to the room with two chests. One is another **Mimic** and the other contains **Small Medal 26**. Open both only when the party is ready for the trap encounter.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 26/32.** Esturk's Palace contains two medals, bringing the section total from 23/32 to 26/32.

A skeleton blocks the central treasure chest beyond this room. It cannot be removed directly. Leave that chest for the return trip after Esturk.

Walk north from the treasure room and enter the opening northwest of the skeleton. Follow the narrow western passage to the staircase. The remaining ascent is linear and ends in Esturk's chamber.

Mimic Reminder

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Mimic	190	350	48G	Defeat can kill multiple party members outright; keep Vivify or Revive available.	Dancer's Costume

Esturk's Antechamber

Two monsters stand between the party and Esturk. Refuse their demand to leave and defeat one Rhinoking and one Bengal. Together they award **970 EXP and 212G**, before any possible item drop. Use ordinary focused attacks, preserve MP, then restore the party fully before approaching Esturk.

Boss: Esturk

Preparation	Recommendation
Hero level	32 or higher
Safe party	Hero / Alena / Ragnar / Cristo
Faster party	Hero / Alena / Ragnar / Mara
Starting tactic	Normal
Primary damage	Alena with Stilleto Earrings; Ragnar with Metal Babble Sword; Mara's Blazemore if selected
Recovery	Hero's Healall plus Cristo's healing, or Hero-led recovery in the faster party
Nearby recovery	Full HP/MP tile outside the palace

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Known Threats	Drop
Esturk	900	15,000	0G	Eerie light while asleep, two actions after waking, powerful group damage, and a freezing wave that removes spell effects.	None

Esturk may begin asleep, but this is not a harmless opening. His eerie light can damage the entire party before he wakes. Use the early turns for direct damage rather than building a large stack of buffs that his freezing wave can erase.

Alena's two attacks and critical-hit rate make her the best burst attacker. Ragnar supplies dependable damage with the Metal Babble Sword. If Mara is active, Blazemore is useful, but her AI may choose Firevolt even though it is ineffective; Normal tactics are safer than relying on a specific spell. Cristo provides the more stable route through Healus and revival.

When Esturk takes a deep breath, assume the following action can defeat or critically wound a character. Use Healall preemptively if the party is already damaged. After Esturk wakes, his two actions make low-HP casters especially vulnerable, so the Hero should abandon offense whenever one bad round could cause a collapse.

Esturk's 900 HP rewards aggressive but controlled damage. Do not repeatedly replace buffs erased by the freezing wave; restore HP and keep attacking. Victory awards **15,000 EXP**.

Saro's Arrival and the Gas Canister

After Esturk falls, Saro arrives and comments that Esturk's evolution was incomplete. Before he can confront the party, another monster reports that humans have abducted Rosa. Saro leaves immediately to find her.

Backtrack through the palace. The skeleton guarding the central chest is gone. Open the chest for the **Gas Canister**. This is the only required post-boss pickup; do not leave the palace without it.

Outside cannot be cast inside Esturk's Palace. Continue back to the cavern, use the recovery tile if needed, and return to the original Aktemto Mine floors. Outside works once the party is back in the mine. Cast it there, then Return to Riverton.

Riverton and the Hot Air Balloon

Recommended Hero level: 32-33
Required item: Gas Canister
Reward: Hot air balloon

Visit the merchant on Riverton's northwest side who previously lacked a suitable lifting gas. Give him the **Gas Canister**. If he does not hand over the finished craft immediately, stay at the inn and speak with him again the following morning. He gives the party the **hot air balloon**.

> **Achievement Alert: There's Gas Inside**
> **Trigger:** Receive the completed hot air balloon from Riverton's inventor.

Leave Riverton and step onto the balloon, then press the interaction button to board. The balloon crosses mountains, shoals, and other terrain that blocks the ship. Casting Return brings the party's major vehicles to the destination region, so neither the ship nor balloon is permanently stranded.

One supplied route mentions the old-man island medal here. That is the same right-pot medal already counted as **Small Medal 6** during the Magic Key sweep. If it was missed, collect it now at the small island shack north of Haville, but do not increment the route total twice.

Izmit's Second Dream

Before flying to the desert marked on the Treasure Map, return to Izmit and stay at the inn. The second dream shows humans abusing the captive Rosa. Saro arrives too late to save her. As Rosa lies dying, she asks him to abandon his revenge against humanity; he refuses and vows that mankind will pay.

> **Achievement Alert: Rosa's Fate**
> **Trigger:** Sleep at the Izmit inn after Esturk's defeat and acquisition of the balloon, then watch the second Rosa and Saro dream through its conclusion.

This scene explains why Saro abandoned Esturk's chamber and why his campaign against humanity intensifies. It completes the Rosa dream sequence but does not yet bring the party into direct conflict with Saro.

Balloon Route Completion Check

- **Achievements:** There's Gas Inside and Rosa's Fate unlocked.
- **Small Medals:** 26/32 found; the old-man island medal is already included as medal 6.
- **Major victory:** Esturk defeated for 15,000 EXP.
- **Travel:** Hot air balloon acquired; ship and wagon remain available.
- **Key items:** Gas Canister delivered; Sphere of Silence and Staff of Transform retained or vaulted.
- **Treasure:** All three new medals, 2,480G, both stat seeds, and Gas Canister collected; both Mimics resolved.
- **Next destination:** The forest at the Treasure Map's desert marker, containing Elfville and the World Tree.

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The World Tree, Zenithian Sword, and Zenithia

Section Achievements: The World Tree, Zenithian Sword, and Zenithia

Achievement	Points	Trigger	Route Notes
Arboreal Vandal	5	Pluck a leaf from the World Tree	Search the leaf-covered floor inside the World Tree and take a Leaf of the World Tree.
The Highest Branches	5	Get the Zenithian Sword	Rescue Lucia at the top of the World Tree, then open the nearby chest.
Hidden Treasure - Shrine of the Horn	5	Find the hidden treasure in the Shrine of the Horn	Move the shrine elevator and descend the staircase it concealed to reach the Dress of Radiance.
Zenithia's Finest	5	Doran joined the party	Bring Lucia into Zenithia, find her near the House of Healing, and accept Doran's help.
Humans are Curious Creatures	5	Talk to the Master Dragon	Meet the Master Dragon after reaching Zenithian Castle.

The balloon opens the two regions that complete the ascent to Zenithia. The first is the desert settlement of **Elfville**, where the World Tree holds both an injured Zenithian and the final piece of the Hero's equipment. The second is the isolated central island containing Gottside, the Shrine of the Horn, and Zenithian Tower.

The critical path is:

1. Fly to the desert marker shown on the Treasure Map and enter Elfville.
2. Reduce the active party to three members before entering the World Tree.
3. Recover the Staff of Healing, pluck a Leaf of the World Tree, and collect the Dew of the World Tree.
4. Rescue Lucia and open the nearby chest for the Zenithian Sword.
5. Fly to the isolated central island and collect Small Medal 27 in Gottside.
6. Clear the Shrine of the Horn for the Baron's Horn and hidden Dress of Radiance.
7. Equip the Hero with all four pieces of Zenithian equipment and enter Zenithian Tower.
8. Collect all five tower treasures, including Small Medal 28, and ride the cloud to Zenithia.
9. Enter Zenithian Castle with Lucia active, collect Small Medal 29, and recruit Doran.
10. Speak with the Master Dragon and receive the Zenithian Sword's blessing.

Elfville and the World Tree

Recommended Hero level: 33
Inn: 20G
Required active party size: Exactly 3 before entering the tree
Fixed treasure: Staff of Healing, Dew of the World Tree, Zenithian Sword
Renewable pickup: Leaf of the World Tree

Board the balloon outside Riverton or Izmit and check the Treasure Map. Fly to the large desert on the eastern side of the world, then land beside the small cluster of trees at the map's marked location. Enter the trees to reach Elfville and the World Tree.

Speak with the elves before climbing. They report that a voice from the tree is asking rescuers to come in a group of three. Leave town, use the wagon to reduce the active party to **exactly three characters**, then re-enter. Lucia will become the fourth member after her rescue, so a full party cannot accept her.

A safe climbing team is **Hero / Ragnar or Alena / Cristo or Nara**. The Hero supplies flexible offense and Healall, a physical attacker limits dependence on MP, and a dedicated healer stabilizes the three-person party. The World Tree has no conventional exit problem: stepping off a branch drops the party safely outside Elfville, but an accidental fall forces a complete reclimb.

Elfville Armor Shop

Equipment	Defense	Price	Users	Route Value
Shield of Strength	40	13,000G	Hero, Ragnar, Cristo, Taloon	Casts Healmore when used; useful when an eligible character lacks a stronger shield.
Water Flying Clothes	41	15,000G	Brey, Nara, Mara	Strong caster armor with protection against fire-based attacks.

Both pieces are worthwhile but optional. Preserve enough gold for healing and supplies if buying either one; no purchase is required to complete the World Tree.

World Tree Enemy Reference

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Red Cyclone	80	403	128G	Appears in groups and can cast Infermost; remove several quickly.	Boomerang
Snowjive	90	261	151G	Uses ice attacks against the reduced party; focus fire rather than spreading damage.	Gum Pod
Eigerhorn	250	387	122G	Casts Snowstorm and becomes dangerous at critical HP.	Lifeforce Nuts
Green Dragon	143	405	132G	Durable breath attacker; maintain group HP before the next round.	Dragon Shield
Chaos Hopper	90	261	99G	Chaos can turn allies against the party; defeat groups immediately.	Scent Pouch
Infurnus Sentinel	-	-	-	Casts Blazemore and FendSpell and resists most attack magic; use physical attacks.	Chain Sickle
Ryvern	120	393	116G	Uses poison and can call Podokesaurs; eliminate it before the group grows.	Poison Needle

World Tree Treasure Route

1. Enter the trunk and walk north into the small upper room.
2. Climb the ladder there and open the chest for the **Staff of Healing**. It has 5 attack power, can be equipped by Cristo, Brey, or Nara, and casts Healmore when used in battle.
3. While standing on the leaf-covered portions of the upper floors, use Search to pluck a **Leaf of the World Tree**. The party can carry only one at a time, and the leaf fully revives one fallen character.

> **Achievement Alert: Arboreal Vandal**
> **Trigger:** Search the leaf-covered floor inside the World Tree and receive a Leaf of the World Tree.

If the party already possesses a Leaf of the World Tree, the tree will not supply another. Use the existing leaf when revival is needed, then search the leaves again so the plucking event is recorded.

Return down the first ladder to the entrance floor and begin the main ascent:

1. Walk south from the entrance, turn east into the narrow passage, and follow it to the next ladder.
2. On the next floor, go east from the ladder and then south onto the branch.
3. Cross the leaves west along the southern edge and enter the small room to the north.
4. Climb the ladder inside that room.
5. On the next floor, walk south onto the leaves and climb the nearby ladder.
6. Open the chest at the top for the **Dew of the World Tree**, which restores the active party's HP when used in battle.
7. Descend to the previous floor and return north to the ladder used to reach it.
8. Continue north onto the northeastern branch, then follow the leaves south and clockwise around the trunk.
9. Enter the small room in the northwest corner and climb its ladder.
10. Walk north onto the leaves and circle counterclockwise until standing southeast of the ladder.
11. Find the next ladder directly east of the trunk and climb to the top of the World Tree.

Move carefully on every exterior branch. Walking off an unguarded edge returns the party to the ground outside Elfville.

Lucia and the Zenithian Sword

From the final ladder, walk a few steps west and follow the southwestern branch toward the center. Speak with **Lucia**, the injured Zenithian whose voice was heard from below. Her wings were damaged by monsters, so agree to escort her home. She joins the three-character active party as a temporary fourth member.

Lucia identifies the final piece of Zenithian equipment. From her position, walk southeast onto the leaves and open the chest for the **Zenithian Sword**.

> **Achievement Alert: The Highest Branches**
> **Trigger:** Open the chest near Lucia at the top of the World Tree and obtain the Zenithian Sword.

The sword initially has **65 attack power**, can be equipped only by the Hero, and produces the Disperse effect when used as an item. Its current attack value is intentionally modest; the Master Dragon can restore its full strength. With the Sword, Helm, Armor, and Shield now secured, the Zenithian set is complete at **4/4**.

The fastest exit is to step from the top branch and fall outside Elfville. Rebuild a four-character active party at the wagon, but keep Lucia available: she must be brought into Zenithian Castle to open the route to Doran.

The Central Island and Gottside

Recommended Hero level: 34-35
Inn: 12G per person
Fixed treasure: Small Medal
Major destination: Shrine of the Horn, then Zenithian Tower

Board the balloon and fly to the small island near the center of the world. It lies due south of Loch Tower and is completely enclosed by terrain the ship cannot cross. Land on the island; its interior expands into a larger region, and further balloon travel within it is not possible.

From the landing area, travel northeast around the mountain range, continue east, and then turn south to reach Gottside. Speak with the residents to learn about the tower southwest of town and the wounded Zenithian urging the Hero to meet the Master Dragon.

In the far northeast corner of town, descend the stairs into the small underground room. Search the **eastern dresser** for **Small Medal 27**.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 27/32.** This dresser is Gottside's only routed medal.

Gottside Shops

Item	Price	Route Use
Medical Herb	8G	Emergency single-target healing.
Antidote Herb	10G	Cheap poison recovery.
Fairy Water	20G	Suppresses weaker encounters while traveling.
Wing of Wyvern	25G	Backup travel when Return is unavailable.
Full Moon Herb	30G	Cures paralysis from enemies such as Pit Viper.
Scent Pouch	150G	Increases encounters; save it for deliberate grinding.

Armor	Price	Route Advice
Iron Mask	3,500G	Skip if the front line already has stronger headgear.
Dragon Shield	7,100G	Hero/Ragnar shield with 30 defense and fire and blizzard resistance; one is found in Zenithian Tower.
Sacred Robe	4,400G	Optional caster protection; compare it with current equipment before buying.
Dragon Mail	5,200G	Optional front-line armor if a physical attacker is behind.
Swordedge Armor	9,800G	Expensive situational armor; not required for the route.

The tower supplies a free Dragon Shield, so do not buy one merely to satisfy the tower entrance. The required shield is specifically the **Zenithian Shield** already recovered from Gardenbur.

Central Island Enemy Reference

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Infurnus Sentinel	-	-	-	Resists magic and casts Blazemore and FendSpell; use physical damage.	Chain Sickle
Wilymage	130	477	146G	Pairs can revive each other with Leaves of the World Tree; damage both quickly.	Mysterious Bolero
Ryvern	120	393	116G	Poison and reinforcements make prolonged fights risky.	Poison Needle
King Metal	7	30,010	20G	Acts twice, casts Firebane, and usually flees; do not depend on meeting one now.	Metal Babble Helm
Noctabat	220	495	144G	Can suppress spellcasting; defeat it with physical attacks.	Pink Leotard
Ferocial	200	447	92G	Strong physical enemy; keep vulnerable casters protected.	Silver Tarot Cards
Ogre	210	391	65G	Heavy physical attacks and critical hits; Surround can reduce its accuracy.	Fire Claw

> **Achievement Setup: The One That Didn't Get Away (deferred)**
> King Metals appear in the hills northeast of Gottside, but the dedicated hunt belongs in Side Activities and Final Checks. A natural victory still unlocks the achievement; no grinding is required here.

Shrine of the Horn

Encounters: None
Required treasure: Baron's Horn
Hidden treasure: Dress of Radiance

Rest and save in Gottside, then travel far east. Enter the mountain ring from its open eastern side and continue to the shrine.

The visible chest and the hidden chest require different falls:

1. Walk north from the entrance and drop through the **large hole**.
2. On the covered platform below, take the southeastern stairs.
3. Open the chest for the **Baron's Horn**. Retain it; it can call the wagon when the party is separated from it later.
4. Return up the stairs and walk north across the covered platform.
5. Drop through the **smaller hole** onto the elevator at the bottom of the shaft.
6. Step on the switch to raise the elevator to the top.

7. Step off and use the stairs in the northwest corner.
8. Follow the linear passage back to the floor that held the elevator.
9. With the elevator moved, descend the staircase that had been concealed beneath it.
10. Open the northern basement chest for the **Dress of Radiance**.

> **Achievement Alert: Hidden Treasure - Shrine of the Horn**
> **Trigger:** Move the elevator, descend the staircase it concealed, and open the basement chest containing the Dress of Radiance.

The Dress of Radiance has **45 defense** and can be equipped by the Hero, Alena, Mara, or Nara. It can reflect hostile magic, but it can also reflect friendly spells and prevent healing from reaching its wearer. Keep that drawback in mind before using it in the final dungeons.

Return to Gottside, heal, save, and equip the Hero with the complete Zenithian set.

Zenithian Tower Entry Check

The tower rejects the party unless the Hero is actively wearing all four pieces:

Slot	Required Equipment	Acquisition
Weapon	Zenithian Sword	World Tree summit
Armor	Zenithian Armor	Shrine of Breaking Waves
Shield	Zenithian Shield	Gardenbur throne room
Helmet	Zenithian Helm	Stancia throne room

Equip all four pieces before touching the tower entrance. Possessing an item in the bag or placing it on another character is not enough. Once the party is inside, equipment can be changed, though the set is already well suited to the climb.

Zenithian Tower

Recommended Hero level: 35
Fixed treasure: Magic Potion, Mystic Acorns, Small Medal, Mysterious Bolero, Dragon Shield
Exit: Orange cloud at the summit

The tower contains several optional branches that end in treasure. Clear each branch when first reached to avoid retracing most of the climb.

Zenithian Tower Enemy Reference

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Ferocial	200	447	92G	Strong physical pressure against weaker casters.	Silver Tarot Cards
Beastan	178	540	81G	Durable melee enemy; concentrated physical attacks are reliable.	Agility Seed
Leaping Maskan	150	485	52G	A stronger Maskan variant; prevent groups from controlling the fight.	Iron Mask
Pit Viper	200	563	95G	Can paralyze with physical attacks and resists lightning.	Full Moon Herb
Demighoul	134	-	-	Difficult to hit physically and capable of multiplying; use reliable spell damage.	Zombie Mail

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Bharack	140	473	172G	Can summon Curers; remove the healer before the group stabilizes.	Wizard's Ring
Rhinoking	220	855	150G	High durability and physical pressure.	Full Plate Armor
Curer	60	68	43G	Healall can reverse a round of damage; defeat it first.	Mystic Acorns
Master Necrodain	146	702	139G	Casts Defeat and can summon Rogue Wispers; prioritize it immediately.	Lifeforce Nuts
Noctabat	220	495	144G	Can interfere with spellcasting; use physical attackers.	Pink Leotard

Treasure and Summit Route

1. From the entrance, walk north through the first intersection and turn west near the top of the floor.
2. Follow the western path to the northwest staircase.
3. Climb it, walk northeast, and take the next stairs to the exterior chest containing a **Magic Potion**.
4. Retrace the entire branch to the first floor.
5. This time travel east to the staircase in the northeast corner.
6. Follow the upper route south, enter the interior doorway, and circle to the chest containing **Mystic Acorns**.
7. Return outside, continue west, climb two ladders, and enter the doorway at the top.
8. Take the stairs on the left in the southwest corner. On the next floor, reach the southwest stairs and climb to the dead-end room containing **Small Medal 28**.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 28/32.** Return to the three-stair room after collecting it; the medal branch does not continue upward.

9. Back in the first room entered from outside, take the southeastern stairs and follow the linear route until it returns outdoors.
10. Walk west, climb the ladder, and continue west to the doorway with stairs below it.
11. Descend those stairs and follow the winding interior path to a doorway beside another staircase.
12. Take the exterior doorway first. Follow the branch to its dead end and open the chest for the **Mysterious Bolero**.
13. Backtrack to the previous fork and take the staircase that was skipped.
14. Outside again, walk north into the doorway, climb the southeastern stairs, and use the ladder to enter the large upper room.
15. From that doorway, go east and follow the path to the **Dragon Shield** chest.
16. Return to the doorway, travel northwest, and then go south into the carpeted passage.
17. Follow the carpet east, turn south to the exterior path, and continue along the linear ascent.
18. Climb the final stairs and ladder, then stand on the summit platform. An orange cloud carries the party to Zenithia.

The **Mysterious Bolero** has 37 defense, can be worn by Cristo, Nara, Mara, or Brey, and can absorb the MP cost of a spell directed at its wearer. The free **Dragon Shield** has 30 defense and reduces fire and blizzard damage for the Hero or Ragnar.

Zenithian Castle

Recommended Hero level: 35-36
Fixed treasure: Small Medal
Renewable gift: Dew of the World Tree

Companion: Doran
Primary objective: Master Dragon

Place Lucia in the active party before entering the castle. She leaves upon arriving home, completing her escort and making Doran available. The wagon also reaches Zenithia, so restore the preferred four-character formation after Lucia departs.

From the entrance, do not climb the large central stairs yet. Walk northwest, unlock the door, and enter the room directly north. The resident monster gives the party a **Dew of the World Tree** whenever none is currently owned. The Dew restores the active party's HP in battle and is limited to one at a time.

Enter the room immediately to the right and search the three dressers for **Small Medal 29**.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 29/32.** This is the final medal in the current section.

On the lower castle level near the House of Healing, find Lucia again. Speak with her and accept the help of **Doran**, a young Kordra who joins as an AI-controlled companion for the remaining journey.

> **Achievement Alert: Zenithia's Finest**
> **Trigger:** Escort Lucia home, speak with her in Zenithia, and allow Doran to join the party.

Speak with the castle's residents before approaching the throne. Their accounts connect the Hero's parents, Esturk's incomplete evolution, the Golden Bracelet, and Necrosaro's retreat beneath the world. They also explain the function of the Baron's Horn and the route through the clouds.

Climb to the Master Dragon and speak with him. He directs the Hero to stop Necrosaro, grants the Hero **5,000 EXP**, and restores the Zenithian Sword from 65 to **110 attack power**. The blessing may leave the sword unequipped, so check the Hero's equipment afterward and equip it again if desired. The Metal Babble Sword remains stronger in raw attack, but the restored Zenithian Sword is the Hero's intended weapon and retains its Disperse item effect.

> **Achievement Alert: Humans are Curious Creatures**
> **Trigger:** Reach the top of Zenithian Castle and complete the conversation with the Master Dragon.

The southwestern cloud passage descends to the dungeon leading beneath the world. Do not enter it yet; that begins the next section.

Zenithia Route Completion Check

- **Achievements:** Arboreal Vandal, The Highest Branches, Hidden Treasure - Shrine of the Horn, Zenithia's Finest, and Humans are Curious Creatures unlocked.
- **Achievement points:** 25 points earned in this section.
- **Small Medals:** 29/32 found, advancing from 26/32 through Gottside, Zenithian Tower, and Zenithian Castle.
- **Zenithian equipment:** Sword, Helm, Armor, and Shield obtained, 4/4; Sword blessed to 110 attack power.
- **Companions:** Lucia returned safely to Zenithia; Doran joined the party.
- **Key items:** Baron's Horn secured for the separated-wagon route ahead.
- **Major treasure:** Staff of Healing, renewable Leaf and Dew of the World Tree, Dress of Radiance, Mysterious Bolero, and Dragon Shield obtained.
- **Next destination:** The cloud passage from Zenithia and the Final Cave.

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The Dark World and the Four Guardians

Section Achievement: The Dark World and the Four Guardians

Achievement	Points	Trigger	Route Notes
And Then There Were None	10	Defeat the four guardians of the Dark World	Defeat Radimvice, Anderoug, Gigademon, and Infurnus Shadow in their four barrier shrines.

Necrosaro has withdrawn beneath the world and sealed his palace behind a four-part barrier. Reaching that barrier first requires a long descent through the **Final Cave**, the dungeon connecting Zenithia to the Dark World. The party then uses the Last Refuge as a base while defeating one guardian in each corner of the Dark World.

The critical path is:

1. Use the southwestern cloud passage in Zenithia and enter the mountain cave below.
2. Complete the Final Cave treasure sweep, including Small Medal 30.
3. Exit into the Dark World and activate the Last Refuge as the recovery point.
4. Defeat Radimvice in the northeast shrine.
5. Defeat the three Anderougs in the southeast shrine.
6. Search outside the southwest shrine for Small Medal 31, solve its statue room, and defeat Gigademon.
7. Defeat Infurnus Shadow in the northwest shrine.
8. Return to the Last Refuge after Necrosaro's barrier falls, heal, and save.

Final Cave

Recommended Hero level: 36-38
Wagon access: Available throughout the dungeon
Fixed treasure: Dress of Radiance, Small Medal, 3 Lifeforce Nuts, Water Flying Clothes, Staff of Jubilation, Demon Armor, 3,280G, Agility Seed, Strength Seed, Mirror Shield
Trap chest: 1 Mimic

In Zenithian Castle, return to the lower room whose southwestern doorway opens onto the clouds. Walk outside and drop through the hole. The party lands beside the cave enclosed by the mountains near Gottside.

Bring the **Baron's Horn** even though it is not needed during this section; it will be required after crossing Necrosaro's Palace in the next section. The wagon accompanies the party through the Final Cave, so rotate reserve healers into use and draw on their MP instead of exhausting only the active party. Carry the Staff of Antimagic or Sphere of Silence for Infurnus Shadow and enough Full Moon Herbs to address paralysis.

Cave Enemy Reference

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Ogrebasher	930	1,023	137G	Massive HP, strong attacks, and critical hits; Surround reduces its physical accuracy.	Club
Bull Basher	250	870	205G	Resists most magic, casts Blizzard, and can revive allies.	Dragon Mail

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Master Malice	1,023	1,232	112G	Cycles through Explodet, FendSpell, Upper, Blazemore, a freezing wave, and a physical attack.	Dress of Radiance
Bharack	140	473	172G	Can summon Curers and resists ice and explosive magic.	Wizard's Ring
Curer	60	68	43G	Healall can erase a full round of progress; defeat it first.	Mystic Acorns
Spite Spirit	250	965	247G	Uses StopSpell, can reproduce, and can reflect attack magic.	Cloak of Evasion
Bellzabble	250	605	123G	Farewell can remove combatants; eliminate groups before they act.	Multi-Edge Sword
Red Dragon	167	703	215G	Uses Surround, Infermost, and scorching gas while resisting fire.	Luck Seed
Demighoul	134	558	63G	Difficult to hit physically and capable of splitting; use reliable spell damage.	Zombie Mail
Fairy Dragon	123	655	390G	Sweet breath and Chaos can disable or turn party members.	Mystic Acorns
Impostor	153	582	316G	Copies active characters; group damage clears several before they transform.	Mirror of Ra
Mimic	190	350	48G	Defeat can kill multiple party members; the only fixed Mimic can be skipped.	Dancer's Costume
Big Sloth	250	589	99G	Becomes more active at low HP but may waste turns or flee.	Staff of Jubilation
King Metal	7	30,010	20G	Acts twice and usually flees; take the experience if one appears naturally.	Metal Babble Helm

Many encounters are slower and more dangerous than their rewards justify. Running is reasonable when Master Malice, Ogrebasher, or a difficult mixed group would consume the resources needed to finish the treasure route.

Entrance, Medal, and Poisoned Treasure Room

1. Walk north into the second room and open the door along its northern wall.
2. Open the chest inside for a second **Dress of Radiance**. Its spell reflection can also reject friendly healing, so do not equip it automatically.
3. Return south, take the western opening, and follow the long spiraling hallway.
4. At the first western side passage, enter the arrow-tile area.
5. Step onto the rightmost column of arrows pointing south. The tiles carry the party into the enclosed area.
6. Walk directly south and open the chest for **Small Medal 30**.
7. Return north and use the left column of arrows at the top to leave the enclosure.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 30/32.** The achievement must remain locked; two routed medals are still outstanding.

Return to the spiraling hallway and continue along it. Pass the first western branch for the moment and keep following the spiral toward its central end. Take the later western passage into the large room covered with damaging floor.

Cast StepGuard, then cross to the far northwest corner and open the isolated chest for **Lifeforce Nuts**. Move to the southwest corner and follow the safe southern edge east. A short row of arrow tiles deposits the party beside the chest containing **Water Flying Clothes**.

Return to the spiraling hallway and backtrack to the earlier western branch that was skipped.

Staff, Demon Armor, and Four-Chest Cache

1. Follow the earlier western branch into the next room.
2. Enter the small side room to the west and open its chest for the **Staff of Jubilation**.
3. Return to the main path, travel south, and enter the southeastern passage.
4. Cast StepGuard before crossing the damaging floor. The isolated chest in the southeast corner is a **Mimic**; fight it only if its experience and possible Dancer's Costume are worth the risk.
5. Continue west and then north along the linear path to the northwest stairs.
6. On the next floor, walk west and then south around the pit.
7. Use the left column of southbound arrow tiles to reach the chest beside the water. It contains the cursed **Demon Armor**.
8. From the chest, walk east and step north onto the eastbound arrows just south of the small pond.
9. Descend the nearby stairs to the room with four grouped chests.
10. Open all four for **Lifeforce Nuts**, **3,280G**, an **Agility Seed**, and a **Strength Seed**.
11. Take the staircase in the southwest corner.

The Demon Armor provides 60 defense but is cursed. Store it rather than equipping it during this route. The Water Flying Clothes remain useful for Brey, Mara, or Nara, while the Staff of Jubilation can be carried by a caster as a backup weapon.

Boat and Lower Tower

Walk north to the boat and sail directly east to the small island containing the next staircase. Follow the linear corridor to another descent. At the large door, continue north through the long hallway until reaching a pit.

1. Deliberately fall through the pit to land beside the chest containing the **Mirror Shield**.
2. Drop through the central opening one more floor.
3. Use the nearby stairs to climb back up one level.
4. Open the chest along the eastern wall for the third set of **Lifeforce Nuts**.
5. Descend again by the stairs or the central opening.
6. Take the northern staircase down.
7. Walk south and leave the tower to enter the Dark World.

The Mirror Shield has 45 defense and can be equipped by the Hero, Ragnar, or Cristo. It can reflect hostile magic, so compare that effect with the elemental resistance and higher defense of the wielder's current shield.

Cave Treasure Check

Treasure	Quantity	Status
Dress of Radiance	1	Second copy collected
Small Medal	1	Medal 30 collected
Lifeforce Nuts	3	Poison room, four-chest cache, and lower tower
Water Flying Clothes	1	Arrow-tile chest collected
Staff of Jubilation	1	Western side room collected
Demon Armor	1	Cursed armor collected and stored
Gold	3,280G	Four-chest cache collected
Agility Seed	1	Four-chest cache collected
Strength Seed	1	Four-chest cache collected
Mirror Shield	1	Pit route collected
Mimic	1	Defeated or deliberately skipped

The Last Refuge

Recommended Hero level: 38-40
Services: Full HP/MP recovery and saving
Return destination: Available after it is visited
Objective: Defeat one guardian in each corner of the Dark World

Enter the shrine immediately beside the dungeon exit. Walk north and approach the flames. A Zenithian appears, restores the party's HP and MP, offers to record the adventure, and explains the barrier protecting Necrosaro's Palace.

Use the Last Refuge after every guardian. Return works between the refuge and the surface world, but it does not work from inside a guardian's den; step outside first. Because recovery is free and nearby, spend MP aggressively during each boss battle rather than saving it for all four.

A dependable active party is **Hero / Alena / Ragnar / Cristo**, with Doran accompanying them. The Hero covers emergency Healall or Healusall, Alena and Ragnar provide sustained physical damage, and Cristo supplies group healing and revival. Brey is useful when a guardian is vulnerable to magic or when Bikill is desired, but Cristo is the safer default.

The four dens can be cleared in any order. This route proceeds clockwise from the northeast so that the Gigademon medal is collected before the final guardian.

Dark World Enemy Reference

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Lethal Armor	64	120	58G	Outclassed by the party at this stage; clear it before stronger enemies act.	Full Plate Armor
Leaping Maskan	150	485	52G	Appears in groups and can sacrifice itself in a party-wide attack.	Iron Mask
Swinger	380	1,094	53G	High HP and strong physical attacks; use focused damage.	Demon Armor
Duke Malisto	200	921	226G	Uses StopSpell, Beat, Firevolt, and Blazemost while resisting magic.	Staff of Antimagic
Guardian	300	1,040	169G	Acts twice and uses blizzard breath and sweet breath; keep group HP high.	Dragon Killer
Ryvernlord	400	786	254G	Appears in groups and can summon Bharacks.	Agility Seed
Great Ridon	300	1,678	20G	Uses violent blaze and resists most magic; physical attacks are dependable.	Multi-Edge Sword
Impostor	153	582	316G	Copies the active party but does not attack before transforming.	Mirror of Ra

Northeast Guardian: Radimvice

Location: Northeast corner of the Dark World
Fixed treasure: Zombie Mail
Encounter: Radimvice with 3 Demighouls

Enter the Den of Radimvice and take the first stairs. On the next floor, use the northeastern staircase first. Open the chest directly south for the cursed **Zombie Mail**, then return to the previous floor and take the southwestern staircase to Radimvice's chamber.

Enemy	Quantity	HP Each	EXP Each	Gold Each	Possible Drop
Radimvice	1	820	6,300	0G	Robe of Serenity
Demighoul	3	134	558	63G	Zombie Mail

Radimvice begins protected by Bounce and can use Blizzard and Infermost while acting twice. The three Demighouls are difficult to hit, can divide, and make the encounter unstable if left alive. Set tactics to Normal and remove the Demighouls first. Cristo's Defeat can work against them, while Lightning provides a more direct option if reflected damage from Radimvice's Bounce can be avoided.

Once the adds are gone, use Alena and Ragnar for physical damage. The Hero should alternate between attacking and healing. Do not spend repeated turns stripping Bounce when Radimvice can restore it; physical pressure is safer. With the initial three Demighouls and no divisions, the encounter awards **7,974 EXP and 189G**.

Leave the den, cast Return to the Last Refuge, recover, and save.

Southeast Guardian: Anderoug

Location: Southeast corner of the Dark World
Encounter: 3 Anderougs

The Den of Anderoug has a short, direct route to the throne room. Either side path reaches the guardian encounter.

Enemy	Quantity	HP Each	EXP Each	Gold Each	Possible Drop
Anderoug	3	300	1,030	300G	Dragon Shield

Every Anderoug can call another Anderoug, so killing them one at a time can extend the battle. Use Lightning, Explodet, Infermost, or Blizzard to damage the entire formation. Defeat can also remove them outright. Alena's critical hits and Ragnar's attacks should finish survivors in the same round whenever possible.

The initial trio is worth **3,090 EXP and 900G** before any reinforcements or possible drops. Return to the Last Refuge afterward and restore the party.

Southwest Guardian: Gigademon

Location: Southwest corner of the Dark World
Hidden treasure: Small Medal
Encounter: Gigademon

Approach the southwest shrine through the narrow grass path between the trees; there is no need to cross the surrounding swamp. Before solving the interior route, collect the section's second medal:

1. Enter the shrine area and take the exterior path lined with tombstones.
2. Follow it clockwise around the building, using StepGuard over the damaging ground.
3. At the far end in the northwest corner, use Search to uncover **Small Medal 31**.

> **Achievement Setup: Small Medal Collector (deferred)**
> **Running total: 31/32.** Do not claim the achievement yet; the final routed medal is inside Necrosaro's Palace.

Exit and re-enter the shrine to reset the approach. Walk west and then south to the first staircase, descend it, immediately climb back up, and take the staircase farther south.

The next room contains five statues that mirror the party's movement. Contact with a statue ejects the party but causes no other penalty. From the room entrance, move all the way west, walk north enough to pull the statues behind the obstacles, then move east and continue north through the opening. Cast StepGuard before entering Gigademon's chamber.

Gigademon asks the Hero to inspect the ground behind the party. Turning around or speaking to him again begins the fight.

Enemy	Quantity	HP	EXP	Gold	Possible Drop
Gigademon	1	1,200	4,100	250G	Club

Gigademon acts twice and can use Defense against the party. His large HP pool makes this an endurance fight, but his offense is primarily physical. Normal tactics with direct attacks are sufficient; Surround can reduce the danger while Alena and Ragnar work through his HP. Keep the Hero ready to heal after critical hits rather than waiting for the AI to react.

Return to the Last Refuge, heal, and save.

Northwest Guardian: Infurnus Shadow

Location: Northwest corner of the Dark World
Encounter: Infurnus Shadow
Recommended tool: Staff of Antimagic or Sphere of Silence

The final routed den places its guardian immediately inside. Heal before entering because there is no treasure branch or preliminary encounter.

Enemy	Quantity	HP	EXP	Gold	Possible Drop
Infurnus Shadow	1	950	5,500	0G	Sword of Miracles

Infurnus Shadow can act twice and combines Explodet with strong blaze and blizzard attacks. Use the **Staff of Antimagic** or **Sphere of Silence** to seal Explodet. Elemental breath remains dangerous after the spell is blocked, so keep the party above the point where two group attacks could cause a collapse.

Use Normal tactics while recovery is stable and switch to Defensive if the Hero and Cristo cannot keep pace. Alena and Ragnar should maintain physical pressure; the Hero uses Healusall when several characters are damaged. The possible Sword of Miracles is valuable, but the guardian's defeat is the required outcome.

When Infurnus Shadow falls, all four guardians have been defeated and the barrier around Necrosaro's Palace disappears.

> **Achievement Alert: And Then There Were None**
> **Trigger:** Defeat Radimvice, Anderoug, Gigademon, and Infurnus Shadow so that all four sections of the barrier surrounding Necrosaro's Palace vanish.

Return to the Last Refuge one final time. Restore HP and MP, save, confirm the **Baron's Horn** is in the party inventory, and stop before entering Necrosaro's Palace.

Dark World Route Completion Check

- **Achievement:** And Then There Were None unlocked for 10 points.
- **Small Medals:** 31/32 found, advancing from 29/32 through the Final Cave and Gigademon's shrine.
- **Guardian status:** Radimvice, Anderoug, Gigademon, and Infurnus Shadow defeated; Necrosaro's barrier removed.
- **Recovery:** Last Refuge available through Return for free HP/MP restoration and saving.
- **Key item:** Baron's Horn retained for calling the wagon after Necrosaro's Palace.
- **Major treasure:** All ten fixed cave rewards collected; Mimic defeated or deliberately skipped; Zombie Mail recovered from Radimvice's den.
- **Next destination:** Necrosaro's Palace, containing Small Medal 32, the Sage's Stone, and the route to Necrosaro's mountain.

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Necrosaro’s Palace and the Ending

Section Achievements: Necrosaro’s Palace and the Ending

Achievement	Points	Trigger	Route Notes
Hidden Treasure - Necrosaro’s Palace	5	Find the hidden treasure in Necrosaro’s Palace	Walk through the concealed passage between the statues and open the Sage’s Stone chest.
Is This The End?	25	Defeat Necrosaro	Defeat all seven forms in one continuous battle.
We Don’t Need Another Hero	25	Defeat Necrosaro without the hero in the party	Begin the battle with the Hero in the wagon and never move the Hero into the active party.
Just the Two of Us	25	Defeat Necrosaro with a party of two	Use exactly two active combatants for the entire battle; keep every other character in the wagon.

With the four guardians defeated, the barrier around Necrosaro’s Palace is gone. This section completes the palace treasure route, secures the Sage’s Stone, opens the path to the mountain, and covers all seven forms of the final battle. Because defeating Necrosaro leads directly into the ending rather than a postgame save, preserve a repeatable in-game save before the fight for the two party-composition achievements and any unfinished side activities.

The critical path is:

1. Enter Necrosaro’s Palace and avoid the roaming Clay Dolls.
2. Collect Small Medal 32 from the poisoned basement.
3. Find the concealed passage between the statues and recover the Sage’s Stone.
4. Collect the Lifeforce Nuts and Staff of Thunder.
5. Manipulate both elevators and leave through the palace’s rear exit.
6. Use the Baron’s Horn outside to summon the wagon.
7. Return to the Last Refuge, heal, save, and prepare the desired achievement party.
8. Re-cross the palace, summon the wagon again, and climb the mountain.
9. Defeat all seven forms of Necrosaro without leaving battle.
10. Return to Zenithia with the Master Dragon and leave the castle to complete the ending.

Necrosaro’s Palace

Recommended Hero level: 40 or higher
Fixed treasure: Small Medal, Sage’s Stone, Lifeforce Nuts, Staff of Thunder
Required key item at the rear exit: Baron’s Horn
Primary hazard: Damaging floors and roaming Clay Dolls

Enter the central palace from the Dark World after all four sections of its barrier have vanished. The wagon cannot follow the active party through the palace interior, so choose four durable members for the crossing. **Hero / Alena / Ragnar / Cristo** remains the safest formation.

Three Clay Dolls patrol the entrance room. Contact starts an inescapable battle, and their Defeat spell can cause an unnecessary loss before the final boss. Cast StepGuard, move east from the entrance, and follow the eastern wall north to the corridor in the northeast corner. Continue through the next room, walk south to its far end, and climb the stairs.

Palace Enemy Reference

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Threat and Response	Possible Drop
Bharack	140	473	172G	Summons Curers and resists ice and explosive magic; defeat support enemies first.	Wizard's Ring
Bull Basher	250	870	205G	Resists most magic, casts Blizzard, and can revive allies.	Dragon Mail
Clay Doll	400	693	15G	Roaming entrance encounters cannot be escaped; Defeat makes avoidance preferable.	Lifeforce Nuts
Demighoul	134	558	63G	Difficult to hit physically and capable of splitting; use reliable spell damage.	Zombie Mail
Impostor	153	582	316G	Copies active party members; group damage removes several before they transform.	Mirror of Ra
Leaping Maskan	150	485	52G	Can sacrifice itself in a party-wide attack; eliminate groups quickly.	Iron Mask
Great Ridon	300	1,678	20G	Uses violent blaze and resists most attack magic; rely on physical damage.	Multi-Edge Sword
Duke Malisto	200	921	226G	Uses StopSpell, Beat, Firevolt, and Blazemost while resisting magic.	Staff of Antimagic
Swinger	380	1,094	53G	High HP and strong physical attacks; concentrate damage.	Demon Armor
Master Malice	1,023	1,232	112G	Uses a fixed spell-and-attack cycle beginning with Explodet; end the encounter quickly.	Dress of Radiance
Guardian	300	1,040	169G	Acts twice and uses blizzard breath and sweet breath.	Dragon Killer
Flamadog	165	585	205G	Scorching gas damages the active party, but it has no major resistances.	Lifeforce Nuts
Ryvernlord	400	786	254G	Appears in groups and can summon Bharacks.	Agility Seed

Small Medal 32

After climbing from the entrance route, walk outside, continue northeast, and re-enter the palace. Follow the hallway to the room containing a spirit and two staircases.

1. Take the descending stairs into the poisoned basement.
2. Cast StepGuard before leaving the safe tiles.
3. Walk all the way south across the damaging floor.
4. Open the chest for **Small Medal 32**.
5. Return to the room with the spirit and two staircases.

> **Achievement Check: Small Medal Collector**
> **Running total: 32/32.** If every routed medal has been collected, `Small Medal Collector` should unlock here. If the total is lower, do not continue to the ending until the audit in Side Activities and Final Checks identifies the missing medal.

This is the final physical Small Medal in the North American NES release and completes the 32-medal achievement route.

Hidden Passage and the Sage's Stone

From the spirit room, take the eastern staircase upward and follow the linear path until reaching the first elevator. Ignore the elevator for now and climb the staircase immediately north of it.

On the next floor, walk directly north between the pair of statues. The wall conceals a passable corridor that is not visible from the room. Continue east through the hidden room, descend the stairs, follow the passage to another staircase, and then walk south through the exterior route. Open the chest at the end for the **Sage's Stone**.

> **Achievement Alert: Hidden Treasure - Necrosaro's Palace**
> **Trigger:** Pass between the statues, follow the concealed route, and open the chest containing the Sage's Stone.

The Sage's Stone casts Healus when used in battle and consumes no MP. It is the most important item for the final battle. Give it to the Hero for the standard and two-member Hero routes so its group healing can be commanded every round when needed.

Remaining Palace Treasure

Return to the room where the hidden passage begins. Take the southeastern exit and follow the route to a room containing two chests. Open them for **Lifeforce Nuts** and the **Staff of Thunder**.

The Staff of Thunder has 29 attack power and can be equipped by Brey or Mara. Its combat-use effect is more valuable than its physical attack, but direct spell damage becomes less dependable during Necrosaro's later forms. Store it if inventory space is tight.

Return to the first elevator that was skipped after the spirit room.

1. Ride the first elevator down one floor.
2. Walk south, then follow the eastern path into the next room.
3. Walk north, climb the stairs, and follow the path to the second elevator.
4. Ride the second elevator down to the previous floor.
5. Return up the nearby stairs. The lowered elevator now forms a walkable platform over the former obstruction.
6. Cross the top of the elevator and climb the staircase in the northeast corner.
7. Climb the next staircase and walk west into the room with water in its center.
8. Travel southwest to the exit, then continue west through the final doorway.

The party emerges on the Dark World map at the base of Necrosaro's mountain. Use the **Baron's Horn** here to call the wagon and reunite the full roster. The horn must be used outside the palace; it cannot solve the separation while the party is still inside.

Palace Treasure Check

Treasure	Location	Purpose
Small Medal 32	Poisoned basement south of the spirit room	Completes the routed 32-medal set.
Sage's Stone	Concealed passage north between the statues	Casts Healus in battle without spending MP.
Lifeforce Nuts	Southeastern treasure branch	Permanently raises maximum HP.
Staff of Thunder	Southeastern treasure branch	Combat-use attack item and caster weapon.

Creating a Repeatable Final-Boss Save

Do not climb the mountain immediately after the first treasure sweep. Cast Return to the Last Refuge, restore everyone, and make an in-game save. The palace treasure flags remain set, so future crossings can ignore every side branch and follow only the elevator route to the rear exit.

Each Necrosaro victory proceeds directly into the ending. After earning one set of achievements, reload this Last Refuge save, cross the cleared palace again, use the Baron's Horn at the rear exit, and configure the next party. This save also preserves a point before the ending for the cleanup activities in the following section.

Final Equipment and Inventory

The standard party remains **Hero / Alena / Ragnar / Cristo**. Exact equipment depends on purchases and medal rewards, but prioritize durability and reliable physical damage.

Character	Recommended Core	Battle Role
Hero	Zenithian Sword, Armor, Shield, and Helm; Sage's Stone	Direct healing, Disperse effect, and emergency Healall or Healusall.
Alena	Stilleto Earrings, strongest available armor, Golden Barrette, Meteorite Armband	Critical-hit pressure through all seven forms.
Ragnar	Metal Babble Sword, strongest armor, Aeolus' Shield, Iron Mask	Durable sustained physical damage.
Cristo	Sword of Miracles, strongest defensive gear, Meteorite Armband	Healus, Healall, Revive, and secondary physical damage.

Keep the **Dress of Radiance** off anyone who must receive healing because its reflection can reject friendly spells. Carry a **Leaf of the World Tree** for guaranteed revival and a **Dew of the World Tree** as an emergency full-party resource. The Sandglass of Regression is optional insurance if a disastrous sequence needs to be replayed.

After crossing the palace, use the Baron's Horn before arranging the active party. Confirm every character not intended for the attempt is in the wagon, including Doran when making a strict two-member attempt.

Achievement Party Plans

Keep the same chosen formation from the opening round through Necrosaro's defeat. Do not rely on moving disallowed characters out immediately before the final blow.

Attempt	Active Party	Achievement Goal	Practical Notes
Standard clear	Hero / Alena / Ragnar / Cristo	Is This The End?	Safest first victory and best way to learn all seven forms.
No-Hero clear	Alena / Ragnar / Cristo / Nara	We Don't Need Another Hero	Leave the Hero in the wagon for the entire battle; all active characters act through tactics.
Two-member clear	Hero / Alena or Ragnar	Just the Two of Us	Hero commands the Sage's Stone and healing while the partner attacks. Keep everyone else in the wagon.
Combined attempt	Ragnar / Cristo or Alena / Cristo	Both composition challenges	Exactly two active members and no Hero satisfy both descriptions literally, but the entire battle is AI-controlled and substantially harder.

The combined attempt is the shortest route if both challenge triggers evaluate the final formation as described. Preserve the pre-boss save regardless: if only one challenge unlocks, use the dedicated formation for the remaining achievement. Levels above the normal recommendation, strong medal equipment, and learned battle behavior make either restricted clear much more reliable.

For the no-Hero attempt, Normal tactics provide the best balance while the party is healthy; switch to Defensive when group damage accumulates. Cristo and Nara offer redundant healing and revival while Alena and Ragnar supply offense. For the two-member Hero attempt, the Hero should use the Sage's Stone frequently and reserve MP for Healall, Healusall, and revival. Alena ends forms faster through critical hits, while Ragnar is the more durable partner.

Necrosaro's Mountain

With the wagon present and the desired active formation selected, walk north into the mountain. The ascent is a short winding path with occasional Flamadog encounters. Preserve HP and MP rather than grinding here. At the summit, approach Necrosaro to begin one continuous seven-form battle.

There is no recovery break, inventory access, or save opportunity between forms. Each transformation receives a new HP pool, for a total of **5,696 HP** across the battle.

Boss: Necrosaro

Form	HP	Actions and Threats	Primary Response
1	800	Two physical actions per round.	Establish a sustainable healing rhythm while physical attackers begin dealing damage.
2	650	One physical action per round after losing an arm.	Use the reduced pressure to restore HP and prepare for spellcasting forms.
3	1,023	Firebane, Snowstorm, Increase, and sweet breath.	Remove Increase with the Zenithian Sword's Disperse effect when practical; use Awake after sleep.
4	700	Freezing wave, scorching gas, violent blaze, and Meditation.	Keep attacking through Meditation and avoid overinvesting in buffs that the wave removes.
5	800	Two actions and party-wide scorching gas.	Use the Sage's Stone regularly and keep fragile characters above danger range.
6	700	Continues the two-action physical and gas pressure.	Recover toward full HP before forcing the final transformation.
7	1,023	Opens with Bounce, acts twice, uses violent blaze, icy breath, and freezing wave.	Stop offensive spellcasting, use free group healing repeatedly, and finish with physical damage.

Necrosaro awards no EXP or gold. The achievement triggers are tied to defeating the final form, not to an end-of-battle reward screen.

Forms 1 and 2: The Arms

Begin on Normal tactics. Form 1 attacks twice, so use the Sage's Stone whenever more than one character needs meaningful healing. Alena and Ragnar should attack continuously while Cristo supports them. If using Bikill, apply it to the strongest physical attacker, but do not sacrifice urgent recovery for setup.

After the first arm is destroyed, Form 2 acts only once per round. This is the safest part of the battle. Restore the party, revive anyone who fell, and stabilize MP before removing the second arm. Avoid rushing the transformation while a healer is weak.

Form 3: Head and Magic

Without both arms, Necrosaro turns to Firebane, Snowstorm, Increase, and sweet breath. If the Hero is active, use the Zenithian Sword as an item to remove Increase when the defense boost materially slows the attackers. Cast Awake when sleep disables an essential healer or damage dealer.

Barrier helps against spell damage if the AI supplies it, but remember that later forms erase support effects. Keep direct damage moving and preserve enough healing for the more dangerous transformations.

Form 4: The First Transformation

After losing his original head, Necrosaro becomes a green creature with a new face. He can erase active spell effects with a freezing wave, recover HP through Meditation, and damage the party with scorching gas or violent blaze.

Do not enter a long cycle of rebuilding every removed buff. Heal first, restore only high-value effects when the party has breathing room, and pressure the 700 HP pool so Meditation cannot prolong the form indefinitely.

Forms 5 and 6: Arms and Legs Restored

Form 5 regrows its arms and returns to two actions per round. Scorching gas can damage the entire active party before a healer responds. Use the Sage's Stone whenever group HP is uneven and reserve Healusall for rounds where free healing will not be enough.

Form 6 adds the legs but follows the same basic pattern. Near the end of its 700 HP pool, slow down long enough to restore the party. The next form opens with Bounce and has the battle's highest sustained group-damage potential.

Form 7: Final Form

The final form begins with Bounce, acts twice, uses violent blaze and icy breath, and can erase support effects with the freezing wave. Do not let Mara, Brey, or another caster repeatedly throw reflected attack spells. Physical attackers should carry the offense while the Hero uses the Sage's Stone on most damaged rounds.

Treat a freezing wave that removes few or no active buffs as a low-damage opportunity. Attack aggressively on that turn, but keep enough HP to survive two consecutive breath attacks. If Cristo is present, Defensive tactics can improve recovery consistency when the party falls behind.

Defeating the 1,023 HP final form ends the battle and begins Necrosaro's collapse.

Achievement Alert: Is This The End?
Trigger: Defeat Necrosaro's seventh and final form.

Achievement Alert: We Don't Need Another Hero
Trigger: Defeat Necrosaro while the Hero remains outside the active party. Keep the Hero in the wagon for the complete battle to satisfy the condition cleanly.

Achievement Alert: Just the Two of Us
Trigger: Defeat Necrosaro with exactly two active party members. Keep all other characters and Doran out of the active formation for the complete battle.

The normal achievement unlocks on every successful clear. The two challenge alerts apply only when their stated formation was maintained. Reload the Last Refuge save after the ending to make another attempt; unlocked RetroAchievements remain credited even though the game itself returns to the pre-boss save.

The Ending

Necrosaro's mountain begins to collapse after the battle. The Master Dragon rescues the party and returns everyone to Zenithia, where fallen allies are restored and the assembled heroes are thanked for ending the threat.

Explore Zenithia for the residents' final dialogue if desired, then leave the castle to commit to the ending sequence. The balloon carries the companions home in turn:

1. Alena, Cristo, and Brey return to the restored Santeem Castle.
2. Ragnar returns to Burland.
3. Taloon reunites with his family in Endor.
4. Nara and Mara visit Kievs and then return to Monbaraba.
5. The Hero returns alone to the ruins of Hometown.

At Hometown, Celia reappears. Ragnar, Alena, Cristo, Brey, Taloon, Nara, and Mara then arrive to reunite with the Hero before the credits.

There is no playable postgame after the credits. Use the preserved Last Refuge save for any remaining achievement cleanup or additional Necrosaro formations.

Final Battle Completion Check

- **Palace achievement:** Hidden Treasure - Necrosaro's Palace unlocked from the Sage's Stone route.
- **Story achievement:** Is This The End? unlocked after defeating the seventh form.
- **Challenge achievements:** We Don't Need Another Hero and Just the Two of Us unlocked through dedicated or combined formation attempts.
- **Small Medals:** 32/32 routed medals found; Small Medal Collector unlocked if every earlier medal was collected.
- **Critical items:** Sage's Stone secured and Baron's Horn used outside the palace.
- **Final boss:** All seven forms defeated, totaling 5,696 HP.
- **Ending:** Zenithia dialogue completed and the castle exited to begin the homecoming sequence.
- **Next destination:** Reload the pre-boss save for Side Activities and Final Checks if any optional achievement remains.

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Side Activities and Final Checks

Section Achievements: Side Activities and Final Checks

Achievement	Points	Trigger	Route Notes
High Roller	5	Have at least 10,000 Casino coins	Build the balance at Endor and allow the achievement to unlock before buying a prize.
The One That Didn't Get Away	5	Defeat a King Metal	Hunt northeast of Gottside or in the Final Cave with a metal-focused party.
Small Medal Collector	50	Find all 32 small medals	Audit the numbered route and recover every available omission before the final clear.

This section uses the in-game save preserved at the Last Refuge before Necrosaro. There is no playable postgame after the credits, so reload that save and complete any unfinished objective before making the definitive final-boss clear. Players who already earned one or more of these achievements can use the corresponding subsection as confirmation and move on.

The efficient cleanup order is:

1. Check whether `Small Medal Collector` unlocked when Small Medal 32 was opened in Necrosaro's Palace.
2. Audit and recover any missing medal before repeating the ending.
3. Build and hold 10,000 Casino coins at Endor.
4. Hunt a King Metal near Gottside or in the Final Cave.
5. Return to the Last Refuge, restore the party, and make a fresh in-game save.
6. Complete any outstanding Necrosaro party-composition victory, then finish the ending.

High Roller: Endor Casino

Location: Basement beneath the Endor inn
Chapter 5 exchange rate: 20G per Casino coin
Required balance: 10,000 coins at one time
Recommended game: 100-coin poker

Casino coins are shared across chapters, so any balance retained from Alena or Taloon reduces the Chapter 5 grind. Speak with the exchange attendant to buy a starting reserve. Purchasing all 10,000 coins directly costs **200,000G**, making direct conversion the fastest option if the party has accumulated enough unused gold.

The casino offers slot machines, poker, and the Monster Arena. Slots and the arena provide less control over an individual attempt. Poker supports 1-, 10-, and 100-coin antes and gives access to a double-or-nothing sequence after a winning hand, making it the most practical route to a five-digit balance.

Chapter 5 Casino Prizes

Prize	Coin Cost	Cleanup Value
Magic Potion	30	Common MP recovery; not worth interrupting the 10,000-coin target.
Wizard's Ring	500	Reusable MP recovery with a chance to break.
Staff of Jubilation	1,000	Optional caster weapon and combat-use item.

Prize	Coin Cost	Cleanup Value
Mirror of Ra	2,500	Reveals transformed enemies but is not required for the final route.
Meteorite Armband	4,000	Excellent speed accessory for a healer or physical attacker.
Metal Babble Shield	50,000	Premium caster shield and the best long-term casino target.

Do not redeem any prize until the displayed balance reaches at least **10,000** and the achievement notification appears. Spending below the threshold before the check can delay the unlock even if 10,000 total coins have been earned over time.

Poker and Double-or-Nothing Route

1. Record the adventure normally in Endor before beginning the session.
2. Buy enough coins to absorb several maximum-ante hands without immediately reaching zero.
3. Use the 100-coin poker table once the reserve can support normal losing streaks.
4. After a winning hand, choose double-or-nothing and predict whether the next card will be higher or lower.
5. Each correct prediction doubles the current award. Collect after a meaningful gain rather than risking the entire chain indefinitely.
6. Leave the casino and make another normal in-game save after reaching a new balance milestone.
7. Reload the normal save after a major losing session, then resume from the banked balance.

This route uses only Dragon Warrior IV's normal save and reset cycle. In Hardcore mode, do not load emulator save states or use rewind, slow motion, frame advance, or cheats. Fast-forward is explicitly allowed by current RetroAchievements rules.

> **Achievement Alert: High Roller**
> **Trigger:** Hold at least 10,000 Casino coins simultaneously. Wait for the unlock before purchasing the Meteorite Armband or another prize.

After the achievement unlocks, spend only what the remaining final-boss plans can spare. A second Meteorite Armband is immediately useful; the Metal Babble Shield requires a much longer grind and is optional.

The One That Didn't Get Away: King Metal Hunt

Preferred location: Hills northeast of Gottside
Alternative location: Final Cave
Recovery base: Gottside or the Last Refuge
Required result: Defeat one King Metal before it flees

Enemy	HP	EXP	Gold	Behavior	Possible Drop
King Metal	7	30,010	20G	May act twice, cast Firebane, or flee.	Metal Babble Helm

The Gottside hills are the cleaner hunting ground because Return provides quick access to town and the surrounding encounters are less costly than those in the Final Cave. The Final Cave is a reasonable alternative while leveling for the restricted Necrosaro attempts, but its ordinary enemies make failed hunts more expensive.

Build the active party around attacks that can bypass or work through metal-monster defense:

Character or Item	Role Against King Metal
Alena with Stilleto Earrings	Two attacks plus her naturally high critical-hit rate provide the best immediate victory chance.
Hero or Ragnar with Metal Babble Sword	Supplies reliable metal-target damage when ordinary weapons would deal little or none.
Brey with Poison Needle	Fixed chip damage remains useful, and its instant-kill effect can end the encounter.
Mara with Poison Needle	Can contribute fixed damage or, under Offensive tactics, attempt BeDragon.
BeDragon	Costs a transformation turn; the following breath can kill a surviving King Metal if it has not fled.
Sandglass of Regression	Rewinds an ongoing battle once per day; the supplied NES sources describe either a return to the beginning or several rounds earlier.

Use **Hero / Alena / Brey / Mara** when all listed tools are available. Put the Metal Babble Sword on the Hero, Stilleto Earrings on Alena, and Poison Needles on Brey and Mara. Offensive tactics make Mara more likely to choose BeDragon, but the immediate attacks from Alena, the Hero, and Brey remain important because the target may flee before Mara's transformed turn.

Focus every action on one King Metal. Do not divide damage across multiple targets unless a group spell or breath will finish all survivors. A critical hit from Alena is the cleanest result; otherwise, accumulate the seven required points of damage before the enemy escapes.

The Sandglass of Regression is a normal in-game item rather than emulator rewind. Use it while the encounter is still active; once every target has fled and the battle has closed, there is no battle left to rewind.

> **Achievement Alert: The One That Didn't Get Away**
> **Trigger:** Defeat a King Metal. Metal Slimes and Metal Babbles do not satisfy this achievement.

The 30,010 EXP reward is useful preparation for the two-member Necrosaro clear, but one confirmed victory is sufficient. Stop the hunt once the achievement unlocks unless additional levels are specifically needed.

Small Medal Collector Audit

The North American NES release contains **32 Small Medals**. Spending medals at the Medal King's castle does not undo their discovery, so audit locations rather than comparing the current inventory count. If the route was followed exactly, Small Medal 32 in Necrosaro's Palace already triggered the achievement.

One of the two Konenber ship medals becomes permanently unavailable after the Great Lighthouse sequence. If either was skipped before the lighthouse, an earlier save or another playthrough may be required. The remaining routed locations can be revisited from the preserved pre-boss save.

#	Location	Exact Pickup
1	Konenber western port	Board the old ship, descend into its first room, and search the dresser.
2	Taloon's unfinished ship in Konenber	Board in the northwest shipyard, go downstairs, and search the dresser before completing the Great Lighthouse.
3	Mintos	Search the ground immediately west of the central well.
4	Shrine east of Mintos	Follow the grassy strip between the outer walls to its dead end and search.
5	Cave West of Kievs	In Edgar's hidden laboratory, search the left pot along the north wall.
6	Small island shack north of Haville	Search the right pot; later references to this shack describe this same medal and must not be counted twice.
7	Endor Castle	At night, unlock the royal bedroom and search the far-right dresser.
8	Seaside Village	Search the ground directly south of the central statue.

#	Location	Exact Pickup
9	Stancia	Enter the northeast house, climb to the second floor, and search the pots.
10	Stancia Castle	During daytime, search the dresser in the far-right room on eastern 1F.
11	Gardenbur Castle	Search the pots in the western first-floor kitchen.
12	Cave Southeast of Gardenbur	Follow the narrow eastern path to its end and open the chest.
13	Branca Castle	Unlock the northeast jail treasury with the Final Key and open its chests.
14	Haville jail	Search the pot in the first cell.
15	Haville jail	Search the pot in the third cell occupied by the Yeti.
16	Shrine of Breaking Waves	After the fourth row of rock pillars, land on the left bank and follow the concealed western route.
17	Shrine of Breaking Waves	Open the two northwest chests downstairs; one holds the medal and the other the Zenithian Armor.
18	Cascade Cave	At the first lower-floor split, follow the northern branch to the chest.
19	Royal Crypt	Take the eastern side corridor north without touching the right-side arrows, then enter the western room.
20	Riverton	On the central island, stand two tiles south of the resident and search the southernmost grass tile.
21	Shrine of the Colossus	Inside the lower body, follow the outer route behind the central stairs to the chest.
22	Dire Palace	Search the pots in the basement kitchen.
23	Dire Palace	In the concealed treasure room, open the northern chests for the medal and Aeolus' Shield.
24	Aktemto Mine B4	At the eastern dead end, search the southern edge against the water.
25	Esturk's Palace	Open the chest in the first small room north of the entrance.
26	Esturk's Palace	Follow the lower route to the two-chest room; one is a Mimic and the other holds the medal.
27	Gottside	Descend into the northeast underground room and search the eastern dresser.
28	Zenithian Tower	Take the southwest stair branches to the dead-end treasure room.
29	Zenithian Castle	Enter the room right of the renewable Dew room and search the dressers.
30	Final Cave	Use the entrance-floor arrow tiles to reach the enclosed southern chest.
31	Gigademon's shrine	Follow the exterior tombstone path clockwise and search the far northwest corner.
32	Necrosaro's Palace	Descend from the spirit room, cast StepGuard, cross the poisoned floor, and open the southern chest.

Achievement Alert: Small Medal Collector
Trigger: Collect the last missing medal among the 32 routed locations. On the main route, this occurs when the Necrosaro's Palace chest raises the running total from 31/32 to 32/32.

If the achievement remains locked, compare the table against the route in numerical order. Start with medals 1 and 2 in Konenber, then check searched pots, dressers, and ground tiles; chest medals are easier to recognize as already opened. Do not count a later reference to an already collected location as another medal.

Final Pre-Necrosaro Check

Return to the Last Refuge after cleanup, restore HP and MP, and record the adventure. Before crossing Necrosaro's Palace for the final time, verify:

- **High Roller:** The achievement unlocked while the Casino coin balance displayed at least 10,000.
- **King Metal:** The One That Didn't Get Away unlocked from an actual King Metal victory.

- **Small Medals:** Small Medal Collector unlocked and the 32-location audit is complete.
- **Palace treasure:** Sage's Stone, Staff of Thunder, Lifeforce Nuts, and Small Medal 32 were collected.
- **Recovery items:** A Leaf of the World Tree and Dew of the World Tree are available where possible.
- **Key item:** The Baron's Horn is carried through the palace and used at the rear exit.
- **Equipment:** The final party and reserve members have their intended weapons, armor, shields, helmets, and accessories.
- **Challenge formation:** The active party matches the next Necrosaro achievement attempt before entering battle.
- **Save:** A normal in-game save exists at the Last Refuge for further attempts.

The final battle and ending route remain in the preceding section. This cleanup section ends at the pre-boss checkpoint and does not repeat Necrosaro's seven forms.

Side Activity Completion Check

- **Achievements:** High Roller, The One That Didn't Get Away, and Small Medal Collector unlocked.
- **Achievement points:** 60 points available from this section's three objectives.
- **Casino:** A 10,000-coin balance was reached before prizes were redeemed.
- **King Metal:** At least one defeated; further hunting is optional leveling.
- **Small Medals:** All 32 routed locations confirmed, including both Konenber ship medals collected before their cutoff.
- **Final save:** Last Refuge save updated after cleanup and before the final battle.
- **Next section:** Reference Appendices.

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Reference Appendices

These appendices condense the route's recurring information into lookup tables. They do not introduce new progression steps. When a reference entry and a walkthrough instruction serve different purposes, follow the detailed walkthrough section for navigation and use the appendix for quick verification.

Permanent Character Reference

Chapter 5 permits direct commands only for the Hero. Every other active character follows the selected tactic and develops resistance knowledge through repeated encounters. Party advice therefore considers both a character's abilities and how reliably the AI uses them.

Character	Class or Role	Strengths	Limitations	Primary Endgame Use
Hero	Balanced fighter and spellcaster	Strong equipment, physical damage, lightning magic, healing, and direct player control	Must divide turns among damage, healing, items, and utility	Sage's Stone controller, emergency healer, and flexible attacker
Ragnar	Soldier and physical tank	Very high HP, strength, defense, and heavy-equipment access	Low agility and no spells	Durable sustained damage with the Metal Babble Sword
Alena	Fast physical attacker	Very high agility, frequent critical hits, and strong damage with Stilleto Earrings	Limited equipment, moderate defense, and no spells	Boss damage and King Metal hunting
Cristo	Defensive mage and primary healer	Healall, Healus, Revive, Increase, and strong late defensive equipment	AI can waste turns on Beat or Defeat until enemy resistance is learned	Main AI-controlled healer and revival support
Brey	Offensive and support wizard	Ice magic, Bikill, SpeedUp, Defense, Bounce, and Transform	Low HP and defense; high-level magic consumes MP quickly	Physical-party support and ice damage
Taloon	Merchant and utility fighter	High HP, broad equipment access, and useful autonomous special actions	Slower and less predictable than Ragnar or Alena; no spells	Durable reserve attacker and challenge-party substitute
Nara	Defensive mage and secondary healer	Healall, Barrier, Vivify, status recovery, and Infernos-family damage	Low HP and physical damage; Farewell removes her from battle	Backup healer and breath-defense support
Mara	Offensive mage	Fire, explosion, Sap, RobMagic, BeDragon, and high MP	Low physical durability and AI spell choices can be inefficient	Group damage, boss spell pressure, and metal hunting

Spell Learning Reference

The levels below are the listed learning levels in the primary walkthrough. Treat them as expected checkpoints and verify the character's Spell menu before a route depends on a particular spell.

Character	Listed Spell Progression
Hero	1 Expel; 3 Blaze; 5 Healmore; 7 Return; 9 Firebal; 11 Repel; 13 Outside; 15 Sleepmore; 17 Awake; 19 FendSpell; 21 Ironize; 23 Boom; 25 Zap; 27 Healall; 28 Vivify; 30 Transform; 32 Healusall; 34 Lightning; 37 Thordain; 39 Chance
Cristo	1 Heal; 4 Upper; 6 Surround; 8 Antidote; 12 StopSpell; 14 Increase; 16 Healmore; 18 Beat; 21 Vivify; 24 Defeat; 27 Healall; 30 Healus; 33 Revive
Brey	1 Icebolt; 3 Sap; 7 Outside; 8 Bounce; 9 Return; 11 Snowstorm; 14 SpeedUp; 17 Day-Night; 19 Bikill; 21 Defense; 23 X-Ray; 25 RobMagic; 27 Icespears; 30 Chaos; 32 Blizzard
Nara	1 Heal; 5 Sleep; 8 Infernos; 10 NumbOff; 13 Healmore; 16 Sleepmore; 20 Vivify; 23 Infermore; 26 Healall; 29 Barrier; 32 Infermost; 35 Farewell
Mara	1 Blaze; 3 Sap; 7 Firebal; 8 Return; 9 Outside; 11 Bang; 14 Firebane; 16 RobMagic; 19 Blazemore; 21 StepGuard; 23 Boom; 27 Firevolt; 30 BeDragon; 33 Blazemost; 36 Explodet

Ragnar, Alena, and Taloon do not learn spells. Their value comes from physical stats, equipment, critical hits, and Taloon's autonomous actions.

Route-Critical Spell Uses

Spell	Primary User	Route Function
Return	Hero, Brey, Mara	Travel to previously registered destinations.
Outside	Hero, Brey, Mara	Leave most dungeons; several story interiors explicitly block it.
Repel	Hero	Suppress encounters weaker than the party while traveling.
StepGuard	Hero, Mara	Cross damaging floor without losing HP.
Day-Night	Brey	Change the time for night-only doors, shops, and events.
Awake	Hero	Remove sleep during dangerous encounters.
NumbOff	Nara	Remove paralysis without a Full Moon Herb.
Upper / Increase	Cristo	Raise one ally's defense or the active party's defense.
Sap / Defense	Brey or Mara / Brey	Lower enemy defense for physical attackers.
StopSpell	Cristo	Seal enemy spellcasting when resistance permits.
Barrier	Nara	Reduce dangerous breath and elemental pressure.
Bikill	Brey	Increase a physical attacker's damage when the AI selects it.
Healall	Hero, Cristo, Nara	Restore one character during boss battles.
Healus	Cristo	Restore the active group; the Sage's Stone reproduces this effect.
Healusall	Hero	Emergency full-party recovery in the late game.
Vivify / Revive	Hero, Cristo, Nara / Cristo	Attempt revival or provide Cristo's stronger late revival.
Ironize	Hero	Prevent damage while enemy AI learns resistances; the party also cannot act.
Transform	Hero, Brey	Copy another party member's command set for specialized tactics.
BeDragon	Mara	Transform for defense-piercing breath on the following turn.
Lightning / Thordain	Hero	High-level damage against groups or major targets when resistance permits.

Temporary Companion Reference

Temporary companions act under AI control and may join beyond the normal permanent roster. Several leave automatically when their story purpose is complete.

Companion	Join Point	Leave Point	Useful Traits
Healie	Hidden well during Chapter 1	End of Chapter 1	Casts Heal and stabilizes Ragnar's solo chapter.
Laurent	Hire at the Endor inn during Chapter 3 for 600G	Five in-game days after hiring	Uses a Venomous Dagger and can cast Sleep and Firebal.
Strom	Hire outside Endor's House of Healing during Chapter 3 for 400G	Five in-game days after hiring	Strong physical attack for the Silver Statuette cave.
Orin	Lowest level of the Cave West of Kievs during Chapter 4	Keeleon Castle escape	Strong physical attacker who can break certain locked doors outside battle.
Hector	Desert Inn after recovering the Symbol of Faith	Mintos after Alena, Cristo, and Brey reunite	Strong attack, offensive magic, and a charge-up action for his next strike.
Panon	Monbaraba after learning the King of Stancia needs a jester	After the Stancia throne-room event	Unpredictable special actions and the dialogue needed for the Zenithian Helm.
Lucia	Top of the World Tree with an active party of three	Entry into Zenithia	Healing support and the escort required to make Doran available.
Doran	Zenithia after returning Lucia	Remains through the final route	Physical attacks and no-MP fire breath that is not stopped by Bounce or FendSpell.

Tactics Quick Reference

Tactic	Best Use	Main Risk
Normal	Default for exploration and unfamiliar bosses	May not emphasize healing or damage strongly enough during emergencies.
Offensive	Fast clears and encouraging Mara's strongest attacks or BeDragon	Rapid MP use and delayed support.
Defensive	Long bosses and AI-controlled challenge parties needing frequent recovery	Fighters may defend instead of finishing a vulnerable target.
Save MP	Routine travel when resources must last	Suppresses costly group healing and BeDragon.
Use No MP	Weak encounters and physical-only cleanup	Prevents emergency spell recovery.
Try Out	Situational experiments with unusual actions or items	Deliberately unpredictable and unsafe for serious bosses.

Endgame Equipment Targets

These are practical targets, not a requirement to duplicate every limited or expensive item. Give the best unique equipment to the active challenge party first, then equip reserves from the listed alternatives.

Character	Weapon	Armor	Shield	Helmet / Accessory	Notes
Hero	Zenithian Sword	Zenithian Armor	Zenithian Shield	Zenithian Helm / Meteorite Armband	Carry the Sage's Stone for directly controlled group healing.
Ragnar	Metal Babble Sword	Metal Babble Armor	Aeolus' Shield	Iron Mask	Highest sustained physical damage and excellent durability.
Alena	Stilleto Earrings or Fire Claw	Pink Leotard or Dress of Radiance	None	Golden Barrette / Meteorite Armband	Stilleto Earrings support critical hits; avoid reflective armor when reliable healing matters.
Cristo	Sword of Miracles	Metal Babble Armor	Metal Babble Shield	Metal Babble Helm / Meteorite Armband	Prioritize survival so Healus and Revive remain available.
Brey	Poison Needle or Magma Staff	Water Flying Clothes	Metal Babble Shield or Scale Shield	Hat of Happiness	Poison Needle supports metal hunting; Magma Staff improves ordinary offense.
Taloon	Sword of Miracles	Metal Babble Armor	Shield of Strength	Iron Helmet	Durable reserve; both weapon and shield provide useful recovery effects.
Nara	Staff of Jubilation or Staff of Healing	Metal Babble Armor	Metal Babble Shield or Iron Shield	Golden Barrette	Defensive gear offsets low HP; the Staff of Healing supplies free Healmore when used.
Mara	Poison Needle or Magma Staff	Water Flying Clothes or Dress of Radiance	Metal Babble Shield	Golden Barrette	Use Poison Needle for metals and stronger magic gear for normal encounters.

High-Value Equipment Effects

Equipment	Effect or Use
Sage's Stone	Casts Healus in battle without spending MP.
Staff of Healing	Casts Healmore when used in battle.
Shield of Strength	Casts Healmore when used in battle.
Sword of Miracles	Restores some of the wielder's HP when an attack deals damage.
Zenithian Sword	Produces the Disperse effect when used and reaches 110 attack after the Master Dragon's blessing.
Stilleto Earrings	Gives Alena two attacks and improves her opportunity to land a critical hit.
Meteorite Armband	Doubles the wearer's agility.
Water Flying Clothes	Reduces fire-based damage.
Dragon Shield	Reduces fire and blizzard damage.
Dress of Radiance	Can reflect hostile spells, but may also reject friendly healing.
Mysterious Bolero	Can absorb the MP cost of a spell directed at its wearer.
Aeolus' Shield	Ragnar's strongest routed shield.

Notable Monster Treasures

The supplied Monster Treasures guide records which item each random monster can leave behind or Taloon can steal. It does not provide drop probabilities, so no odds are claimed here. This table favors permanent stat items, uncommon equipment, and late-game rewards over ordinary herbs and basic shop gear.

Monster	Possible Treasure	Why It Matters
Archbison	Strength Seed	Permanent Strength increase.
Beastan	Agility Seed	Permanent Agility increase.
Bebanbar	Staff of Healing	Repeatable Healmore effect in battle.
Beleth	Staff of Force	Strong caster weapon.
Bellzabble	Multi-Edge Sword	Powerful but cursed weapon.
Bharack	Wizard's Ring	Reusable MP recovery until it breaks.
Big Sloth	Staff of Jubilation	Caster equipment and combat-use utility.
Blizag	Mystic Acorns	Permanent maximum MP increase.
Bomb Crag	Lifeforce Nuts	Permanent maximum HP increase.
Doolsnake	Golden Barrette	Useful helmet for Alena, Mara, or Nara.
Dragon Rider	Strength Seed	Permanent Strength increase.
Dragonit	Cloak of Evasion	Useful light armor for eligible characters.
Duke Malisto	Staff of Antimagic	Provides spell-sealing utility as an item.
Eigerhorn	Lifeforce Nuts	Permanent maximum HP increase.
Fairy Dragon	Mystic Acorns	Permanent maximum MP increase.
Flamadog	Lifeforce Nuts	Permanent maximum HP increase.
Great Ridon	Multi-Edge Sword	Powerful cursed weapon or sale item.
Green Dragon	Dragon Shield	Element-resistant shield for the Hero or Ragnar.
Guardian	Dragon Killer	Strong weapon for the Hero or Ragnar.
Jumbat	Robe of Serenity	Defensive caster armor.
King Metal	Metal Babble Helm	Rare top-tier helmet and achievement-linked hunting target.
King Slime	Mystic Acorns	Permanent maximum MP increase.
Maskan	Stilleto Earrings	Alena's preferred multi-hit weapon.
Master Malice	Dress of Radiance	High-defense reflective armor.
Metal Babble	Hat of Happiness	Restores MP while walking.

Monster	Possible Treasure	Why It Matters
Metal Slime	Golden Barrette	Strong lightweight helmet.
Mighty Healer	Lifeforce Nuts	Permanent maximum HP increase.
Ryvernlord	Agility Seed	Permanent Agility increase.
Spite Spirit	Cloak of Evasion	Useful light armor.
Swinger	Demon Armor	Powerful but cursed armor.
Wilymage	Mysterious Bolero	Can absorb the MP cost of incoming spells.

Small Medal Location Index

This is the compact lookup version of the detailed audit in Side Activities and Final Checks. One of the first two Konenber ship medals is permanently missable after the lighthouse mission, so collect both before leaving for the lighthouse. Medal 6 is listed once even though later source routes revisit its island.

#	Location	Pickup
1	Konenber western port	Old ship, downstairs dresser
2	Taloon's unfinished ship in Konenber	Northwest shipyard, downstairs dresser before the Great Lighthouse
3	Mintos	Ground immediately west of the central well
4	Shrine east of Mintos	End of the grassy strip between the outer walls
5	Cave West of Kievs	Left pot in Edgar's hidden laboratory
6	Small island shack north of Haville	Right pot
7	Endor Castle at night	Far-right dresser in the royal bedroom
8	Seaside Village	Ground directly south of the central statue
9	Stancia	Pots upstairs in the northeast house
10	Stancia Castle by day	Dresser in the far-right room on eastern 1F
11	Gardenbur Castle	Pots in the western first-floor kitchen
12	Cave Southeast of Gardenbur	Chest at the end of the narrow eastern path
13	Branca Castle	Chest in the northeast Final Key jail treasury
14	Haville jail	Pot in the first cell
15	Haville jail	Pot in the third cell with the Yeti
16	Shrine of Breaking Waves	Hidden western route after the fourth row of rock pillars
17	Shrine of Breaking Waves	Northwest chest beside the Zenithian Armor chest
18	Cascade Cave	Chest on the northern branch at the first lower-floor split
19	Royal Crypt	Western room reached from the eastern corridor without using the right arrows
20	Riverton	Southernmost grass tile, two tiles south of the central-island resident
21	Shrine of the Colossus	Chest behind the central stairs inside the lower body
22	Dire Palace	Pot in the basement kitchen
23	Dire Palace	Northern chest in the concealed treasure room
24	Aktemto Mine B4	Water's edge at the eastern dead end
25	Esturk's Palace	First small-room chest north of the entrance
26	Esturk's Palace	Lower-route chest beside a Mimic
27	Gottside	Eastern dresser in the northeast underground room
28	Zenithian Tower	Dead-end treasure room reached by the southwest stair branches
29	Zenithian Castle	Dressers in the room right of the renewable Dew room
30	Final Cave	Enclosed southern chest reached by the entrance-floor arrows
31	Gigademon's shrine	Ground at the northwest end of the exterior tombstone path
32	Necrosaro's Palace	Southern chest across the poisoned basement below the spirit room

Achievement Index

The canonical set contains **43 achievements worth 360 points**. The Primary Section column identifies the section containing the routed trigger or final cleanup instructions.

ID	Achievement	Points	Primary Section	Requirement
52318	Reunited	5	Chapter 1: Ragnar and the Missing Children	Help Flora find her missing husband
52319	In Search of a Hero	10	Chapter 1: Ragnar and the Missing Children	Complete Chapter 1
52320	The Offering	5	Chapter 2: Alena's Journey to Endor	Bring peace to Tempe
52321	Speak No Evil	5	Chapter 2: Alena's Journey to Endor	Restore the King's Voice
52322	It's a Trap	5	Chapter 3: Taloon's Road to Riches	Collect the Iron Safe and leave
52323	Making Friends	5	Chapter 1: Ragnar and the Missing Children	Let the Healer slime join your party
52324	Sneaking Out	5	Chapter 2: Alena's Journey to Endor	Find a way out of the Castle
52325	The Kidnapped Imposter	5	Chapter 2: Alena's Journey to Endor	Rescue the fake princess
52326	The Empty Castle	10	Chapter 2: Alena's Journey to Endor	Complete Chapter 2
52327	The Architect	5	Chapter 3: Taloon's Road to Riches	Repair the bridge to Endor
52328	Moving In	5	Chapter 3: Taloon's Road to Riches	Purchase the shop in Endor
52329	The Traveling Merchant	10	Chapter 3: Taloon's Road to Riches	Complete Chapter 3
52330	Edgar's Pupil	5	Chapter 4: The Sisters of Monbaraba	Get Orin to join your party
52331	Refugees	10	Chapter 4: The Sisters of Monbaraba	Complete Chapter 4
52332	Caravan	10	Chapter 5 Begins: The Hero, Endor, and the Wagon	Acquire the wagon
52333	Starboard the Helm!	10	Konenber and the Great Lighthouse	Acquire the boat
52334	Miracle Plant	5	Mintos, Padequia, Keeleon, and Santeem	Help Cristo recover from his illness
52335	Rematch	5	Mintos, Padequia, Keeleon, and Santeem	Defeat Keeleon
52336	You've Changed	5	Mintos, Padequia, Keeleon, and Santeem	Defeat the evolved Balzack
52337	Not So Funny	5	Stancia and the Zenithian Helm	Get the Zenithian Helm
52338	Proof of Innocence	5	Gardenbur and the Zenithian Shield	Get the Zenithian Shield
52339	Underwater Oasis	5	Rosaville, Shrine of Breaking Waves, and the Dire Palace	Get the Zenithian Armor
52340	A Monstrous Announcement	5	Rosaville, Shrine of Breaking Waves, and the Dire Palace	Attend the conference at the Dire Palace
52341	There's Gas Inside	10	Esturk's Palace and the Balloon	Acquire the hot air balloon
52342	The Highest Branches	5	The World Tree, Zenithian Sword, and Zenithia	Get the Zenithian Sword
52343	Humans are Curious Creatures	5	The World Tree, Zenithian Sword, and Zenithia	Talk to the Master Dragon
52344	And Then There Were None	10	The Dark World and the Four Guardians	Defeat the four guardians of the Dark World
52345	Is This The End?	25	Necrosaro's Palace and the Ending	Defeat Necrosaro
52346	We Don't Need Another Hero	25	Necrosaro's Palace and the Ending	Defeat Necrosaro without the hero in the party
52347	Just the Two of Us	25	Necrosaro's Palace and the Ending	Defeat Necrosaro with a party of two

ID	Achievement	Points	Primary Section	Requirement
52348	High Roller	5	Side Activities and Final Checks	Have at least 10,000 Casino coins
52349	Tunnel Rat	5	Chapter 5 Begins: The Hero, Endor, and the Wagon	Be the 1000th person to use the new tunnel
52350	Rosa's Fate	5	Esturk's Palace and the Balloon	Find out what happened to Rosa
52351	Private Dance	5	Chapter 4: The Sisters of Monbaraba	Try Pufpuf
52352	Zenithia's Finest	5	The World Tree, Zenithian Sword, and Zenithia	Doran joined the party
52353	The One That Didn't Get Away	5	Side Activities and Final Checks	Defeat a King Metal
52354	Hidden Treasure - Great Lighthouse	5	Konenber and the Great Lighthouse	Find all three hidden treasures in the Great Lighthouse
52355	Hidden Treasure - Endor	5	Chapter 5 Begins: The Hero, Endor, and the Wagon	Find the hidden treasure in Endor
52356	Hidden Treasure - Gardenbur	5	Gardenbur and the Zenithian Shield	Find the hidden treasure in Gardenbur
52357	Hidden Treasure - Shrine of the Horn	5	The World Tree, Zenithian Sword, and Zenithia	Find the hidden treasure in the Shrine of the Horn
52358	Hidden Treasure - Necrosaro's Palace	5	Necrosaro's Palace and the Ending	Find the hidden treasure in Necrosaro's Palace
52359	Arboreal Vandal	5	The World Tree, Zenithian Sword, and Zenithia	Pluck a leaf from the World Tree
52360	Small Medal Collector	50	Side Activities and Final Checks	Find all 32 small medals

Achievement Points by Route Section

Section	Achievements	Points
Chapter 1: Ragnar and the Missing Children	3	20
Chapter 2: Alena's Journey to Endor	5	30
Chapter 3: Taloon's Road to Riches	4	25
Chapter 4: The Sisters of Monbaraba	3	20
Chapter 5 Begins: The Hero, Endor, and the Wagon	3	20
Konenber and the Great Lighthouse	2	15
Mintos, Padequia, Keeleon, and Santeem	3	15
Stancia and the Zenithian Helm	1	5
Gardenbur and the Zenithian Shield	2	10
Rosaville, Shrine of Breaking Waves, and the Dire Palace	2	10
Esturk's Palace and the Balloon	2	15
The World Tree, Zenithian Sword, and Zenithia	5	25
The Dark World and the Four Guardians	1	10
Necrosaro's Palace and the Ending	4	80
Side Activities and Final Checks	3	60
Total	**43**	**360**

Route Completion Summary

Category	Complete When
Chapters	Ragnar, Alena, Taloon, Nara, and Mara completed their opening stories and reunited with the Hero.
Transportation	Wagon, ship, tunnel access, Colossus crossing, and balloon all unlocked.
Keys	Thief's Key, Magic Key, and Final Key routes completed.
Zenithian equipment	Sword, Armor, Shield, and Helm obtained; Sword blessed by the Master Dragon.
Companions	Healie, Orin, Hector, Panon, Lucia, and Doran joined at their routed points.
Hidden treasure	Great Lighthouse trio plus Endor, Gardenbur, Shrine of the Horn, and Necrosaro's Palace discoveries completed.
Small Medals	All 32 routed medal locations confirmed.
Optional challenges	10,000 Casino coins held, King Metal defeated, and both restricted Necrosaro victories completed.
Story	Esturk and all four Dark World guardians defeated; Necrosaro's seventh form defeated; ending viewed.
Achievement set	43/43 achievements and 360/360 points earned.

This completes the Dragon Warrior IV unified achievement walkthrough.

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